

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION

FY 2024 Annual Agency Performance Report



Message from the Secretary



Miguel A. Cardona, Ed.D.
U.S. Secretary of Education

I am proud to present the U.S. Department of Education's (Department's) *FY 2024 Annual Performance Report*, which highlights the key achievements of our "Raise the Bar" initiative. These efforts are reshaping the future of American education by ensuring that every student, regardless of background or zip code, has access to a high-quality, world-class education.

Since the start of the Biden–Harris Administration, the Department has focused on four pillars under Raise the Bar: *Achieving Academic Excellence*, *Boldly Improving Learning Conditions*, *Creating Pathways for Global Engagement*, and *Increasing College Affordability and Completion*. These pillars guide our work and reflect our unwavering commitment to elevating opportunities for all students.

Under the *Achieving Academic Excellence* pillar, our historic $130 billion investment through the American Rescue Plan (ARP) provided a critical lifeline for schools recovering from the COVID-19 pandemic. Our commitment to accelerating learning through a focus on quality core instruction led by highly qualified educators, supported by investments in expanded high-quality tutoring, afterschool, and summer learning programs, has driven important progress in closing achievement gaps and preparing students for academic success.

We know that *Boldly Improving Learning Conditions* starts with our teachers, who are the backbone of our educational system. We continue to tackle teacher shortages and restore the jobs that were lost during the pandemic by fighting for educators to have the respect and the support they deserve—founded on agency, better working conditions, and competitive salaries. As of October 2024, our actions have helped recover more than 730,000 public education jobs. Our critical investments don't stop there. More than 30 states, the District of Columbia, and Puerto Rico have increased teacher salaries since 2022. We now have registered teacher apprenticeship programs in 45 states, the District of Columbia, and Puerto Rico, where none existed before the Biden–Harris Administration.

Our third pillar, *Creating Pathways for Global Engagement*, has continued to reimagine how U.S. high schools prepare all students to thrive in their future careers in an effort to support public and private sector leaders, government agencies, and others to help students earn postsecondary degrees and industry credentials that employers need and the economy demands. In January 2024, the Department announced 19 new grant awards totaling $25 million for the first-ever Perkins Innovation and Modernization, Career Connected High Schools Grant Program to develop new high-quality, career-connected high school programs for more students. In addition, we sponsored several challenges to develop innovative tools and practices to support career navigation and pathways. We also provided actionable steps through a state policy heat map and dozens of playbooks. Robust investments and a strategic action in the areas of an interagency initiative (with the White House and Department of Labor), dual enrollment, work-based learning, and workforce credentials are

the four key levers to providing all students with pathways to high-quality postsecondary education and training.

The Department also recognizes the importance of multilingualism as an academic, cognitive, and economic superpower for American students—and a reflection of the beautiful diversity of our nation. In 2024, we invested $890 million to expand language programs, support English learners, and help immigrant students transition to higher education and good jobs. All 50 states and the District of Columbia now offer the Seal of Biliteracy, recognizing the value of bilingualism.

Finally, *Increasing College Affordability and Completion* remains a top priority. We invested more than $90 million in grant awards under the Postsecondary Student Success Grant program to support minority-serving institutions, Historically Black Colleges and Universities, and community colleges to improve postsecondary student outcomes. Our fixes to Public Service Loan Forgiveness have brought relief to over 1 million borrowers with over $69.2 billion in loan forgiveness.

When it comes to Raising the Bar for our students, it's about more than closing achievement gaps—it's about raising the standard of what education *should be* in America. When we work together, we prove that every student can thrive if they have the right support.

The performance data included in this report are complete and reliable in accordance with federal requirements. Thank you for taking the time to read this important report and for your commitment to supporting the future of American education.

Miguel A. Cardona, Ed.D.
U.S. Secretary of Education

Table of Contents

HIGHLIGHTS 1

Executive Summary 2
About the Department 4
White House Initiatives and Offices 6

FY 2024 ANNUAL PERFORMANCE REPORT 10

FY 2022–FY 2026 Strategic Plan Overview 11

STRATEGIC GOAL 1: Promoting Equity 15

Equitable Resources and Opportunities for Underserved Students 17
Access to Learning Opportunities and Environments 21
Protection of All Students from Discrimination 24
Engagement of Youth and Adults in Learning 28

STRATEGIC GOAL 2: Diverse Educator Workforce 33

Strategic Objective 2.1 35
Strategic Objective 2.2 40
Strategic Objective 2.3 43

STRATEGIC GOAL 3: Student Needs 47

Strategic Objective 3.1 49
Strategic Objective 3.2 54
Strategic Objective 3.3 59

STRATEGIC GOAL 4: Postsecondary Education Access and Success 63

Strategic Objective 4.1 65
Strategic Objective 4.2 71
Strategic Objective 4.3 77
Strategic Objective 4.4 82

STRATEGIC GOAL 5: Organizational Governance 87

Strategic Objective 5.1 89
Strategic Objective 5.2 91
Strategic Objective 5.3 95
Strategic Objective 5.4 98

APPENDICES 100

Appendix A. COVID-19 Pandemic Relief Funding Performance Indicators 101
Appendix B. Data Validity and Verification 102
Appendix C. Performance Indicator Changes 118
Appendix D. Summary of Performance Evaluations Completed During FY 2024 119
Appendix E. FY 2024 Management Challenges Facing the U.S. Department of Education 122
Appendix F. Programs by Goal 128
Appendix G. Glossary of Acronyms and Abbreviations 136

HIGHLIGHTS

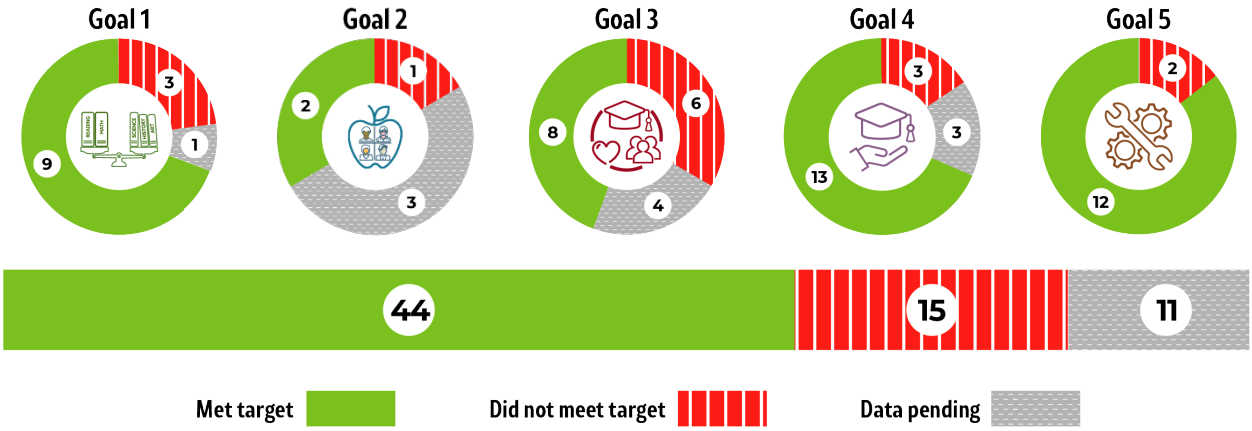
Executive Summary

This document is the Department's Fiscal Year (*FY) 2024 Annual Agency Performance Report* (APR). The APR provides narrative and data on the Department's progress toward the strategic goals and objectives outlined in its *Fiscal Years 2022–2026 Strategic Plan*. The upcoming *FY 2026 Annual Agency Performance Plan* will detail the Department's planned strategies and activities to achieve those strategic goals and objectives.

The *Government Performance and Results Act Modernization Act of 2010* (GPRAMA) (Pub. L. No. 111-352) is an update to the *Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) (Pub. L. No. 103-62) and provides the legal basis for the Department's Strategic Plan, including its strategic goals and objectives. In accordance with GPRAMA, the Deputy Secretary serves as the Chief Operating Officer of the Department and leads the Department's work in achieving its strategic goals.

FY 2024 Annual Agency Performance Report

In FY 2024, the Department assessed progress on 70 performance indicators. Of these indicators, 42 met their annual targets; 15 did not meet their annual targets, and 13 will report data by February 2025.



Additionally, in accordance with the Office of Management and Budget's (OMB's) memorandum M-20-21, the Department assessed COVID-19 pandemic relief funding progress on four performance indicators. Of these indicators, one met its annual target, and three are pending data.

Each year, OMB Circular A-11, Part 6 requires federal agencies to identify strategic objectives that have demonstrated noteworthy progress in achieving performance outcomes and focus areas for improvement for which current strategies are not having the intended impact on outcomes. The Department designated strategic objectives 1.3 and 1.4 as areas demonstrating noteworthy progress. The Department also identified strategic objective 4.2 as a focus area for improvement as current strategies are not having the intended impact on outcomes.

Throughout the fiscal year, the Department made significant strides toward accomplishing the goals of the *Fiscal Years 2022–2026 Strategic Plan*; however, that effort went beyond

meeting targets for performance indicators and encompassed a wide array of activities. This report discusses the accomplishments of the Department during FY 2024 as well as the challenges encountered.

About the Department

Mission

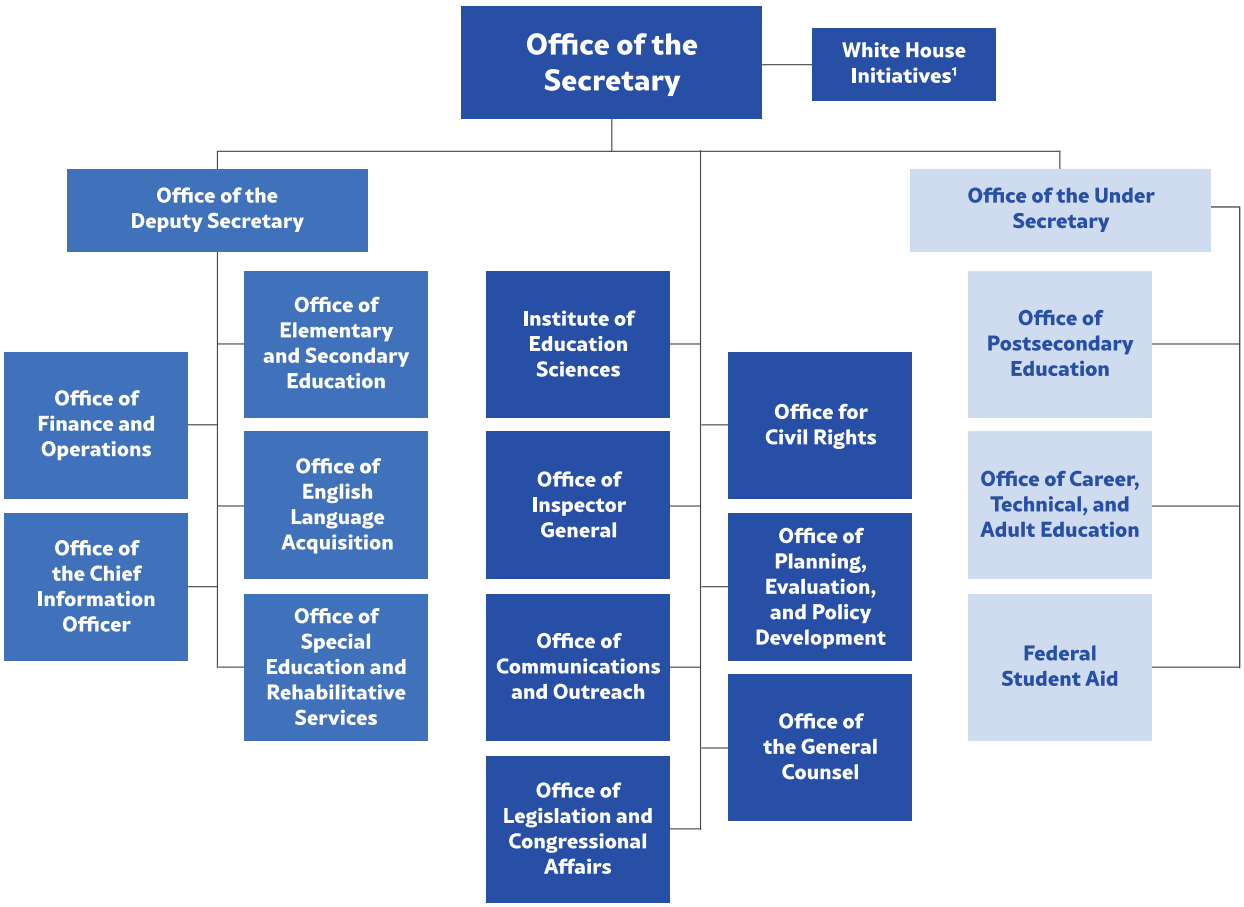
The U.S. Department of Education's mission is to promote student achievement and preparation for global competitiveness by fostering educational excellence and ensuring equal access.

The Department accomplishes its mission by funding grant and loan programs (e.g., early intervention services and employment training programs) that provide services to children as early as birth all the way to adulthood. Many of these programs provide grants to state or local educational agencies to support students, including those with disabilities and from socioeconomically disadvantaged backgrounds, and families protected by Federal civil rights laws and other laws. Several programs prepare students, teachers, and the nation's citizenry to engage with and succeed in an increasingly globalized world. Other programs provide grants and loans to postsecondary students and facilitate research that examines ways states, schools, districts, and postsecondary institutions can improve America's education system.

In addition, the Department fulfills its mission through the enforcement of student privacy and Federal civil rights laws that, among other things, provide all individuals with equal access to the programs funded by the Department.

FY 2024 Organization Structure

The following chart shows the Department's coordinating structure in fiscal year 2024.



[1]The White House Initiatives (WHIs) are Office of Faith-Based and Neighborhood Partnerships; WHI on Advancing Educational Equity, Excellence, and Economic Opportunity for Native Americans and Strengthening Tribal Colleges and Universities; WHI on Advancing Educational Equity, Excellence, and Economic Opportunity for Hispanics; WHI on Advancing Educational Equity, Excellence, and Economic Opportunity for Black Americans; and WHI on Advancing Educational Equity, Excellence, and Economic Opportunity through Historically Black Colleges and Universities.

White House Initiatives and Offices

The Department receives guidance and support from various committees and groups composed of experts in elementary and secondary schools and postsecondary and adult education institutions. These bodies provide invaluable advice on policy and program matters to ensure the Department is fulfilling its mission. Commissions, appointed by the President, offer guidance on national issues, with education being a key area. Furthermore, the Secretary of Education established commissions to advise the President and the Department.

White House Initiative on Advancing Educational Equity, Excellence, and Economic Opportunity for Black Americans

The White House Initiative (WHI) on Advancing Educational Equity, Excellence, and Economic Opportunity for Black Americans (i.e., WHI for Black Americans) collaborates closely with the Executive Office of the President to achieve critical Administration objectives related to promoting educational equity, excellence, and economic opportunity for Black students in prekindergarten through grade 12 (P–12) and postsecondary institutions. The WHI for Black Americans partners with the community, its Presidential Advisory Commission, and civil rights organizations to implement the objectives outlined in Executive Order (EO) 14050 effectively. In fiscal year (FY) 2024, the following successes were realized through these concerted efforts:

- The WHI for Black Americans plays a crucial role in bridging the gap between the federal government and the Black community. One of the key efforts is the Interagency Working Group (IWG) for Black Americans, which brings together more than 120 senior officials from more than 30 federal agencies to collaborate on programs, funding, and initiatives that have a meaningful impact on Black communities. Collaborations have resulted in the awarding of a record $10 billion in federal contracts to Black-owned small businesses; a more than $16 billion investment in Historically Black Colleges and Universities (HBCUs); and reduced costs for high-speed internet to more than 5.5 million Black households with the Affordable Connectivity Program.
- Power Up is a nationwide event series that aims to promote the best practices and resources necessary to advance education, equity, and economic opportunity for the Black community. In FY 2024, Power Up convenings engaged almost 3,000 Black students, educators, administrators, and business owners from across the country, including support from the Congressional Black Caucus and state and local Black mayors and legislators. The series includes youth engagement, educator and community roundtables, college and career fairs, and federal resources panels.
- A key charge of the WHI for Black Americans is to identify and promote practices that provide Black students with a rigorous, well-rounded education in safe and healthy environments. In FY 2024, the Initiative grew its virtual audience, with consistent communication to over 300,000 listserv members. The online community receives timely updates and virtual access to resources on topics like Black male educator recruitment, financial education, student civil rights, and student debt relief through the initiative's Lunch and Learn webinar series.

White House Initiative on Historically Black Colleges and Universities

The WHI on Advancing Educational Equity, Excellence, and Economic Opportunity through HBCUs (i.e., WHI-HBCUs) collaborates closely with the President's Executive Office to prioritize advancing educational equity, excellence, and economic opportunity through HBCUs. This partnership involves HBCU leaders, representatives, students, and alumni. Guided by EO 14041 and the HBCU PARTNERS Act, WHI-HBCUs is committed to strategically advancing the Department's goals. It does so by enhancing relationships across the federal government to support the growth of HBCUs and by fostering alliances with organizations that seek to promote equity and remove historical barriers.

During FY 2024, the following successes were realized through the concerted efforts of WHI-HBCUs:

- The Initiative formed an IWG with the Department of the Airforce's Chief Scientist, Chief Digital and Artificial Intelligence Office, the White House Office of Science and Technology Policy, and the Department of Commerce to explore approaches from HBCUs that lead to the development of datasets with reduced bias. The objective is to develop baseline information that will contribute to new funding opportunities that will accelerate efforts create unbiased datasets in the use of artificial intelligence and machine learning.
- In response to the passage of the *CHIPS* and *Science Act*, on February 8, 2024, in collaboration with the Georgia Institute of Technology and WHI-HBCUs, the Department of Commerce hosted the official kick-off of the HBCU CHIPS Network (i.e., the network). The network has since grown from an initial cohort of 14 HBCUs to nearly 30 public and private HBCUs and Historically Black Community Colleges across 5 regional hubs working to secure funding for semiconductor research and workforce development. Since formalizing this collaboration, the network has secured approximately $7.1 million across four awards with the goal of increasing HBCU research capacity and curriculum development aligned with semiconductor manufacturing.
- The Departments of Education and Agriculture sent a joint letter signed by our respective Secretaries to 16 Governors regarding unbalanced funding between their 1862 and 1890 land grant universities. The cumulative funding gap between the land grants totaled nearly $13 billion in state-appropriated funding. Since the release of the letter, four states—Arkansas, Maryland, Oklahoma, and West Virginia—have made efforts to begin addressing the disparity in funding.
- As the Department worked through the Better *Free Application for Federal Student Aid*® process for the 2024–2025 season, WHI-HBCUs hosted biweekly meetings between Federal Student Aid and HBCU financial aid offices from March 2024 to July 2024 to offer technical assistance and provide real-time troubleshooting. In addition to this, WHI-HBCUs hosted six webinars for contributors and students and convened two meetings with the Secretary and HBCU associations for their member schools. Additionally, WHI-HBCUs established a cadence of individual check-in calls with each of the 101 HBCUs and a meeting held three times a week with White House staff. Based on these inputs, WHI-HBCUs were able to be informed of the challenges HBCUs faced during the rollout and deployment of FSA resources to assist with solving potential issues.

White House Initiative for Advancing Education, Equity, Excellence and Economic Opportunity for Native Americans and Strengthening Tribal Colleges and Universities

The WHI for Advancing Education, Equity, Excellence and Economic Opportunity for Native Americans and Strengthening Tribal Colleges and Universities (i.e., WHI-NATCU) is a key initiative operating under the Department. Its primary goal is to lead the President's EO 14049, which was signed on October 11, 2021. The initiative aims to provide education opportunities and improve education outcomes for all American Indian and Alaska Native (AI/AN) students while promoting tribal self-determination. It works to ensure that AI/AN students, at all levels of education, receive quality education that prepares them for college, careers, and fulfilling lives, including learning their Native languages and histories. As a result of their efforts, the following achievements were realized in FY 2024:

- WHI-NATCU co-hosted an Education Summit with the California Indian Nations College, which featured California State Department of Education Supervisor Tony Thurman and Assembly Member James C. Ramos.
- WHI-NATCU assisted with a visit with the U.S. Treasurer, the first Native American to hold the position, to the Tohono O'odham Nation. The visit highlighted projects and funding the tribe received from the *American Rescue Plan Act*.
- WHI-NATCU and the Department's Office of Indian Education and Office of English Learning Acquisition co-led the 11th Annual National Native Language Summit in Palm Springs, CA. The theme was "Beyond the Decade: Inspiring a Generation of Native Language Learners." The summit had 655 participants from throughout the United States.
- WHI-NATCU assisted in securing space at the White House for the National Advisory Council on Indian Education (NACIE) to have its first in-person meeting in October 2024. NACIE has not held an in-person meeting since 2020.

Center for Faith-based and Neighborhood Partnerships

The Center for Faith-based and Neighborhood Partnerships (CFBNP) is a part of the White House Office of Faith-based and Neighborhood Partnerships, which facilitates collaborations between nonprofit organizations and the federal government. The goal of these partnerships is to provide aid to Americans in need regardless of whether the organizations are faith-based. The centers established by the office within other federal agencies help achieve this objective. CFBNP is dedicated to keeping its stakeholders informed about the various opportunities available for enhancing organizational capacity and improving student outcomes within the Department of Education. As a result of their efforts, the following achievements were realized in FY 2024:

- CFBNP serves as the primary Department representative to the Interagency Policy Committee to Counter Antisemitism, Islamophobia, and Related Forms of Discrimination and Bias. Following the October 7, 2023, Hamas attacks in Israel and the subsequent conflict, CFBNP spearheaded several actions to counter the dramatic rise in antisemitic, anti-Muslim, and anti-Arab hate in schools and on college campuses. For example, in spring 2024, the Department held a series of listening sessions with community leaders, educators, and students to hear about their concerns and how the Department could best support them.

- The center created a webpage, featured on the Department's homepage, to provide a comprehensive list of relevant resources for P–12 schools and institutions of higher education. In addition, the center led the publication of a new resource guide, "Free to Learn: Leading Inclusive Learning Environments in Higher Education." The guide provides tools to institutions of higher education for fostering safe and inclusive campuses through the Israel–Hamas conflict and beyond.
- The Department also joined eight other federal agencies in finalizing a new regulation that would restore important religious freedom protections for beneficiaries of federally funded social services. The rule is responsive to the EO President Biden signed in February 2021 reestablishing the White House Office of Faith-based and Neighborhood Partnerships, which highlighted the need to strengthen the ability of faith-based and other community organizations to deliver services effectively while also protecting the religious liberty of program beneficiaries.

The White House Initiative on Advancing Educational Equity, Excellence, and Economic Opportunity for Hispanics

The WHI on Advancing Educational Equity, Excellence, and Economic Opportunity for Hispanics is a key program dedicated to promoting equity in the American education system and fostering economic growth. The success of Hispanic and Latino students is crucial to the future prosperity and global leadership of the country, making it a top priority for the Administration. To achieve these goals, this WHI partners with community leaders and organizations as well as its Presidential Advisory Commission to execute the objectives outlined in EO 14045. The following lists highlights some of the achievements that were made through these efforts in FY 2024:

- In July 2024, President Biden signed EO 14124, creating the President's Board of Advisors on Hispanic-Serving Institutions (HSIs) and the WHI on Advancing Educational Equity, Excellence, and Economic Opportunity through HSIs. This historic action implements a priority recommendation approved by the Commission in January 2024.
- In FY 2024, the President's Advisory Commission for Hispanics approved 13 recommendations (with 79 sub-recommendations) to advance educational equity and economic opportunity for the Hispanic community.
- In September 2024, the initiative and Commissioners conducted a site visit in Puerto Rico in support of the Administration and Secretary Cardona's work prioritizing support for the island. Staff and commissioners visited various public schools and conducted roundtables focused on expanding kindergarten through grade 12 and postsecondary education opportunities, strengthening career pathways for Puerto Rican students and workers, advancing federally funded educational environmental justice efforts, increasing the Puerto Rican community's access to federal resources, and elevating student support in collaboration with business, education, and nonprofit leaders.
- Under this Administration, for the first time in history, agencies submitted in-depth action plans outlining their accomplishments for the Latino community and actions taken/needed to address systemic barriers impacting Latino and HSI engagement in federal outreach/communications, procurement, grant processes, internships, and career opportunities.

FY 2024 ANNUAL PERFORMANCE REPORT

FY 2022–FY 2026 Strategic Plan Overview

In July 2022, the Department published its *Fiscal Years 2022–2026 Strategic Plan*. Included in the plan are five strategic goals, each with supporting objectives. The Strategic Plan is a tool to communicate a clear vision of the Biden–Harris Administration's priorities related to education, and it outlines the Administration's high-level goals and objectives along with the strategies that will be used to achieve them. Also included are three Agency Priority Goals (APGs), which are two-year goals that reflect the highest priorities of the Department.

The Department is responsible for helping states, school districts, and institutions of higher education provide high-quality education to all the nation's students, especially those who are the most vulnerable and face the greatest barriers. The Department's planning, strategic goals and objectives, performance indicators and metrics, and programmatic implementation are aligned with the Department's *Fiscal Years 2022–2026 Strategic Plan*.

Performance Management

The Deputy Secretary and Performance Improvement Office facilitate strategic planning, goal setting, reporting, and monitoring to improve operations and achieve the agency's mission. The following flowchart demonstrates the Department's performance management cycle.



FY 2024 Agency Priority Goals

The Department has identified four APGs for fiscal year 2024. These APGs seek to address educator shortages and student mental health and well-being, reduce student loan delinquency, and provide support to accelerate learning outcomes.

APG	Related Strategic Objective
APG 1: Support states and local agencies in their efforts to eliminate educator shortages at every school. The Department will support states and local educational agencies in eliminating educator shortages at every school including through more effective teacher recruitment, preparation, and retention efforts. By September 30, 2025, the Department's efforts will have supported the creation of registered teacher apprenticeship programs in 35 states and doubled enrollment levels, relative to spring 2023, to more than 2,500 apprentices.	**Strategic Goal 2, Objective 2.1:** Strengthen and diversify the educator pipeline and workforce. **Strategic Goal 2, Objective 2.2:** Identify and promote evidence-based practices or strategies that support diverse districts (including rural districts) with high rates of poverty in recruiting, selecting, preparing, and retaining well-qualified (including in-field fully certified) and effective teachers, principals, paraprofessionals, and specialized instructional support personnel.
APG 2: Support states and local agencies as they invest in every student's mental health and well-being. The Department will support states and local educational agencies (LEAs) as they invest in every student's mental health and well-being. By September 30, 2025, the Department will implement 25 *Lessons from the Field* webinars to share state educational agency, LEA, and school best practices and evidence-based approaches to addressing the social, emotional, and mental health needs of prekindergarten through grade 12 students and staff and implement 1,250 high-impact activities or services to assist parents in improving mental health and well-being in their children.	**Strategic Goal 3, Objective 3.1:** Support the development and implementation of multitiered systems of supports to increase students' engagement; social, emotional, and mental health; well-being; and academic success.
APG 3: Empower students and families with financial aid information and tools that help reduce monthly payments and delinquency. By September 30, 2025, all benefits of the Saving on a Valuable Education Income-Driven Repayment Plan will be fully available to all eligible borrowers, and Federal Student Aid will establish metrics that will monitor and track borrowers' ability to select student loan repayment plans that contribute to a reduced risk of delinquency.[2]	**Strategic Goal 4, Objective 4.2:** Improve the administration of student aid programs to help eligible students receive aid; support borrowers in successfully repaying their loans, claiming loan forgiveness benefits, and mitigating student loan default; and hold contractors accountable.
APG 4: Expedite academic recovery and accelerate learning for every student. The Department will continue to give states and districts the supports they need to bring student learning back to—and beyond—prepandemic levels. By September 30, 2025, 75 percent of schools serving majority high-need students will continue to offer academically focused summer learning or enrichment programming.	**Strategic Goal 1, Objective 1.2:** Ensure all students have access to well-rounded, rigorous, engaging, and diverse learning opportunities and environments to support their success in school.

[2] On July 18, 2024, a federal court issued a stay preventing the Department from continuing operations on the Saving on a Valuable Education Income-Driven Repayment plan.

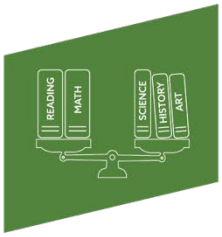
STRATEGIC GOAL 1

Promote equity in student access to educational resources, opportunities, and inclusive environments.

GOAL LEADER

Assistant Secretary, Office of Planning, Evaluation, and Policy Development





WHY IT MATTERS

To thrive academically and be globally competitive, students need an education with opportunities to build deep knowledge and useful life skills across disciplines. A comprehensive and rigorous education, however, is not accessible to all students or communities. Due to the pandemic, students are, on average, two to four months behind in reading and mathematics, with students who are of color, from low-income backgrounds, and/or presently and historically underserved even further behind. The Department is committed to bringing student learning beyond prepandemic levels and helping close underlying opportunity and achievement gaps by ensuring states and districts deploy federal pandemic relief funds in evidence-based ways, promoting promising practices, and providing technical assistance and opportunities for new or continued grant funding.

Strategic Goal 1

Objectives at a Glance

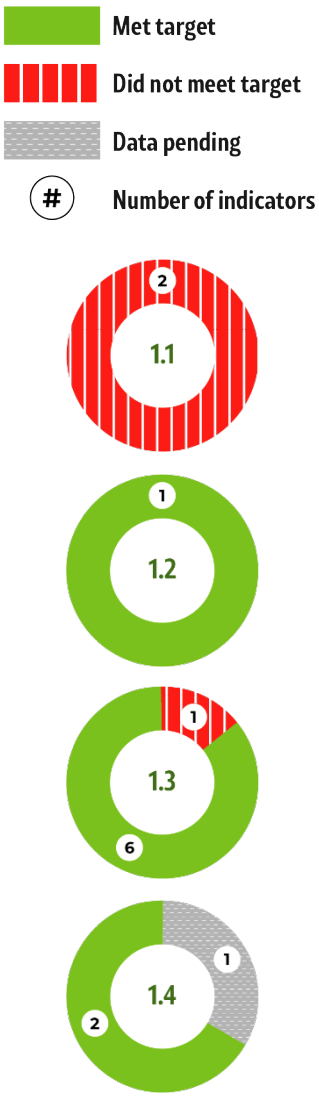
Four objectives guide the Department's work in goal 1. In fiscal year 2024, the Department assessed 13 performance indicators for this goal. Of these indicators, nine met their targets; three did not meet their targets, and one is pending available data.

1.1 Prioritize the equitable and adequate distribution of resources to communities of concentrated poverty in an effort to provide underserved students with high-quality educational opportunities.

1.2 Ensure all students have access to well-rounded, rigorous, engaging, and diverse learning opportunities and environments to support their success in school.

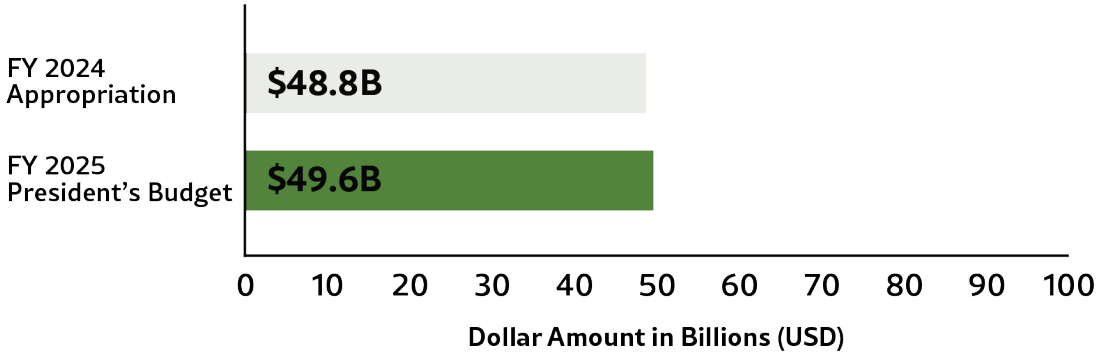
1.3 Support states, school districts, and institutions of higher education to promote and protect students' nondiscriminatory and equal access to education, as provided by Federal civil rights laws.

1.4 Promote greater access and supports for youth and adults to engage in learning, succeed in postsecondary education, and increase their employability in high-demand occupations.



Goal 1 Budgetary Resources

The following figure and table show budgetary resources and major programs and activities supporting goal 1.



Major Programs and Activities Supporting Goal 1 (in thousands)

POC	Objective	Major Programs and Activities	FY 2024 Appropriation	FY 2025 President's Budget
IES	All	Institute of Education Sciences (D)	$719,606	$734,605
OSERS	1.2	American Printing House for the Blind (D)	$43,431	$43,431
OCR	1.3	Office for Civil Rights (D)	$140,000	$162,359
OCTAE	1.4	Career, Technical, and Adult Education (D)	$2,181,436	$2,268,436
OESE	1.1	Indian Education (D)	$194,746	$194,746
OESE	1.1	Safe Schools and Citizenship Education (D)	$241,000	$291,000
OESE	1.1, 1.2, 1.3	Innovation and Improvement (D)	$942,000	$922,000
OESE	1.1, 1.4	Education for the Disadvantaged (D)	$19,107,790	$19,287,790
OESE	1.2	English Language Acquisition (D)	$890,000	$940,000
OESE	All	Impact Aid (D)	$1,625,151	$1,618,112
OESE	All	School Improvement Programs (D)	$3,586,098	$3,591,098
OPE	1.4	Higher Education (D)	$11,953	$11,953
OSERS	1.1, 1.2, 1.3	Special Education (D)	$15,277,634	$15,473,634
OSERS	1.3, 1.4	Vocational Rehabilitation Services and Training (D, M)	$3,805,068	$4,097,859

Notes: (1) Dollar amounts are estimates of program funding aligned to the strategic goal (Appendix F). As programs may support more than one strategic goal, amounts included here may be reflected in budget tables for other strategic goals. Please refer to the Department's Budget Tables for additional information on the FY 2024 Congressional Action and the FY 2025 President's Budget Request. (2) Letters following major programs and activities denote discretionary (D) or mandatory (M).
Acronyms and Definitions: POC = Principal Operating Component; FY = Fiscal Year; IES = Institute of Education Sciences; OSERS = Office of Special Education and Rehabilitative Services; OCR = Office for Civil Rights; OCTAE = Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education; OESE = Office of Elementary and Secondary Education; and OPE = Office of Postsecondary Education.

Strategic Objective 1.1

Prioritize the equitable and adequate distribution of resources to communities of concentrated poverty in an effort to provide underserved students with high-quality educational opportunities.

Strategic Objective Leader: Assistant Secretary, Office of Elementary and Secondary Education

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has two performance indicators, and both did not meet their annual targets.

Key Successes and Opportunities

Supporting Students in Greatest Need with Guidance and Resources

One critical component of the Department's work is to widely disseminate resources and information to enhance state and local efforts to ensure all students have equitable access to a high-quality education. The Department has published an unprecedented number of guidance documents to support state educational agency (SEA) and local educational agency (LEA) efforts to address the needs of all students and particularly historically underserved students. Specifically, the Office of Elementary and Secondary Education (OESE) published *School Improvement and Related Provisions under Title I, Part A of the Elementary and Secondary Education Act of 1965* in English and Spanish for public comment to describe statutory requirements; provide recommendations based on the Department's work with states; and answer frequently asked questions posed by teachers, school and LEA leaders, SEA representatives, civil rights organizations, education advocates, and policymakers.

OESE also published the guidance document *Title I, Part D of the Elementary and Secondary Education Act of 1965 Prevention and Intervention Programs for Children and Youth Who Are Neglected, Delinquent, or At-Risk* for public comment. The goal of this resource is to help states and subgrantees make the most of Title I, Part D funds; enhance educational opportunities for children and youth who are neglected, delinquent, or at-risk; and connect to and strengthen support systems that can provide sufficient resources, services, and supports to help these students succeed.

OESE published Nita M. Lowey 21st Century Community Learning Centers (CCLC) Program Title IV, Part B guidance to address services to eligible children, youth, and their families under the 21st CCLC program. In addition to these guidance documents, OESE published the following:

- Dear Colleague Letter supporting the needs of students in foster care.
- Dear Colleague Letter on how SEAs can help ensure accessibility of state and local report cards and educator equity for low-income and minority students in Title I schools.

- Resource encouraging full-service community school strategies to address chronic absenteeism.

In addition to the various resources the Department developed and disseminated, the Department's technical assistance network continues to support the field of education in substantive ways to help ensure all students have equitable access to a high-quality education. Current centers that support state and local efforts to ensure equitable access to a high-quality education include the 21st CCLC National Technical Assistance Center, the National Center for Homeless Education, and the National Technical Assistance Center for the Education of Neglected or Delinquent Children & Youth.

The Department announced a new cohort of comprehensive centers, including a national center; regional centers that align with the regions served by the Institute of Education Sciences Regional Educational Laboratories (RELs); and content centers to support English learners and multilingualism, early school success, fiscal equity, and the educator workforce. Aligning regional centers with RELs leverages the different expertise of staff, maximizes support to the field, and ensures strategic approaches are applied to provide targeted and universal technical assistance. The comprehensive centers and RELs provide complementary supports to SEAs and LEAs, and they coordinate their work.

Offering Evidence that Supports Student Achievement

As COVID-19 relief funds wind down, the Department has sought to support state and local efforts to sustain the most effective strategies implemented with those funds to ensure equitable access to a high-quality education for all students, including historically underserved students through the Strategic Planning for Continued Recovery (SPCR) initiative. The National Comprehensive Center partnered with the Department to produce and disseminate a variety of resources to support SEAs as they work with their LEAs to sustain effective investments funded by relief funds. The SPCR provided varied supports designed to meet the unique needs of SEAs and LEAs, including 6 webinars, in which more than 37 SEAs attended; 8 individual consultations; 4 cross-SEA collaboration sessions; and 3 convenings to share participant insights, resources, and lessons learned.

As the National Comprehensive Center moved forward with the SPCR, participants expressed a need for smaller, community-of-practice-level engagement with the content. As a result, the SPCR team established the following three communities of practice to help ensure maximum impact of the work occurring in SEAs and LEAs:

1. **Return-on-Investment:** SEAs (the District of Columbia, Guam, Indiana, Nebraska, Nevada, New Jersey, New York, and North Carolina) developed and implemented customized tools and processes, adapted from North Carolina's *ESSER Funding Cliff Toolkit*, to help build LEAs' capacity to determine the return on their investments and inform sustainability decisions.
2. **Trade-Off Decisions:** SEAs (Washington, Alabama, and U.S. Virgin Islands) engaged in trade-off discussions within each SEA and with their LEAs to inform financial sustainability decisions. SEA teams used tools to integrate trade-off considerations into SEA and LEA budgeting processes.
3. **Sustainability:** SEAs (Commonwealth of Northern Mariana Islands, Oklahoma, Kansas, and American Samoa) used the *After-Action Review Guide* to examine their internal processes and technical assistance supports provided to LEAs related to pandemic recovery plans. SEAs will use the information from the After-Action Review to inform decisions on how best to sustain effective practices.

The National Comprehensive Center website includes the following variety of resources aligned with the webinar topics and addressed through the cross-SEA collaboration sessions and individual consultations:

- SPCR SEA Sustainability Planning Resource
- The Investment Grid: Linking Costs and Outcomes
- *After-Action Review Guide*
- SPCR Resource Portfolios and Additional Materials

Providing Oversight of Federal Pandemic Relief and Recovery Funds

The Department distributed approximately $200 billion in funding to support primarily public kindergarten through grade 12 (K–12) education across three COVID-19 relief acts, including the *Coronavirus Aid, Relief, and Economic Security* (CARES) *Act*, the *Coronavirus Response and Consolidated Appropriations* (CRRSA) *Act*, and the A*merican Rescue Plan* (ARP) *Act*. Fiscal year (FY) 2024 activities consisted of closing out the CARES Act and CRRSA Act grant programs and finishing the period of performance for the ARP Act. Monitoring activities included biennial reviews, formal monitoring, informal monitoring, liquidation extensions, *Federal Funding Accountability and Transparency Act of 2006* (FFATA) reporting, and maintenance of equity (z).

The Department monitored programs through targeted and consolidated monitoring. In FY 2024, all 52 Elementary and Secondary School Emergency Relief (ESSER) grantees underwent monitoring to ensure compliance with federal subrecipient oversight requirements and to ensure compliance with required SEA and LEA uses of funds to address learning loss. The Department conducted five targeted monitoring events with SEAs to ensure compliance with Emergency Assistance to Non-Public Schools (EANS) requirements and to review grantees' approved late liquidation requests. The Department conducted three consolidated monitoring events, a cross-program review of SEAs' implementation of K–12 formula grants for both pandemic relief funding and *Elementary and Secondary Education Act of 1965* formula grant programs administered by OESE.

In FY 2024, the Department also continued to informally monitor all pandemic relief funds grantees through routine check-in calls and provided timely and reliable technical assistance, including support for meeting various reporting requirements. These regular check-ins also included reviews of fiscal data for all CARES ESSER and CARES Governor's Emergency Education Relief (GEER) grants in anticipation of grants being closed after the final reporting period for these funds ends in calendar year 2026. CRRSA ESSER, CRRSA EANS, and CRRSA GEER grantees without late liquidation requests also had their fiscal data regularly reviewed in anticipation of all CRRSA grants being closed in calendar year 2027.

In addition to monitoring grantees, the Department continued to provide oversight for the implementation of approved late liquidation requests by ESSER, GEER, and EANS grantees vis-à-vis the Department's exceptional process for extending the liquidation period for any pandemic relief program grant upon review of liquidation data submitted by a grantee requesting late liquidation for a grant in any covered program. This work included the review and approval of 63 CRRSA Act grantee late liquidation requests and 11 ARP Act grantee late liquidation requests, extending the opportunity for grantees to liquidate an additional $2.1 billion in pandemic relief funding for up to an additional 14 months. At the same time, the Department monitored and closed 21 CARES grantee open requests to liquidate an additional $27 million in CARES funds through March 31, 2024.

In FY 2024, the Department reviewed and approved 11 ARP ESSER state plan amendments to ensure each plan included evidence-based interventions that a state will implement to address the academic impact of lost instructional time and ensure that such interventions respond to students' academic, social, emotional, and mental health needs. The Department also reviewed and approved 21 Tydings waivers to extend the period of availability for consolidated state administrative funds so that grantees could use those consolidated funds through March 31, 2026, for the purpose of winding down ARP ESSER and ARP EANS.

The Department continued to provide technical assistance to state grantees with required FFATA reporting. FFATA requires information regarding federal awards be available to the public. The law requires that prime awardees use the Federal Subaward Reporting System to report information about their subawards and executive compensation. As of September 30, 2024, 48 of 104 ARP grants have been confirmed to be accurate and complete.

The Department supported states in implementing ARP's historic Maintenance of Equity (MOEquity) requirements, which safeguard high-poverty school districts and schools from disproportionate reductions in per-pupil state and local education aid. The Department provided one-on-one assistance to states to come into compliance with the MOEquity provisions. Almost all SEAs (51 out of 52 SEAs in FY 2022 and 50 out of 52 SEAs in FY 2023) are fully compliant with these requirements. Accordingly, 19 states made $274.2 million in supplemental payments to high-need school districts in FY 2022, and 17 states made $505.4 million in supplemental payments to high-need school districts in FY 2023.

Performance Indicators

1.1.1 Percentage of individual discretionary grant programs that include the Secretary's priority of promoting equity in student access to educational resources and opportunities (including absolute, invitational, or competitive preference priorities).

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	41%	58%	44%	55%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year (FY) 2022.
Data Source: FY 2024 Grants Policy Office Grant Competition and Early Warning Dashboard.
Period of Performance: School year 2022–2023.

1.1.2 Percentage of states publishing report cards (as of January 15 annually) that include per-pupil expenditures of federal, state, and local funds, including actual personnel expenditures and actual nonpersonnel expenditures of federal, state, and local funds disaggregated by source of funds for each local educational agency and school for either of the prior two years.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	90%	83%	83%	77%	95%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2021.
Data Source: School Support and Accountability—Title I Program Office.
Period of Performance: Report cards published as of January 15, 2024.

Strategic Objective 1.2

Ensure all students have access to well-rounded, rigorous, engaging, and diverse learning opportunities and environments to support their success in school.

Strategic Objective Leaders: Deputy Assistant Secretary, Office of Planning, Evaluation, and Policy Development and Assistant Secretary, Office of Elementary and Secondary Education

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has one performance indicator, and it met its annual target.

Key Successes and Opportunities

Providing Technical Assistance to Increase Access to Out-of-School Time

Out-of-school time enrichment activities provide an opportunity to help ensure all students have access to well-rounded learning opportunities in environments that support their academic potential and social emotional well-being. To support impactful out-of-school time activities, the Department developed and continues to implement the Engage Every Student initiative in partnership with the Afterschool Alliance, the National Association of School Superintendents, the National League of Cities, the National Summer Learning Association, and the National Comprehensive Center. The dedicated website for Engage Every Student continues to provide resources and exemplars to the field to disseminate and showcase best practices and evidence-based strategies to maximize the benefits of out-of-school time enrichment activities. In July 2024, the Engage Every Student Summit convened youth, state, and local school leaders; state and city elected officials; afterschool and summer learning program providers; and advocates to highlight best practices for out-of-school time opportunities.

In addition to Engage Every Student, the Department continues to promote strategies to support high-quality out-of-school time programming through the National Partnership for Student Success (NPSS). NPSS is a collaboration among AmeriCorps, the Everyone Graduates Center, and the Department to support ongoing recovery from the pandemic to help ensure that student performance reaches to levels before the pandemic and beyond. NPSS promotes partnerships among states, districts, and members of the educational community, including employers; colleges and universities; and state service commissions, state and local network providers, cross-sector collaboratives, youth-serving organizations, and providers of high-quality student supports. Key NPSS-supported strategies that leverage out-of-school time include high-impact tutoring, student success coaching, mentoring, and post-secondary transition coaching.

The Department also leverages its technical assistance network to support high-quality out-of-school time programming. The Institute of Education Sciences' (IES's) Regional Educational Laboratory (REL) West presented on Creating a Logic Model to Meet Program Needs for Out-of-School Time to support out-of-school time programming. In addition, RELs have published a variety of resources to support high-dosage and high-quality tutoring that can occur during out-of-school time and can support efforts to accelerate student learning. Further, the National Comprehensive Center has a suite of resources available to support high-quality out-of-school time academic enrichment activities. The regional comprehensive

centers leverage the resources and information housed on the National Comprehensive Center website to help further the reach of these valuable resources.

Developing and Disseminating Promising Practices and Evidence-based Supports and Resources

The YOU Belong in STEM initiative was launched at the Department's first-ever national summit on science, technology, engineering, and mathematics (STEM) education. YOU Belong in STEM included a new public–private partnership with Beyond100K to strengthen the national STEM educator pipeline. The initiative galvanized 275 national organizations to make commitments to advance key policy goals through actions totaling over $17 million and that will positively impact 12 million students and 100,000 STEM educators.

The Department's Best Practices Clearinghouse includes hundreds of examples of how schools are using American Rescue Plan and other funds to support academic and mental health recovery that can be helpful for school leaders and communities across the country.

The What Works Clearinghouse has produced practice guides that recommend and explain evidence-based educational practices for addressing various educational needs. RELs have also created resources in many areas, including mathematics and literacy, that help educators implement evidence-based practices and programs. Finally, IES created a summary of existing IES evidence-based resources for addressing chronic absenteeism and shared this through the RELs' dissemination efforts, with educational associations, and at the Every Day Counts Summit.

The Comprehensive Center Network created a community of practice for cross-agency teams from states and the Department that were committed to ensuring students benefit from funds that helped to advance summer learning, afterschool, and other out-of-school-time programs.

Assisting States in Ensuring All Students Have Access to a Well-Rounded Education

In fiscal year 2024, the Department continued investments and technical assistance efforts intended to ensure that all students have access to a well-rounded education. In September 2024, the Department awarded $149.6 million in new Comprehensive Literacy State Development (CLSD) grants to 23 state educational agencies. These investments support states and education partners in developing and implementing evidence-based literacy interventions and supports to help students achieve key literacy milestones, in addition to helping states, school districts, and communities promote equitable access to high-quality literacy instruction and materials for every student.

The CLSD Program also implements the CLSD National Literacy Center website to support preliteracy skills, reading, and writing for students from birth through grade 12, including students in poverty, English learners, and students with disabilities. The CLSD grants and technical assistance center can help ensure all students have access to a well-rounded education and the necessary literacy skills to be successful in all content areas. The CLSD center provided targeted technical assistance for 11 states and hosted 5 communities of practices with states through June 2024.

The Department has invested in other grant programs to support student access to a well-rounded education in environments that support their success. Specifically, the Department awarded $65.4 million in 12 new Magnet Schools Assistance Program (MSAP) grants intended to promote desegregation and support academically challenging and innovative

instructional approaches designed to bring together students from different social, economic, ethnic, and racial backgrounds in 37 schools. Grantees will use their MSAP funds to increase academic achievement, build educator capacity, increase family engagement, and foster community collaboration.

In addition, the Department awarded $1.7 million in two new Fostering Diverse Schools Demonstration grants in addition to the $20 million awarded through this program in May 2024. These grants are intended to support voluntary local and state efforts to enrich student educational experiences and create more diverse and inclusive school communities. Through the Jacob K. Javits Gifted and Talented Students Education Program, the Department is awarding $16.5 million to support coordinated research, demonstration projects, innovative strategies, and other activities to build and enhance the capacity of elementary and secondary schools to identify gifted and talented students and meet their special education needs. The Department has awarded approximately $36 million in funds through the Assistance for Arts Education Program and is promoting the integration of arts in education, with a focus on underserved and students with disabilities.

Performance Indicators

1.2.1 Number of local educational agencies who are subrecipients of American Rescue Plan Homeless Grants showing an increase in the number of students identified as homeless.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	—	45.2%	60.8%	46%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2023.
Data Source: ED*Facts* Consolidated State Performance Report.
Period of Performance: School year 2022–2023.

Strategic Objective 1.3

Support states, school districts, and institutions of higher education to promote and protect students' nondiscriminatory and equal access to education, as provided by Federal civil rights laws.

Strategic Objective Leader: Assistant Secretary, Office for Civil Rights

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has seven performance indicators. Of these indicators, six met their annual targets, and one did not meet the target. The Department has designated strategic objective 1.3 as an "Area Demonstrating Noteworthy Progress." This designation is derived from the Office of Management and Budget's guidance that provides criteria for designating at least one strategic objective for this category. This objective is being recognized for noteworthy performance because "as a result of actions being taken, the intended results or improvements in ultimate outcomes have largely been realized and represent a significant improvement in national welfare."

Key Successes and Opportunities

Promoting Equal Access to Education on the Basis of Race, Color, and National Origin

During fiscal year (FY) 2024, the Office for Civil Rights (OCR) resolved 3,707 complaints alleging discrimination on the basis of race, color, or national origin under Title VI of the *Civil Rights Act of 1964* (Title VI). Additionally, OCR issued five policy resources addressing discrimination based on race, color, and national origin, sharing information with school communities about Federal civil rights laws that protect students from discrimination on the basis of race, color, and national origin harassment. Topics these resources address include civil rights protections for students based on their shared ancestry or ethnic characteristics, protecting, for example, Jewish, Muslim, Arab, Palestinian, Israeli, and Sikh students. In May 2024, OCR issued a fact sheet highlighting the 70th anniversary of the landmark *Brown v. Board of Education* decision and summarizing OCR resources that describe the obligations to ensure equal access to education under Title VI.

OCR released multiple Civil Rights Data Collection (CRDC) reports and snapshots for the 2020–2021 school year. These publications address, for example, racial disparities in student discipline; referrals to law enforcement and school-related arrests; and access to and enrollment in mathematics, science, and computer science courses; dual enrollment or dual credit programs; and Advanced Placement courses. OCR also issued a snapshot of data addressing the experiences of English learners.

Promoting Equal Access to Education on the Basis of Sex

During FY 2024, OCR resolved 4,378 complaints alleging discrimination based on sex in violation of Title IX of the *Education Amendments of 1972* (Title IX), which prohibits discrimination on the basis of sex in education programs or activities receiving federal financial assistance. In April 2024, the Department released its Final Rule amending the Department's regulations implementing Title IX. The Final Rule protects students' nondiscriminatory and equal access to education by strengthening and clarifying protections

that address all forms of sex discrimination. The Final Rule took effect on August 1, 2024. As a result of interim rulings to date in several lawsuits, the Department is currently enjoined from enforcing the 2024 Final Rule in 26 states and a number of kindergarten through grade 12 schools and colleges and universities. Please visit www.ED.gov/TitleIX for more information.

OCR issued seven policy resources related to Title IX: (1) a fact sheet about the Final Rule; (2) a summary of the Final Rule's major provisions; (3) a resource for drafting Title IX nondiscrimination policies; (4) notices of nondiscrimination and grievance procedures; (5) a Small Entity Compliance Guide to support compliance with the Final Rule; (6) a resource explaining the updated Title IX Coordinator duties; and (7) a resource highlighting the key components of the Final Rule to aid schools in implementation and a resource describing the Title IX requirements related to pregnancy or related conditions and parental, family, or marital status.

Promoting Equal Access to Education for Students with Disabilities

During FY 2024, OCR resolved 7,164 complaints alleging discrimination on the basis of disability under Section 504 of the *Rehabilitation Act of 1973* (Section 504) and/or Title II of the *Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990*. While OCR does not enforce the *Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* (IDEA), another federal law that addresses the rights of students with disabilities in the education context, OCR does enforce Section 504 and Title II rights of IDEA-eligible students with disabilities. OCR published a snapshot of data from the CRDC for the 2020–2021 school year that revealed differences in access to educational opportunities for students with disabilities compared to their nondisabled peers. The snapshot includes data on restraint and seclusion of students with disabilities served under IDEA and served under Section 504 only; students with disabilities served under IDEA who were enrolled in mathematics, science, and computer science courses; and participation of students with disabilities served under IDEA in gifted and talented programs, dual enrollment or dual credit programs, and Advanced Placement courses.

During FY 2024, OCR released seven resources addressing the civil rights of students with a range of medical conditions, including asthma, cancer, diabetes, epilepsy, food allergies, gastroesophageal reflux or gastroesophageal reflux disease, and sickle cell disease, and four resources addressing civil rights of students with specified mental health disabilities, including anxiety disorders, depression, bipolar disorder, and eating disorders.

Performance Indicators

1.3.1 Number of policy guidance and fact sheets publications on the Office for Civil Rights' website that focus on how schools and districts serving students in prekindergarten through grade 12 and institutions of higher education may comply with Federal civil rights laws by avoiding and addressing discrimination based on race, color, national origin, disability, sex, and age.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	4	11	23	2

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Generated data reports from an internal data-collection system.
Period of Performance: October 2023–September 2024.

1.3.2 Number of published civil rights data and user-friendly summaries of key data about the experiences of students, including their access to resources and educational opportunities through the Civil Rights Data Collection.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	3	2	10	2

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Generated data reports from an internal data-collection system.
Period of Performance: October 2023–September 2024.

1.3.3 Number of proactive investigations that address possible violations of Federal civil rights laws.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	100	10	12	8

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Generated data reports from an internal data-collection system.
Period of Performance: October 2023–September 2024

1.3.4 Number of proactive outreach and technical assistance activities that provide stakeholders (e.g., students, parents and guardians, recipient educational institutions, and advocacy groups) with information concerning their rights and responsibilities under Federal civil rights laws.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	154	197	211	150

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Generated data reports from an internal data-collection system.
Period of Performance: October 2023–September 2024.

1.3.5 Percentage of complaints that are resolved within 180 days.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	79%	73%	70%	80%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Generated data reports from an internal data-collection system.
Period of Performance: October 2023–September 2024.

1.3.6 Number of annual trainings on two substantive areas related to systemic investigations.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	2	21	32	4

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Generated data reports from an internal data-collection system.
Period of Performance: October 2023–September 2024.

1.3.7 Percentage of students with disabilities who have an Individualized Educational Program who graduate from high school with a regular high school diploma.						
FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
72.7%	72.6%	76.6%	75.4%	73.63%	75.6%	75.6%

Data Source: *Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* Part B CWD Exiting (ED*Facts* File 009).
Period of Performance: July 1, 2022–June 30, 2023.

Strategic Objective 1.4

Promote greater access and supports for youth and adults to engage in learning, succeed in postsecondary education, and increase their employability in high-demand occupations.

Strategic Objective Leaders: Assistant Secretary, Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education and Assistant Secretary, Office of Postsecondary Education

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has three performance indicators. Of these indicators, two met their targets, and one is pending available data. The Department has designated strategic objective 1.4 as an "Area Demonstrating Noteworthy Progress." This designation is derived from the Office of Management and Budget's guidance that provides criteria for designating at least one strategic objective for this category. This objective is being recognized for noteworthy performance because "as a result of actions being taken, the intended results or improvements in ultimate outcomes have largely been realized and represent a significant improvement in national welfare."

Key Successes and Opportunities

Building an Evidence Base

The Department recognizes the need for high-quality data to identify inequities and develop solutions for supporting career, technical, and adult education. The Department published *Workforce Innovation and Opportunity Act* (WIOA) guidance—produced jointly across the Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education (OCTAE), the Office of Special Education and Rehabilitative Services, and the U.S. Department of Labor. This guidance describes two key changes to how the adult education programs evaluate measurable skill gains (MSGs). States may now report MSGs for participants who are enrolled in a program below the postsecondary level and who enroll in state-recognized postsecondary education or training during the program year. In other words, an exit from the adult education program is no longer required for this MSG type. Second, and in response to public comments OCTAE received during the recent renewal of the Adult Education National Reporting System (NRS) information collection, the Department described a new MSG type, enabling states to report an MSG for participants who pass a subtest on a state-recognized high school equivalency examination.

Following solicitation of public comment and renewal of its information collection, the Adult Education NRS deployed a multipronged approach to support state and local implementation of NRS performance accountability policy changes. This approach included the 2024 NRS Regional Training Series, a three-day convening held in New Orleans, LA; Phoenix, AZ; and Crystal City, VA. OCTAE used this series to help states with the following activities: analyzing data and evaluating options for implementing assessment alternatives in programs designed to result in MSGs other than pretest–posttest gain; reviewing steps for decision-making and change management that may help inform approaches to alternative educational placement and performance accountability; and identifying potential consequences, challenges, and considerations to inform comprehensive strategies for program implementation.

This series followed an April 2024 webinar that provided a review of the most recent changes to the NRS accountability provisions and the timeline for implementing the reporting changes. During a national meeting of state directors in May 2024, OCTAE provided an intensive institute session on changes to the NRS accountability framework with a special focus on the MSG indicator and how these changes could impact performance. These national events (among others) helped state-level adult education staff—including directors, assistant directors, data, and professional development staff—guide identification and selection of program strategies for adult education. These strategies have attendant benefits for adult-education student achievement of MSGs.

Similarly, through its Data Quality Institute, OCTAE continued to provide state career and technical education (CTE) directors and staff with opportunities to learn strategies to improve data and accountability systems while also focusing on strategies to address disparities and gaps in performance among CTE concentrators. In September 2024, OCTAE held a three-day convening in the District of Columbia, bringing together 120 state CTE leaders and their staff across 42 states to focus efforts to improve Perkins data quality and use. OCTAE also provided states with robust data dashboards, allowing them to analyze disaggregated CTE performance data to identify gaps.

Unlocking Career Success

The Department continued to reimagine how U.S. high schools prepare all students to thrive in their future careers in an effort to support public and private sector leaders, government agencies, and others to help students earn postsecondary degrees and industry credentials that employers need and that the economy demands. The Unlocking Career Success (UCS) initiative blurs the lines between high school, college, and career, providing students with accelerated and innovative opportunities to earn college credits and gain real-world career experiences. OCTAE provided actionable steps—through the Unlocking Pathways State Policy Heat Map—for policymakers and the public about how state policies can impact career pathways programs. This tool includes 20 policies that are essential to cohesive career-connected ecosystems and shows how many of these policies each state has enacted. It also highlights how state policies can impact career pathways programs across the four keys of UCS: dual enrollment, work-based learning, workforce credentials, and career advising and navigation.

OCTAE released several playbooks to support specific underserved populations—adult learners, English learners, and individuals with disabilities. The playbooks provide strategies and tactics to schools, community-based organizations, businesses, and other governmental and nongovernmental entities to support these populations. The actions offered are tailored to these stakeholders and target populations. Such actions include how to strategically leverage federal funds; incorporate tools for students, families, and educators; consider local and state policies, processes, programs, and practices; and understand labor market needs. Each playbook includes statutory and background information for context, actions for stakeholders, and additional resources.

Innovating Solutions for Engagement

The Department continued to develop tools to better support traditionally underserved populations using strategies that optimize impact based on available resources. In the United States, 43 million Americans—nearly 1 in 5 adults—read at or below a third-grade level, and only a small portion of these adults have access to adult education programs and training opportunities. While technology has the potential to augment existing services, most current educational technology products are designed for kindergarten-through-

grade-12 students or colleges—not for adult learners, a diverse group that includes adults who have not completed high school and adults who are learning English. Through the Future Finder Challenge, OCTAE sponsored an open innovation, $1 million prize competition seeking creative solutions by innovators to create digital career-navigation tools for adult learners. In December 2023, the Department announced its grand-prize winner—Gladeo, a minority- and women-owned public benefit corporation based in Los Angeles, CA—and runner-up—Workbay, a women-owned business in Franklin, TN.

During a post-challenge deployment phase, the Department provided hands-on, customized support to help these winning teams scale their solutions as well as gain visibility and recognition across the adult education ecosystem. This support included connecting both teams to a broad network of subject-matter experts and helping them prepare presentations for the Coalition on Adult Basic Education 2024 Conference and the Department-sponsored Annual State Directors Meeting. This assistance was critical, as both winning teams were new to serving adult learners and valued the infrastructure of support to navigate this complex space. Gladeo and Workbay are currently working with a range of partners to expand access to their tools across the adult education sector.

Additional examples of innovating solutions for engagement—including the Career Z Challenge, the Your Place in Space Challenge, and the Employability Skills Framework 2.0—can also be found in strategic objective 4.3.

Engaging Minority-Serving Institutions

The Office of Postsecondary Education (OPE) conducted 171 outreach engagements and 166 technical assistance engagements to increase the participation of Historically Black Colleges and Universities (HBCUs), Tribally Controlled Colleges and Universities, minority-serving institutions (MSIs), and community colleges in federal grant competitions. These engagements included webinars, site visits, meetings with institutions, speaking engagements, and other types of interactions. Topics focused on issues such as increasing college completion and closing attainment gaps among underserved populations. The International and Foreign Language Education office leadership and staff actively participate in meetings of the White House Initiative (WHI) on HBCUs Interagency Cluster for International Affairs and share information about funding opportunities.

The total number of MSIs eligible to apply for grants that require MSI status grew to 894 in FY 2024. This rate surpasses OPE's performance measure goal of increasing this number to 870 in 2024. While OPE has little direct control over the number of institutions that meet the qualifying factors to be considered an MSI, OPE's technical assistance and outreach to institutions makes an impact on their knowledge of the process and benefits of seeking MSI designation—especially for institutions that may not have considered applying under the waiver process. The OPE Higher Education Programs Office has hosted five technical assistance sessions specifically to discuss eligibility for grant programs under Titles III and V of the *Higher Education Act of 1965* for FY 2024, increasing awareness of the process for being designated as an MSI. OPE partners with the WHI for Tribally Controlled Colleges and Universities and is working to develop relationships and inform more institutions of the availability of grant programs.

In addition, many of OPE's outreach and technical assistance engagements include messages about availability of grants for MSIs and information on the application procedures and processes. OPE has co-hosted several outreach engagements with other organizations and federal agencies to highlight opportunities in other federal grant programs outside the department that are available specifically to MSIs.

Performance Indicators

1.4.1 Percentage of adult education participants that achieve measurable skill gains (reporting for Native American and Alaska Native, Hispanic or Latino, Asian, Black or African American, Native Hawaiian or other Pacific Islander, White, and more than one race).

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	40.96%	43.06%	TBD	43%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year (FY) 2022. FY 2024 data are expected in February 2025.
Data Source: National Reporting System for adult education annual program performance report from grantee submissions (Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education).
Period of Performance: July 1, 2023–June 30, 2024.

1.4.2 Percentage of disaggregated student categories for which secondary career and technical education concentrators meet 90% of the average state determined performance level for secondary students being placed in postsecondary education; advanced training; military service; national, community service, or Peace Corps; or employment.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	69.7%	75.2%	80.7%	70.5%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Federal Eligibility Matrix results.
Period of Performance: Program year 2022–2023.

1.4.3 Number of eligible minority-serving institutions that can apply for competitive grant programs that contribute to student success, including access, support services, retention, and outreach.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	808	840	862	894	870

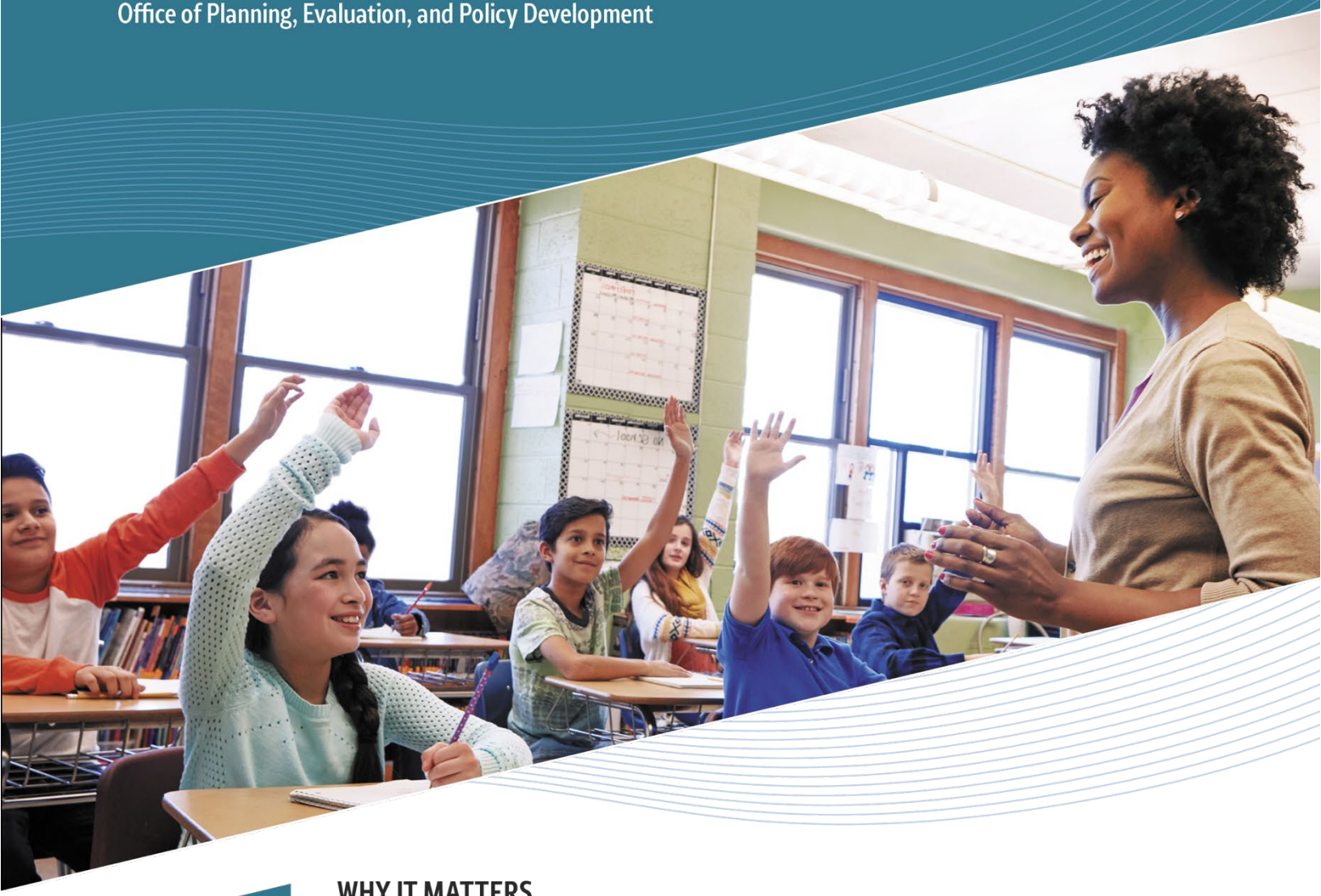
Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2021.
Data Source: Federal Eligibility Matrix results.
Period of Performance: October 2023–September 2024.

STRATEGIC GOAL 2

Support a diverse and talented educator workforce and professional growth to strengthen student learning.

GOAL LEADER

Senior Advisor, Office of the Deputy Secretary and Assistant Secretary, Office of Planning, Evaluation, and Policy Development



WHY IT MATTERS

Every student should have access to outstanding, well-prepared, well-supported educators who reflect the diversity of the students they serve. As a result of the historic investments in the *American Rescue Plan*, states and school districts have made significant progress in eliminating educator shortages and advancing strategies that will strengthen and diversify our educator pipeline. There are now more people working in public schools than before the pandemic, including 40 percent more social workers and 25 percent more nurses, providing critical supports to students that also help lessen burdens on teachers. The Department also is supporting efforts to better prepare, develop, and retain talented and diverse educators in America's schools. Increasing teacher compensation is critical to effectively recruiting and retaining the teachers that schools need. While teacher pay has not kept up with inflation, average salaries increased by 4.1 percent from 2021–2022 to 2022–2023, double the increase from the prior year. An additional 3.1 percent increase is projected to have occurred from 2022–2023 to 2023–2024. This potentially totals a 7.2 percent increase over two years.

Strategic Goal 2

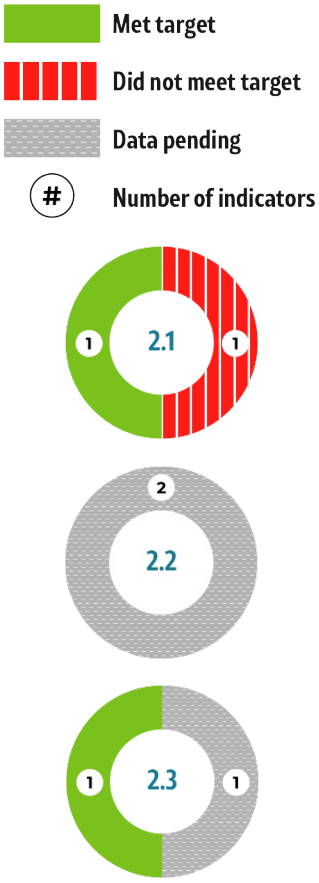
Objectives at a Glance

Three objectives guide the Department's work in goal 2. In fiscal year 2024, the Department assessed six performance indicators for this goal. Of these indicators, two met their targets; one did not meet the target, and three are pending available data.

2.1 Strengthen and diversify the educator pipeline and workforce.

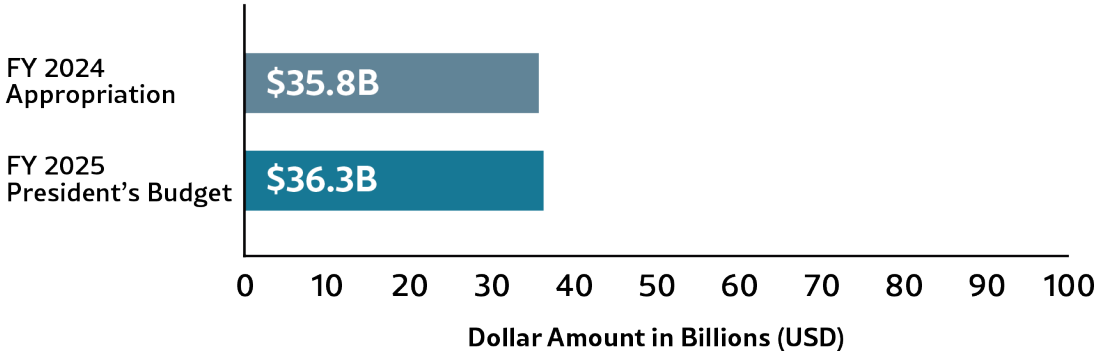
2.2 Identify and promote evidence-based practices or strategies that support diverse districts (including rural districts) with high rates of poverty in recruiting, selecting, preparing, and retaining well-qualified (including in-field fully certified) and effective teachers, principals, paraprofessionals, and specialized instructional support personnel.

2.3 Support the professional growth, retention, and advancement of talented, experienced educators and other school personnel and their capacity to meet the social, emotional, mental health, and academic needs of underserved students.



Goal 2 Budgetary Resources

The following figure and table show budgetary resources and major programs and activities supporting goal 2.



Major Programs and Activities Supporting Goal 2 (in thousands)

POC	Objective	Major Programs and Activities	FY 2024 Appropriation	FY 2025 President's Budget
FSA	2.1	Health Education Assistance Loans Liquidating Account (M)	-	-
FSA	2.1, 2.3	Teacher Education Assistance for College and Higher Education (M)	$38,920	$39,188
IES	All	Institute of Education Sciences (D)	$131,306	$136,306
OELA	2.2	English Language Acquisition (D)	$62,011	$79,524
OESE	2.2	Indian Education: Special Programs for Indian Children (D)	$72,000	$72,000
OESE	2.1, 2.2, 2.3	Innovation and Improvement (D)	$150,000	$263,000
OESE	2.1, 2.2, 2.3	School Improvement Programs (D)	$2,190,080	$2,190,080
OPE	2.1, 2.2	Higher Education (D)	$85,000	$125,000
OSERS	2.2, 2.3	Vocational Rehabilitation Training (D)	$29,388	$23,388
OSERS	2.2, 2.3	Special Education (D)	$14,367,334	$14,557,334
OESE	All	Education for the Disadvantaged (D)	$18,630,802	$18,810,802

Notes: (1) Dollar amounts are estimates of program funding aligned to the strategic goal (Appendix F). As programs may support more than one strategic goal, amounts included here may be reflected in budget tables for other strategic goals. Please refer to the Department's Budget Tables for additional information on FY 2024 Congressional Action and the FY 2025 President's Budget Request. (2) Negative dollar amounts (indicated by values in parentheses) represent a downward re-estimate for the program. (3) Letters following major programs and activities denote discretionary (D) or mandatory (M).
Acronyms and Definitions: POC = Principal Operating Component; FY = Fiscal Year; FSA = Federal Student Aid; IES = Institute of Education Sciences; OELA = Office of English Language Acquisition; OESE = Office of Elementary and Secondary Education; OPE = Office of Postsecondary Education; and OSERS = Office of Special Education and Rehabilitative Services.

Strategic Objective 2.1

Strengthen and diversify the educator pipeline and workforce.

Strategic Objective Leaders: Assistant Secretary, Office of Postsecondary Education and Assistant Secretary, Office of Elementary and Secondary Education

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has two performance indicators. Of these indicators, one met its target, while one did not.

Strengthening and diversifying the educator workforce requires addressing the educator shortages that were exacerbated by the pandemic and the underlying challenges that have historically resulted in these challenges. In just three months in 2020, local public schools lost 730,000 employees, 9 percent of the total workforce. The $130 billion in American Rescue Plan (ARP) funds provided critical resources to states and school districts that provided fiscal certainty so that districts could retain and hire staff and supported direct investments in staffing. While the Department awaits final spending reports, an analysis of district spending plans indicated they planned to spend $30 billion of these resources on staffing, including recruitment, retention, hiring, and professional learning to support staff as they addressed the significant academic, social, emotional, and mental health needs of students.

As of spring of the 2023–2024 school year, there were once again more individuals working in local public education than before the pandemic. The full impact of the fall 2024 expiration of Elementary and Secondary School Emergency Relief funds remains to be seen, as staffing varies based on local budgeting decisions. At the national level, as of fall of the 2024–2025 school year, staffing levels held steady despite the expiration of these funds. Initial data suggests these levels were higher than at any point in the last decade, reflecting districts continuing to prioritize staffing as they made budgeting decisions while approaching the expiration without the support of ARP funds.

Ensuring all schools have the staff they need, including schools serving rural and low-income communities and those with higher shares of students of color, which have been disproportionately impacted by staffing shortages both before and since the pandemic, requires addressing fundamental challenges facing the profession that result in these shortages. This is particularly urgent, as while the total number of individuals working in local public schools exceeds prepandemic levels, there are still fewer teachers than before the pandemic. To address these challenges facing the profession, the Department has focused its efforts to eliminate educator shortages on five key strategies, as outlined in the graphic below.



In fiscal year (FY) 2024, the Department awarded a grant under the Comprehensive Center Program to create a new Center on Strengthening and Supporting the Educator Workforce, which supports efforts across these strategies. This center will support states and local educational agencies (LEAs) to improve educator recruitment and retention and increase educator diversity, including through increased compensation and improved working conditions; expanded high-quality and affordable educator pathways including high-quality residencies, Grow Your Own programs, and registered apprenticeship programs for teachers; enhanced opportunities for teacher leadership and career advancement; and ongoing professional learning at the start of and throughout educators' careers.

Key Successes and Opportunities

Expanding High-Quality and Affordable Pathways into Teaching

As it works to strengthen the pipeline into teaching, the Department has focused its efforts on expanding and creating programs that reduce the financial barriers to entering the profession and that include robust classroom experience for teacher candidates before they become teacher of record. This includes through expanding teacher residency, Grow Your Own (GYO) and registered apprenticeship programs for teachers. GYO programs encourage members of the community—from high school students to paraprofessionals and other career changers—to pursue teaching careers while also enhancing educator diversity, reflecting the Department's interest in learning from applicants proposing GYO projects.

Annual funding for the Teacher Quality Partnership (TQP) Program, which can support all three of these models, has increased by 34 percent since the beginning of the Biden–Harris Administration, or $18 million. In FY 2024, the Department awarded $28 million in 18 new TQP grants. The TQP Program funds teacher preparation programs in high-need communities at colleges and universities for the undergraduate "fifth year" level and for teaching residency programs for individuals new to teaching with strong academic and professional

backgrounds. The central feature of all TQP grantees is a strong partnership between the teacher preparation program and the school districts they serve, which is often facilitated by mentor teachers that coach and prepare incoming educators.

In addition, numerous awardees responded to an invitational priority, focused on the establishment of GYO and registered apprenticeship programs for teachers.

Registered apprenticeship programs for teachers break down the financial barriers to entering the teacher profession by allowing individuals to "earn while they learn," often supporting individuals like current paraprofessionals in earning their bachelor's degree and teacher's license at significantly reduced costs while working in the classroom. As of September 2024, registered apprenticeship programs for teachers are authorized in 45 states, the District of Columbia, and Puerto Rico and enroll over 2,900 apprentices. There were no registered apprenticeship programs for kindergarten through grade 12 teachers at the beginning of the Administration in 2021. This progress is a result of a strategic partnership between the Department and the U.S. Department of Labor to expand these programs.

Demonstrating its commitment to strengthening the pipeline of special education teachers and professionals, the Department has increased its annual funding for the Personnel Preparation Grant Program from $90 million in FY 2021 to $115 million in FY 2024 for this *Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* (IDEA) Part D program.

In May and June 2024, leaders from 25 states, the District of Columbia, and American Samoa gathered at three Regional Convenings to Support State Action to Advance the Education Professions held in Albuquerque, NM; Chicago, IL; and Jackson, MS, to share bold efforts and leadership underway across states to increase educator compensation, expand access to high-quality and affordable pathways into the profession, and increase educator diversity. The convenings were held by the Department in partnership with TEACH.org and The Hunt Institute.

Increasing the Diversity of the Educator Pipeline and Workforce

Increasing educator diversity can help improve student outcomes and eliminate educator shortages by recruiting and developing talent from all our communities. In fall 2023, the Department released Raise the Bar Policy Brief on Eliminating Educator Shortages through Increasing Educator Diversity and Addressing High-Need Shortage Areas, which included new data visualizations of educator diversity and shortage areas by state, particularly highlighting the widespread shortage of special education teachers. The brief also highlighted Department resources that can be used to increase educator diversity and identify shortage areas.

In FY 2024, the Department prioritized efforts to increase educator diversity across 23 competitive grant programs, awarding more than $450 million to date to over 350 grantees working to increase educator diversity across 47 states, the District of Columbia, Puerto Rico, and Guam. Programs awarding funds in FY 2024 that are specifically designed to increase educator diversity include the following:

- The Department awarded an additional $14.8 million in grants from the Augustus F. Hawkins Centers of Excellence Program, which invests in high-quality educator preparation programs at Historically Black Colleges and Universities (HBCUs), Tribally Controlled Colleges and Universities (TCCUs), and minority-serving institutions (MSIs, including Hispanic-serving institutions, with a state-accredited teacher preparation program. The program helps increase the number of well-prepared teachers,

including teachers of color, resulting in a more diverse teacher workforce prepared to teach in our Nation's low-performing elementary and secondary schools and close achievement gaps.

- The Department invested $8 million in the National Professional Development Program, which supports preservice training programs for teachers, paraprofessionals, administrators, and aspiring educators, including high school students (i.e., through dual enrollment and early college programs) who want to become fully certified as bilingual or multilingual educators. Annual funding for this program has increased by $6 million, or 12 percent, since the beginning the Biden–Harris Administration.
- The Department also awarded grants under the Promoting Postbaccalaureate Opportunities for Hispanic Americans (PPOHA) Grant Program, which included an invitational priority for projects that are designed to establish or expand entry points into the Hispanic educator pipeline, increase the number of Hispanic educators, increase the number of Hispanic students earning postgraduate degrees in preparation for employment as an educator, or both. In 2024, the PPOHA Program received 74 applications for review. Of the eligible applications, 35 applicants addressed the invitational priority. Of the 16 grantees in the PPOHA Program, 5 of them addressed the invitational priority.
- Utilizing IDEA Part D funds, the Department launched a new National Center on HBCUs, TCCUs, and MSIs to Diversify the Workforce Serving Children with Disabilities.

Promoting Educator Diversity Through Technical Assistance and Partnerships

In FY 2024, the Department also supported states, provided technical assistance, and utilized partnerships to increase educator diversity.

The Department developed new guidance on increasing educator diversity, released in FY 2025, which outlines why educator diversity matters, evidence-based strategies state educational agencies and LEAs can use to increase educator diversity, and the federal funds that can support these efforts.

At the Regional Convenings to Support State Action to Advance the Education Professions, representatives from Washington, Colorado, Illinois, Massachusetts, and Mississippi presented on their efforts to increase educator diversity that are increasing the number of teachers of color in their states.

In partnership with TEACH.org and One Million Teachers of Color, the Department launched a Public Service Announcement campaign, Teachers: Leaders Shaping Lives, which elevates the teaching profession and promotes educator diversity. Additional resources on the campaign are available here.

Throughout FY 2024, Regional Educational Laboratory (REL) Mid-Atlantic worked with New Jersey to increase teacher diversity. The REL partnered with the New Jersey Department of Education to develop and facilitate a coaching series to 10 local school districts to help them build their capacity to make data-informed decisions and implement research-based practices that promote increased hiring of teachers of color. The REL also facilitated a coaching series that built the capacity of state leaders to train districts on culturally responsive hiring practices. REL Midwest continued to partner with school districts across Minnesota to cultivate and sustain school culture and working conditions that increase the retention of teachers of color and Indigenous teachers.

Performance Indicators

2.1.1 Percentage of participants in teacher preparation projects funded under the Indian Education Professional Development Grants Program who become teachers in local educational agencies that serve a high proportion of Indian students.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	36%	37%	41%	46%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Office of Indian Education: Professional Development—*Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) Measure.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

2.1.2 Percentage of individual discretionary grant programs that include a priority (i.e., absolute, competitive, or invitational priority) that advances educator diversity.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	19%	31%	56%	22%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year (FY) 2022.
Data Source: Office of Elementary and Secondary Education Discretionary Grant Tracking (Grants Published).
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

Strategic Objective 2.2

Identify and promote evidence-based practices or strategies that support diverse districts (including rural districts) with high rates of poverty in recruiting, selecting, preparing, and retaining well-qualified (including in-field fully certified) and effective teachers, principals, paraprofessionals, and specialized instructional support personnel.

Strategic Objective Leaders: Deputy Assistant Secretary, Office of Planning, Evaluation, and Policy Development and Director, Institute of Education Sciences

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has two performance indicators. Both indicators are pending available data.

Providing competitive compensation throughout educators' careers is critical to not only recruiting but also retaining well-qualified and effective staff. However, teachers are consistently underpaid, earning 26 percent less than their similarly educated peers. The President, Vice President and Secretary have consistently called for teachers to be paid more. The Department has outlined how its resources can support these efforts and highlighted best practices by states that are increasing teacher pay.

Building on efforts in previous fiscal years, in summer 2024, the Department convened cross-sector teams from 25 states and territories plus the District of Columbia to highlight states taking bold action to strengthen the educator workforce by increasing educator compensation, expanding access to high-quality and affordable educator preparation, and increasing educator diversity. State leaders learned from others operating in a variety of political and legal contexts about successful efforts to dramatically increase teacher pay in New Mexico, Nevada, and Mississippi.

The federal government, states, and local communities have mobilized around this effort. Since 2021, 30 states, the District of Columbia, and Puerto Rico have taken action to increase teacher pay. Nationwide, average teacher pay has increased by an estimated 9.5 percent since 2021.

The Department has also increased the monthly disposable income of educators by fixing the Public Service Loan Forgiveness Program. As of September 2024, it canceled $69 billion in student debt for over 947,000 borrowers.

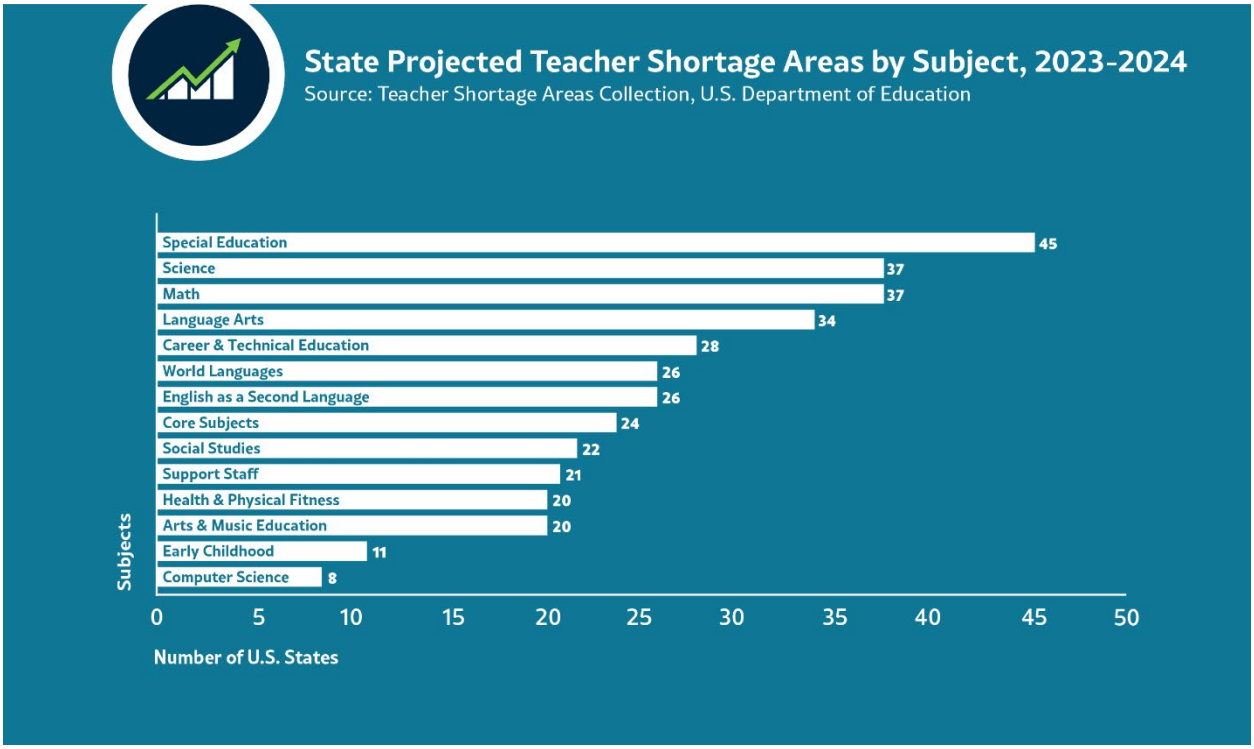
Key Successes and Opportunities

Providing Resources to Recruit, Retain, and Support Education Professionals in Underserved Communities

In fiscal year (FY) 2024, the Department invested more than $2 billion in federal funds through the Supporting Effective Instruction State Grants (Title II, Part A) to address inequities in access to effective teachers for underserved students, provide professional development, reduce class sizes, improve teacher recruitment and preparation, increase the diversity of the teacher workforce, and conduct a range of other activities.

In FY 2024, the Department also worked to support state educational agencies and local educational agencies (LEAs) in more effectively using these funds by developing guidance on how these entities can strategically use Title II, Part A funds to advance the Department's five key strategies for eliminating educator shortages, as outlined previously, and released updated frequently asked questions on Title II, Part A funds. These two resources were developed in FY 2024 and released in early FY 2025.

In addition, to increase the number of highly effective educators, the Department invested $90 million in FY 2024 to support the implementation of evidence-based practices that prepare, develop, or enhance the skills of educators through the Supporting Effective Educator Development Program. Annual funding for this program has increased by 12 percent, or $10 million, since the beginning of the Biden-Harris Administration.



Providing Technical Assistance and Evidence-Based Practices

In FY 2024, the Department awarded a grant under the Comprehensive Center Program to create a new Center on Strengthening and Supporting the Educator Workforce. This center will support states and LEAs to improve educator recruitment and retention and increase educator diversity, including through increased compensation and improved working conditions; expanded high-quality and affordable educator pathways including high-quality residencies, Grow Your Own programs, and registered apprenticeship programs for teachers; enhanced opportunities for teacher leadership and career advancement; and ongoing professional learning at the start of and throughout educators' careers.

Performance Indicators

2.2.1 Percentage of candidates in teacher preparation programs who become teachers of record.						
FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	90%	92%	TBD	94%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Effective Educator Development Programs: Teacher Quality Partnership—*Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) and Grantee Summaries.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

2.2.2 Number of qualified teachers and school leaders retained in high-needs schools, including those who were recruited through teacher residency programs.						
FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	16,551	66,799	TBD	67,000

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Effective Educator Development Programs: Teacher and School Leader Incentive Program—*Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) Measure and Grantee Summaries.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

Strategic Objective 2.3

Support the professional growth, retention, and advancement of talented, experienced educators and other school personnel and their capacity to meet the social, emotional, mental health, and academic needs of underserved students.

Strategic Objective Leader: Assistant Secretary, Office of Elementary and Secondary Education

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has two performance indicators. Of these indicators, one met its annual target, and one is pending available data.

Key Successes and Opportunities

In fiscal year (FY) 2024, the Department awarded a grant under the Comprehensive Center Program to create a new Center on Strengthening and Supporting the Educator Workforce, which supports efforts critical to this strategic objective. This center will support states and local educational agencies (LEAs) to improve educator recruitment and retention and increase educator diversity, including through increased compensation and improved working conditions; expanded high-quality and affordable educator pathways including high-quality residencies, Grow Your Own programs, and registered apprenticeship programs for teachers; enhanced opportunities for teacher leadership and career advancement; and ongoing professional learning at the start of and throughout educators' careers.

Outlining Components of Good Jobs in Education

Retaining talented and experienced educators requires that education jobs be good jobs. In FY 2024, the Department released the Good Jobs Principles for Education in partnership with the Department of Labor's Good Jobs Initiative. The following principles provide a vision of job quality in a modern education system:

- **Recruitment and Hiring:** Qualified applicants are actively recruited—especially from underrepresented or underserved communities, including individuals with disabilities. The application and hiring processes are fully accessible and free from discrimination, including unequal treatment. The employer refrains from the use of selection criteria that are unrelated to effective preparation for the role and skills needed to succeed, including educational requirements, licensure, or other legal requirements. The employer complies with Federal civil rights laws that prohibit discrimination based on disability, race, color, national origin, age, and sex, including gender identity and sexual orientation.
- **Pay:** All employees are paid a competitive wage. Workers' pay is fair, transparent, equitable, and comparable to compensation for similarly skilled and experienced workers. Workers' wages increase with increased skills, responsibilities, and years of experience and also increase with the cost of living (discussed more in strategic objective 2.2)
- **Benefits:** Full-time and part-time employees are provided family-sustaining benefits that promote economic security and mobility. These benefits include health insurance, a retirement plan, workers' compensation benefits, and work–family benefits such as paid sick and parental leave and caregiving supports. Employees are

empowered and encouraged to use these benefits, including, for educators, through the provision of adequate classroom coverage.

- **Diversity, Equity, Inclusion, and Accessibility (DEIA):** All employees have equal opportunity. Employees are respected, empowered, and treated fairly. DEIA is a core value and practiced norm in the workplace. Individuals from underrepresented communities do not face systemic barriers or discrimination in the workplace.
- **Empowerment and Representation:** Employees can engage in protected, concerted activity, such as joining a union, without fear of retaliation. Opportunities are provided for employees to contribute to decisions about their work and how it is performed.
- **Job Security and Working Conditions:** Employees have a safe, healthy, and accessible workplace. Employees have job security without arbitrary or discriminatory discipline or dismissal. They have dedicated planning and collaboration time, adequate hours, and predictable schedules. Employees are free from harassment, discrimination, and retaliation at work. Workers are properly classified under applicable laws.
- **Organizational Culture:** All employees are valued, contribute meaningfully to the organization, are provided adequate resources and supports (including technology tools and reasonable accommodations, as appropriate for their disability), and are engaged and respected, especially by leadership.
- **Skills and Career Advancement:** Employees receive effective orientation, training, mentoring, and job-embedded professional learning throughout their careers. Employees have access to career advancement opportunities, equitable opportunities, and tools to progress to future jobs.

The FY 2024 Education Innovation and Research Program's competition for Early- and Mid-Phase and Expansion Grants included an absolute priority for projects focused on educator recruitment and retention. These projects aim to enhance the ability of schools to recruit and retain staff through strategies such as supporting educator well-being as well as structuring staffing and schedules to ensure educators and students are appropriately supported and have sufficient time for planning, collaborating, working with coaches, and observing instruction of other educators.

Providing Evidence-Based Professional Development Strategies

The Department invested more than $2 billion in federal funds through the Supporting Effective Instruction State Grants (Title II, Part A) to address inequities in access to effective teachers for underserved students, provide professional development, reduce class sizes, improve teacher recruitment and preparation, increase the diversity of the teacher workforce, and a range of other activities.

The Department also worked to support state and local educational agencies in more effectively using these funds by developing guidance on how these entities can strategically use Title II, Part A funds to advance the Department's five key strategies for eliminating educator shortages, as outlined previously, including providing effective new teacher induction and ongoing professional learning throughout educators' careers and supporting teacher leadership and career advancement opportunities for teachers. The Department released updated FAQs on Title II, Part A funds. These two resources were developed in FY 2024 and released in early FY 2025.

Teacher Leadership and Career Advancement

Providing opportunities for teachers to lead beyond their classroom allows teachers to maximize their impact on students and provides opportunities for teachers to advance in their careers, including earning additional compensation, without leaving the classroom.

A key program that supports teacher leadership and career advancement opportunities for teachers is the Teacher and School Leader Incentive Program. The Department requested $200 million for this program in its FY 2024 budget request, a $27 million increase over the FY 2023 funding level. Unfortunately, the final funding bill for FY 2024 included a $113 million cut to this program, undermining the Department's efforts to expand teacher leadership and career advancement opportunities.

Performance Indicators

2.3.1 Percentage of educators participating in leadership preparation programs.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	87%	85%	TBD	88%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year (FY) 2022. FY 2024 data are expected in February 2025.
Data Source: Effective Educator Development Programs: Supporting Effective Educator Development—*Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) Measure.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

2.3.2 Percentage of local educational agencies indicating that one of their top two uses of Title II, Part A professional development funds is for professional development that is sustained, job-embedded, and/or collaborative.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	32%	26%	43%	36%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: School Support and Accountability—Title II Program *Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) Measure.
Period of Performance: School year 2022–2023.

STRATEGIC GOAL 3

Meet students' social, emotional, and academic needs.

GOAL LEADER

Senior Advisor, Office of the Deputy Secretary



WHY IT MATTERS

When students feel connected to school, their mental health and academic performance improve. The consequences of the pandemic—social isolation, illness, and family hardship among them—have led to decreased feelings of connectedness for students. The Department is committed to working with parents, families, educators, and others to meet students' mental health needs. We are assisting state and local leaders to grow the knowledge and skills of professionals currently in schools, expand the supply of mental health professionals who work with students in schools, and increase access to funding through the Medicaid program to support school health services, including mental health services.

Strategic Goal 3

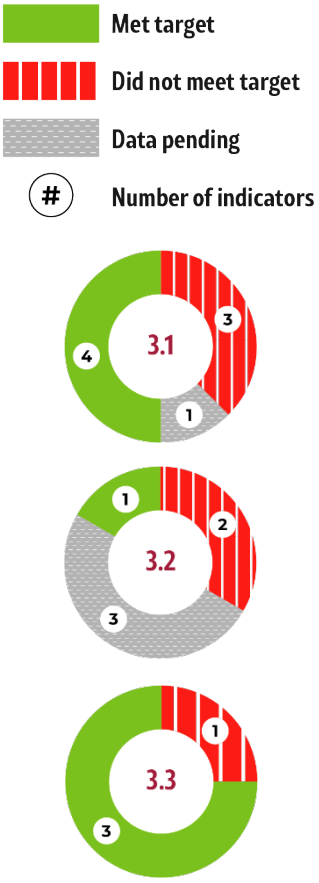
Objectives at a Glance

Three objectives guide the Department's work in goal 3. In fiscal year 2024, the Department assessed 18 performance indicators for this goal. Of these indicators, eight met their targets; six did not meet their targets, and four are pending available data.

3.1 Support the development and implementation of multitiered systems of supports to increase students' engagement; social, emotional, and mental health; well-being; and academic success.

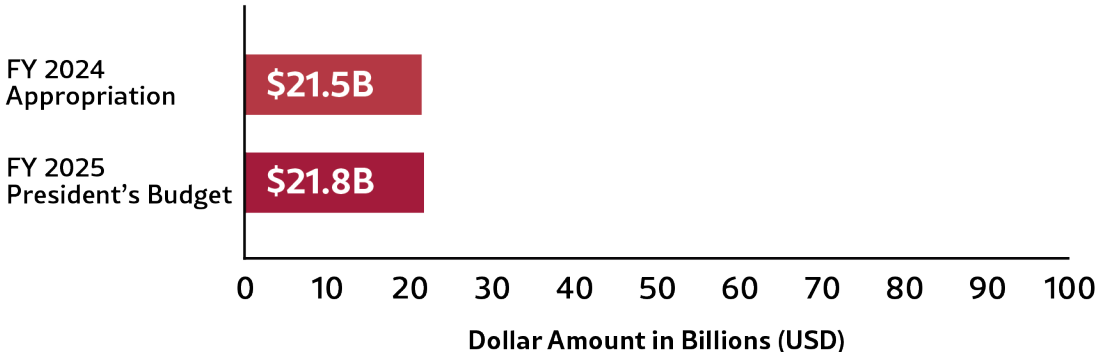
3.2 Foster supportive, inclusive, and identity-safe learning environments and ensure the individual needs of underserved students are met through appropriately designed instruction, evidence-based practices, and related supports and services.

3.3 Strengthen learning environments, support professional development, and improve educator credentialing for emergent bilingual students and multilingual learners.



Goal 3 Budgetary Resources

The following figure and table show budgetary resources and major programs and activities supporting goal 3.



Major Programs and Activities Supporting Goal 3 (in thousands)

POC	Objective	Major Programs and Activities	FY 2024 Appropriation	FY 2025 President's Budget
IES	All	Institute of Education Sciences (D)	$719,606	$734,605
OELA	3.2, 3.3	English Language Acquisition (D)	$890,000	$940,000
OESE	3.1, 3.2	Safe Schools and Citizenship Education (D)	$457,000	$507,000
OESE	3.2	Education for the Disadvantaged (D)	$648,865	$648,865
OESE	3.2	Innovation and Improvement (D)	$266,000	$266,000
OESE	3.2, 3.3	Indian Education (D)	$194,746	$194,746
OESE	All	School Improvement Programs (D)	$2,929,523	$2,929,523
OSERS	3.2	American Printing House for the Blind (D)	$43,431	$43,431
OSERS	3.2	Vocational Rehabilitation Services and Training (D)	$19,000	$19,000
OSERS	3.2	Special Education (D)	$15,280,482	$15,476,482

Notes: (1) Dollar amounts are estimates of program funding aligned to the strategic goal (Appendix F). As programs may support more than one strategic goal, amounts included here may be reflected in budget tables for other strategic goals. Please refer to the Department's Budget Tables for additional information on FY 2024 Congressional Action and the FY 2025 President's Budget Request. (2) Negative dollar amounts (indicated by values in parentheses) represent a downward re-estimate for the program. (3) Letters following major programs and activities denote discretionary (D) or mandatory (M).
Acronyms and Definitions: POC = Principal Operating Component; FY = Fiscal Year; IES = Institute of Education Sciences; OELA = Office of English Language Acquisition; OESE = Office of Elementary and Secondary Education; and OSERS = Office of Special Education and Rehabilitative Services.

Strategic Objective 3.1

Support the development and implementation of multitiered systems of supports to increase students' engagement; social, emotional, and mental health; well-being; and academic success.

Strategic Objective Leader: Deputy Assistant Secretary, Office of Elementary and Secondary Education

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has eight performance indicators. Of these indicators, four met their targets, three did not meet their targets, and one is pending available data.

Key Successes and Opportunities

Building Capacity to Address the Social, Emotional, and Mental Health Needs of Students

To meet the Administration's goal of doubling the amount of mental health professionals in schools, the Department will continue to assist states so they may recruit and retain these vital school staff members and offer professional development for teachers on trauma-informed and other mental health practices. The Department has awarded $286 million to date across 264 grantees in 48 states and the District of Columbia to support mental health services in schools—investments that are estimated to support more than 14,000 new mental health professionals in schools in the coming years. The Department continues to administer the Mental Health Personnel Technical Assistance Center for Schools (METRICS) to provide universal and targeted support to the Mental Health Service Professional (MHSP) and School-Based Mental Health Service grantees. METRICS also provides via its dedicated webpage resources and information to support efforts at the local level to increase and retain the number of MHSPs in schools and districts across the country.

To demonstrate the state-led efforts to leverage the Administration's historic investments to strengthen education in schools, colleges, and universities across the county, the Department published State fact sheets that outline how each state has, among other things, worked to tackle the youth mental health crisis, address gun violence, and improve school climate. From the 10 percent of funds set aside for state use through the Elementary and Secondary School Emergency Relief Fund, approximately $1 billion has been dedicated to support the mental health and overall well-being of students and school staff across the country, according to calculations by the Council of Chief State School Officers' COVID Relief Data Project.

The Department is collaborating with the Center for Medicare and Medicaid Services to assist state educational agencies and local educational agencies (LEAs) in providing health and mental health services in schools to Medicaid-enrolled children. The Department has created a resource for states to understand the value of accessing Medicaid dollars and how to get started.

The National Center for Pyramid Model Innovations (NCPMI) has provided numerous technical assistance sessions to assist stakeholders to understand and implement the pyramid model, a framework of evidence-based practices for promoting young children's healthy social and emotional development. Throughout the year, NCPMI hosted workshops

supporting State Part B, section 619 and Part C systems on scaling and sustaining the implementation of the pyramid model with fidelity. NCMPI also hosted national webinars on implementing interventions for children who have experienced trauma and coaching strategies to promote practice improvements.

In October 2023, the Center on Positive Behavioral Interventions and Supports (PBIS) shared an evidence-based three-tiered framework to improve and integrate data, systems, and practices affecting daily student outcomes at their annual National Leadership Forum. The center hosts a web application for easy entry and reporting of validated fidelity of implementation of PBIS. In addition, the center conducted multiple trainings. In fiscal year (FY) 2024, the center released the following six publications related to fidelity:

- Integrating High Leverage Practices for Students with Disabilities within a PBIS/MTSS Framework.
- Enhancing Team Functioning in Schools' Multi-Tiered Systems of Support
- School Climate and PBIS Fidelity.
- Systematic Screening in Tiered Systems: Lessons Learned at the Middle and High School Level.
- Supporting and Responding to Students' Social, Emotional, and Behavioral Needs: Evidence-Based Practices for Educators.
- Strengthening Tier 2/Tier 3 Systems & Practices Through the Use of a District Behavior Interventionist Role.

In April 2024, the Department, in partnership with the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services' (HHS's) Center for Medicaid Services, convened state and local government leaders to discuss investing in children's mental health and overall well-being. This virtual convening included representatives from schools, districts, and states that are successfully providing school-based services and that are investing in building capacity to support students' mental health now and into the future, including by using Medicaid funds.

On January 24, 2024, Secretary Miguel Cardona and HHS Secretary Xavier Becerra issued a joint letter to governors announcing a Notice of Funding Opportunity, *State Grants for the Implementation, Enhancement, and Expansion of Medicaid and CHIP School Based Services*, that will make it easier for states to support schools in providing critical health care services, especially mental health services, for millions of students and youth across the nation. The funds, awarded through the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services, are the latest in a series of actions by HHS and the Department that reflect a whole-of-government approach to meet families where they are and to ensure that children have access to the health care they need.

Collaborating with the Education Community to Improve Student Attendance

Consistent school attendance is critical to student success. Students who are chronically absent are much less likely to read at grade level and to graduate high school. To focus efforts on improving student attendance, the Department hosted the Everyday Counts Summit, encouraging states to implement evidence-based approaches to increase attendance. State leaders from Alabama, Indiana, and Rhode Island shared how they report real-time data on student absence to track progress and drive change. Following the summit, the Department launched the Attendance Solutions Network for districts committed to increasing student attendance.

The Office of Elementary and Secondary Education continues to focus on addressing chronic absenteeism through the Student Engagement and Attendance Center (SEAC). Among other activities, SEAC will implement a three-week learning series, Promoting Attendance Early: Absenteeism in Kindergarten and the Early Grades. Additionally, the Office of Indian Education led a Grantee Engagement Session on Early School Success in April 2024. The Department has provided multiple resources to states and districts, including a Dear Colleague Letter, the use of funds and supports to address chronic absenteeism, and Regional Educational Laboratory Handout: Strategies to Address Chronic Absenteeism.

Supporting Projects that Increase Capacity of Early Childhood Programs

In January 2024, the Department released guidance for how states, LEAs, and schools can use Title I funds to expand access to high-quality preschool for three- and four-year olds in a range of quality settings including schools, Head Start, and community-based organizations. The Early Childhood Technical Assistance Center supports states as they monitor educational results and functional outcomes ensuring that states meet *Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* (IDEA) program requirements. The center has developed a Part C General Supervision Monitoring Procedures Checklist that can be used by Part C lead agencies to assess whether or not the lead agency's current procedures include the necessary elements to effectively monitor the implementation of the IDEA and to help evaluate, prioritize, or improve specific parts of the general supervision system.

In November 2023, the Department and HHS released a policy statement on the Inclusion of Children with Disabilities in Early Childhood Programs. The statement sets the expectation that all young children with disabilities should have access to high-quality inclusive early childhood programs that provide individualized and appropriate support so they can fully participate alongside their peers without disabilities, meet high expectations, and achieve their full potential. Political leadership from the Department and HHS announced the policy statement at the Division of Early Childhood 39th Annual International Conference on November 29, 2023, where they held a plenary session and listening session at the conference and went on a site visit in Minneapolis, MN, to highlight inclusive preschool. Staff from the Department and HHS have been presenting information on the inclusion policy statement in webinars with administrators and providers that work in IDEA programs, Head Start, childcare, and public preschool.

Concurrent with this policy statement, the Department released 2023 Early Childhood Transition Questions and Answers, incorporating longstanding policy and providing further clarification on early childhood transition requirements as children transition from the IDEA Part C early intervention program to the IDEA Part B preschool program. The Department anticipates this document will help ensure smooth transitions between Early Intervention Services programs and providers and LEAS or other early childhood programs.

The Department and HHS released an August, 2024 joint letter to address critical gaps in service for deaf or hard of hearing infants and toddlers. The letter encourages collaboration between state Early Hearing Detection and Intervention programs and IDEA Part C early intervention programs. According to the letter, approximately 1.8 newborns out of 1,000 born in the United States are identified as congenitally deaf or hard of hearing. “Early identification of young DHH children, appropriate family support, and timely early intervention, are key components to their meeting language acquisition milestones that foster developmental growth and overall health and well-being,” the letter states.

In FY 2024, the Department published two resources, a Part C Administrator Implementation Technical Assistance Guide: Interagency Collaboration and a Part C Administrator

Implementation Technical Assistance Guide: Professional Development to assist states as they carry out this critical work.

Performance Indicators

3.1.1 Number of high-impact activities or services implemented to ensure that parents are trained and can effectively engage in activities that will improve students' social, emotional, and mental health as well as academic development to include an understanding of how they can support learning in the classroom with activities at home or outside the school as well as how they can participate in state and local decision-making processes.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	1,600	1,215	3,672	1,200

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: School Choice and Improvement Programs—Statewide Family Engagement Center *Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) Measure.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

3.1.2 Percentage of national chronic absenteeism.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	21.0%	30.6%	28.0%	<19.0%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Chronic Absenteeism (ED*Facts* File 195).
Period of Performance: School year 2021–2022.

3.1.3 Percentage of discretionary grant programs that include a priority (i.e., absolute, invitational, or competitive preference priority) that addresses student social, emotional, and mental health as well as academic needs.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	26%	19%	19%	30%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Grants Policy Office Dashboard.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

3.1.4 Percentage of schools that report annually an improved school climate based on the results of the Department's School Climate Surveys or via a similar tool.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	32%	48%	TBD	45%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: School Climate Transformation Grant: Local Educational Agency *Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) Measure.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

3.1.5 Number of states with 80% or more prekindergarten children with disabilities that show greater-than-expected growth in social–emotional skills by the time they exit *Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* (IDEA) Part B, Section 619 services.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	26	26	31	27

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year (FY) 2022. These data are based on FFY 2022 data due to a two-year data lag.
Data Source: IDEA Part B state annual performance reports.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2022–September 30, 2023.

3.1.6 Number of states with 65% or more infants and toddlers with disabilities that show greater-than-expected growth in social–emotional skills by the time they exit *Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* (IDEA) Part C services.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	27	28	30	28

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: IDEA Part C state annual performance reports.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2022–September 30, 2023.

3.1.7 Number of successful grant applications that address the Secretary's supplemental priorities related to social, emotional, and academic needs.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	1,464	1,605	1,794	1,765

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year (FY) 2022. This indicator measures a moving aggregate of grants from FY 2022–FY 2026.
Data Source: Annual Performance Report.
Period of Performance: October 2023–September 2024.

3.1.8 Number of schools that report fidelity data on their Positive Behavioral Interventions and Supports (PBIS) implementation efforts via PBIS apps.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	13,228	13,581	13,617	14,260

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: PBIS Assessment web application.
Period of Performance: School year 2023–2024.

Strategic Objective 3.2

Foster supportive, inclusive, and identity-safe learning environments and ensure the individual needs of underserved students are met through appropriately designed instruction, evidence-based practices, and related supports and services.

Strategic Objective Leaders: Assistant Secretary, Office of Elementary and Secondary Education and Assistant Secretary, Office of Special Education and Rehabilitative Services

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has six performance indicators. Of these indicators, one met its annual target; two did not meet their targets, and three are pending available data.

Key Successes and Opportunities

Connecting Students with Disabilities to Resources

The Technical Assistance and Dissemination (TA&D) Program is the Department's primary vehicle under the *Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* (IDEA) for providing educators, policymakers, other service providers, and the parents and families of children with disabilities with information on effective practices for meeting the needs of children with disabilities and their families. The program makes competitive awards to provide technical assistance, support model demonstration projects, disseminate useful information, and implement activities that are supported by scientific research. Fiscal year (FY) 2024 activities and accomplishments can be found on IDEA's website.

The Center for Parent Information and Resources maintains a hub with valuable information and products that are shared across the United States on a multitude of topics, such as student-centered transition planning, age of majority, state assessments, bullying, educational support strategies, and self-advocacy. A new technical assistance tool, Parent Center Standards for Family-Centered Services, is being shared with Parent Centers to increase their effectiveness when working with families.

The Administration's Joining Forces initiative includes meeting the unique needs of military-connected families of children with disabilities. Family members need assistance simplifying and streamlining the onboarding process into a new school system, facilitating the transfer of Individualized Education Programs without a major disruption in service delivery, and providing required services to children without negative impacts in educational programming. In 2024, the Office of Special Education and Rehabilitative Services has taken several steps to support military-connected children with disabilities and their families, including funding model demonstration projects; a social media campaign; and resources to help support states, parents, families, and others to meet the unique needs of military-connected children with disabilities and ensure the timely provision of required early intervention and special education and related services (e.g., self-assessment, transfer requirements, and procedural safeguards).

Children with disabilities benefit when their families are systemically engaged in their education in ways that are responsive to the families' strengths, needs, and experiences. In FY 2024, through the IDEA TA&D to Improve Services and Results for Children with

Disabilities Program, the Department funded three model demonstration projects that will develop strategies to involve parents as partners in creating equitable and inclusive schools, with a focus on engaging with military-connected families. Funding ($5.1 million) is planned for five years to demonstrate methods for identifying evidence-based strategies that build the capacity of school personnel and underserved families of children with disabilities to jointly develop and implement sustainable, equitable, and inclusive systemic change.

The Department's Office of Special Education Programs (OSEP) and the Office of Educational Technology developed guidance in support of children with disabilities who need assistive technology (AT) devices and services for meaningful access and engagement in education. A Dear Colleague Letter and resource document are intended to increase understanding of IDEA's requirements regarding AT devices and services and dispel common misconceptions regarding AT while providing examples of the use of AT devices and services for children with disabilities. The resource document is intended for a wide range of individuals, including parents, early intervention service providers, special educators, general educators, related services personnel, school and district administrators, technology specialists and directors, and employees at state lead agencies and educational agencies. AT devices and services can help improve outcomes for children, develop important skills and abilities, and prepare them for the workforce and life after high school. By providing children with disabilities with the tools they need to succeed, the Department can help break down barriers and create a more inclusive and equitable educational system for all.

Monitoring Implementation of *Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* Requirements

To support state educational agency (SEA) capacity to ensure effective implementation of IDEA, in FY 2024, the Department funded the National Center for Systemic Improvement ($5.4 million), which will provide technical assistance to states to increase leader and staff retention, strengthen the design and implementation of effective general supervision systems, and establish instructional leadership strategies to improve academic and functional outcomes for all children and youth with disabilities.

The Department funded a FY 2024 grant to establish and operate the National Technical Assistance Center to Improve State Capacity to Collect, Report, Analyze, and Use Accurate IDEA Part B Data (Data Center). The Data Center will provide technical assistance to states to ensure that they meet current and future IDEA Part B data collection and reporting requirements, improve data quality, and analyze and use sections 616 and 618 and other IDEA data (e.g., State Supplemental Survey-IDEA) to identify and address programmatic strengths and areas for improvement. The Data Center will focus on providing technical assistance on collecting, reporting, analyzing, and using Part B data on children with disabilities ages 3–21 years required under sections 616 and 618 of IDEA.

Using data to carry out continuous progress monitoring, OSEP produces summary fast facts related to specific aspects of the data collection authorized by section 618 of the IDEA, such as child count, educational environments and settings, discipline, and exiting. During FY 2024, OSEP added fast facts data on Children Identified with Autism. This resource is an update to a 2020 publication.

OSEP's National Center for Systemic Improvement kicked off a Summer Learning Series on implementation of the revised IDEA General Supervision requirements. The primary audience is state agencies preparing to complete the required State Performance Plan/Annual Performance Report. These types of technical assistance events enhance understanding that leads to appropriate implementation of IDEA.

OSEP works to ensure that lead agencies and SEAs have the tools needed to implement IDEA with fidelity. Examples of resources published during FY 2024 include the Center for IDEA Fiscal Reporting tools to meet IDEA's fiscal requirements on time (IDEA Part B Fiscal Timeline and IDEA Part C Fiscal Timeline) and the use of Part B and Part C funds.

The National Technical Assistance Center on Transition: The Collaborative produced a School Completion Toolkit, which is a resource that states, school districts, schools, parents, and other interested parties can use to gain a basic understanding of matters related to school dropout, graduation, recovery, reentry, and school completion.

Promoting Inclusive Learning Environments

The Department continues to provide guidance, oversight, and technical assistance to states to implement efforts supported by $2 billion in funding through Stronger Connections grants, the School-Based Mental Health Services Grant Program, and the Mental Health Service Professional Demonstration Grant Program under the *Bipartisan Safer Communities Act*. The April 2024 Children's Mental Health Convening included SEAs, state Medicaid agencies, districts, and mental health providers sharing lessons learned about why school-based services are essential and how to effectively access Medicaid funding for services. Careful planning should mitigate implementation challenges.

The Department released Functional Behavior Assessment (FBA) guidance, clarifying that FBAs may be used as: (1) a screening tool for children without disabilities; (2) an instructional strategy for both children with and without disabilities; and (3) a part of an evaluation under IDEA for a child suspected of having a disability or a child with a disability.

The Department developed a voluntary self-assessment for state agencies to enhance support for military-connected families with children who have disabilities. The self-assessment identifies best practices to support timely and effective provision of IDEA services to military-connected children with disabilities and highlights specific IDEA regulations that, while applicable to all children with disabilities, may be of particular interest to the families of military-connected children with disabilities, particularly when they transfer between school districts.

In November 2023, the Department and the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services (HHS) released a policy statement on the Inclusion of Children with Disabilities in Early Childhood Programs. The statement sets the expectation that all young children with disabilities should have access to high-quality, inclusive early childhood programs that provide individualized and appropriate support so they can fully participate alongside their peers without disabilities, meet high expectations, and achieve their full potential. Political leadership from the Department and HHS announced the policy statement at the Division of Early Childhood 39th Annual International Conference where they held a plenary session and listening session at the conference and went on a site visit in Minneapolis, MN, to highlight inclusive preschool. Staff from ED and HHS have been presenting information on the inclusion policy statement in webinars with administrators and providers that work in IDEA programs, Head Start, childcare, and public preschool.

In FY 2024, the National Center on Inclusion Toward Rightful Presence identified four SEAs as partners to serve as model demonstration (partner) sites to successfully implement and sustain evidence-based inclusive practices and policies that support students with autism, intellectual disabilities, traumatic brain injuries, and multiple disabilities who currently participate in alternate assessments in kindergarten through grade 12 education, including those who are English learners. The center is providing intensive technical assistance aligned

to high-leverage practices to select SEA partner sites, school districts and schools to develop capacity and implement equity-based, schoolwide multi-tiered systems of support.

In FY 2024, through the IDEA TA&D to Improve Services and Results for Children with Disabilities Program, the Department funded three model demonstration projects that will develop strategies to involve parents as partners in creating equitable and inclusive schools, with a focus on engaging with military-connected families. Funding ($4.5 million) is planned for five years to demonstrate methods for identifying evidence-based strategies that build the capacity of school personnel and underserved families of children with disabilities to jointly develop and implement sustainable, equitable, and inclusive systemic change.

In FY 2024, OSEP awarded more than $35 million in funding for 138 new awards supporting personnel preparation, ongoing professional learning, and leadership development to increase the number of well-prepared, diverse, and effective personnel serving children with disabilities. OSEP's Personnel Development Program authorized by the IDEA Part D funds activities that recruit, prepare, and retain personnel who serve and support infants, toddlers, children, and youth with disabilities and their families. Personnel include early intervention providers; teachers; related services providers; administrators leading early intervention programs, schools, or local and state agencies; and university faculty who are preparing future generations of personnel to serve children with disabilities. Additional information regarding educator shortages is located in this brief.

The FY 2024 National Technical Assistance Center to Diversify the Workforce Serving Children with Disabilities will support Historically Black Colleges and Universities, Tribally Controlled Colleges and Universities (TCCUs), and other minority-serving institutions that offer high-quality degree or certification programs in early intervention, early childhood special education, special education, or related services. The center will help these institutions improve and develop high-quality programs and increase the number of programs that successfully receive related federal grants.

Performance Indicators

3.2.1 Percentage of grantees providing culturally responsive activities.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	100%	100%	100%	100%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Tiered Fidelity Inventory, Schoolwide Benchmarks of Quality, Schoolwide Evaluation Tool, Self-Assessment Survey, and Team Implementation Checklist.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

3.2.2 Percentage of Student Support Service students served who persist into their next year of enrollment or attain a degree.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	85%	86.9%	86.2%	TBD	87%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year (FY) 2021. FY 2024 data are expected in February 2025.
Data Source: Student Support Services' Annual Performance Report.
Period of Performance: Program year 2023.

3.2.3 Percentage of prekindergarten children with disabilities attending general early childhood programs and receiving the majority of *Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* (IDEA) services in that setting.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
45.48%	43.75%	39.78%	40.99%	41.64%	TBD	42.7%

Notes: These data are the count of children with disabilities receiving special education and related services under IDEA Part B as of a state-designed child count date between October 1, 2023 and December 1, 2023. It is a single day count.
Data Source: ED*Facts*—IDEA Part B Child Count and Educational Environments.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023 –December 2023.

3.2.4 Percentage of parents receiving Special Education Parent Information Centers services who report having enhanced capacity to effectively work with schools and service providers in meeting the needs of their children.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	90.3%	96.1%	93.2%	91.8%	93.0%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2021.
Data Source: Data and performance reports from Department-funded Technical Assistance Centers.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2022–September 30, 2023.

3.2.5 Percentage of students ages 14 through 21 with disabilities served under *Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* (IDEA) Part B who exit school by dropping out.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
16.0%	16.6%	12.7%	14.6%	15.5%	13.9%	15.0%

Data Source: IDEA Part B Children With Disabilities Exiting (EDFacts File 009).
Period of Performance: July 1, 2022–June 30, 2023.

3.2.6 Percentage of students with disabilities who spend 80% or more of the day inside a regular class.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
64.00%	64.82%	66.17%	66.80%	67.08%	TBD	65.50%

Notes: These data are the count of children with disabilities receiving special education and related services under IDEA Part B as of a state-designed child count date between October 1, 2023 and December 1, 2023. It is a single day count.
Data Source: ED*Facts*—*Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* Part B Child Count and Educational Environments.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023 –December 2023.

Strategic Objective 3.3

Strengthen learning environments, support professional development, and improve educator credentialing for emergent bilingual students and multilingual learners.

Strategic Objective Leader: Assistant Deputy Secretary, Office of English Language Acquisition

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has four performance indicators. Of these indicators, three met their targets, and one did not meet the annual target.

Key Successes and Opportunities

Strengthening Learning Environments for Multilingual Learners

On June 24–25, 2024, the Office of English Language Acquisition (OELA) held its first Seal of Biliteracy Summit, which was attended by nearly 200 participants including researchers, practitioners, educators, students, and policymakers to promote opportunities aimed at advancing the cause of multilingual education. The summit included 29 of the 50 states that have endorsed the Seal of Biliteracy.

On May 22, 2024, the Office of Indian Education supported an interagency Native Language Summit Engagement Session to help shape the agenda for the upcoming Native Language Summit, Beyond the Decade: Inspiring a Generation of Native Language Learners, on October 8, 2024, in Palm Springs, CA. The session tapped into the working knowledge of hundreds of Native American Language experts and programs and aligned this year's summit to the many needs of Native American Language communities. The Department saw an increase in the number of downloads of the Family Engagement Toolkit and Being Bilingual is a Superpower Initiative to over 24,000 since its release in November 2023.

Additionally, the Department hosted a Seal of Biliteracy salon discussion at the AERA conference. Over 40 researchers, doctoral students, and professors attended. The discussion focused on access, rigor, value, and policy structures to amplify the Seal of Biliteracy as a credential to bilingual and multilingual students.

The Department also completed site visits and roundtable discussions with the five states with the most dual language programs. The site visits have demonstrated the high-quality indicators that should be considered in dual language immersion programs and provided information on the need for and opportunities to provide technical assistance.

In fiscal year (FY) 2024, the Department launched a dual language immersion project in five states. Additionally, the Department conducted school visits and roundtables and collaborated with WestED to provide a blueprint for dual language. The Department's dual language immersion project was established to amplify multilingualism for all and focused on five states: New York, Texas, California, Utah, and North Carolina. During FY 2024, the Department increased toolkits for families in various languages to continue to support Native American and other multilingual languages.

The overall OELA grantee response rate under the grantee satisfaction survey was 78 percent, which is 20 percent higher than the overall Department response rate. The

program-level results show increases across the board for all three programs (i.e., Native American and Alaska Native Children in School [NAM], National Profession Development [NPD] Program, and Title III-A), demonstrating OELA's continued efforts to deliver great customer service. The overall scores for every satisfaction driver for each program either increased or stayed the same; there were no decreases. The Title III Formula Program reached an all-time high score of 64 in overall grantee satisfaction, which is its highest score over the past six years.

Building Multilingual Teacher Pipelines

OELA launched a competition for NPD that focuses on preservice programs to increase the number of certified bilingual teachers supporting English learners (ELs).

The Grow Your Own pilot program of 13 grantees will serve approximately 3,674 participants across 9 states in 4 languages: Navajo, Sm'álgyax, Spanish, and Ute. Of the 13 entities funded, there are two Hispanic-serving institutions, two minority-serving institutions, one Asian American and Native American Pacific Islander-serving institution program, and one Native American-serving nontribal institution program.

In the NPD Program, more than 4,500 in-service teachers participated in programs on average. More than 1,000 preservice teachers were served in teacher preparation programs administered by the NPD Program. Close to 3,000 educators either completed or were making progress toward obtaining a certificate, endorsement, or license in teaching ELs. Additionally, OELA's continued efforts to deliver great customer service to NPD grantees is reflected in the GSS score. The NPD Program reached an all-time high score of 84 in overall grantee satisfaction, which is its highest satisfaction score over the past seven years.

Supporting Native American Languages

On October 6–7, 2024, NAM grantees gathered for a NAM Grantee Meeting in Palm Springs, CA. More than 50 attendees who share a collective interest in the preservation and revitalization of Native American languages and English language acquisition shared best practices in dual language programs, immersion schools, instructional technology, and program evaluation. The meeting was held in conjunction with the 11th Annual Native American Language Summit hosted by the Department.

NAM grantees support the development and retention of 16 Native languages. Common languages between the grantees include Cherokee, Yup'ik, and Cree. NAM grantees reported a total of six Seal of Biliteracy certificate recipients. NAM grantees are implementing unique activities or features to support the project goals. The most widely reported features include increasing English proficiency among learners, promoting parent and community involvement, immersion schools, providing teacher/staff professional development, and creating curriculum and instruction materials. Other project features include creating Native language assessments, mobile apps, podcasts, and focusing on science, technology, engineering, and mathematics instruction.

Compared to the 2023 grantee satisfaction survey, NAM saw increases across the board in overall grantee satisfaction from 82 to 88; in Department Staff from 94 to 97; in Documents from 88 to 96; in Information in Application Package from 86 to 94; in Grant Performance Requirements from 81 to 90; in Technical Assistance from 87 to 94; and in Trust from 86 to 96.

Performance Indicators

3.3.1 Percentage of students who attain proficiency in a Native language as determined by each grantee through pre- and post-assessments of Native language proficiency.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	8.5%	32.0%	12%	30.0%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Native American and Alaska Native Children in School Program—*Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) Measure.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

3.3.2 Number of technical assistance and outreach activities that support (or increase awareness of supports for) the English learners' education community and/or its stakeholders.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	15	34	139	37

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Tracking via contractor-produced and internally produced quarterly technical assistance and outreach reports.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

3.3.3 Number of National Professional Development (NPD) grant participants who are enrolled and are making progress toward becoming state-certified, licensed, or endorsed in English learner instruction.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	4,500	6,034	4,542	4,500

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: NPD grant—*Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) Measure.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

3.3.4 Number of National Professional Development (NPD) grant participants who have become state certified, licensed, or endorsed in English as a Second Language or bilingual instruction.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	1,800	2,129	2,552	1,800

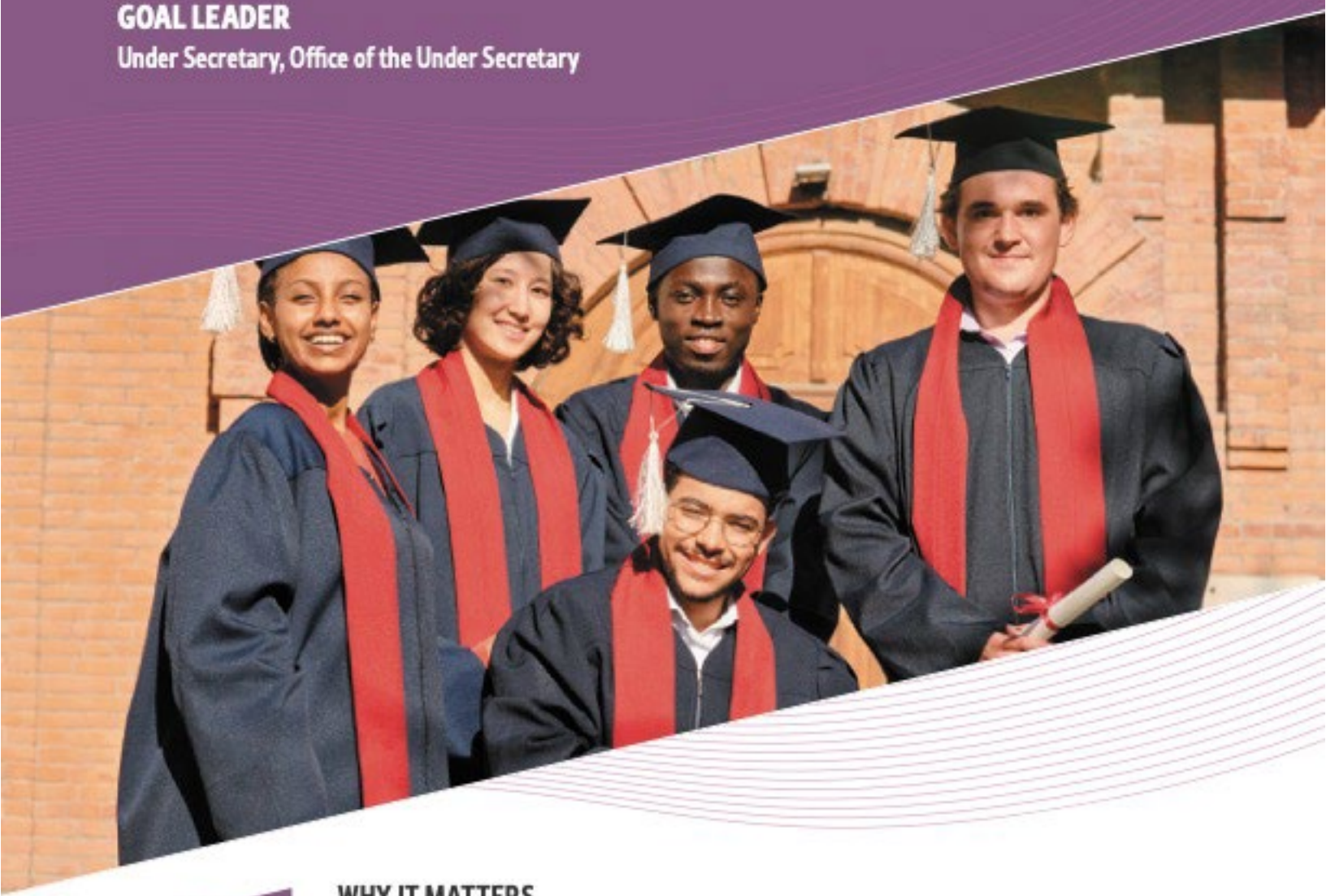
Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: NPD grant—*Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) Measure.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

STRATEGIC GOAL 4

Increase postsecondary value by focusing on equity-conscious strategies to address access to high-quality institutions, affordability, completion, post-enrollment success, and support for inclusive institutions.

GOAL LEADER

Under Secretary, Office of the Under Secretary



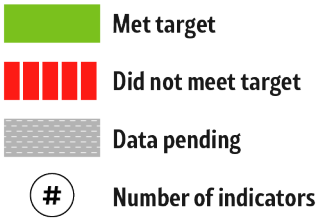
WHY IT MATTERS

Today, most good jobs—those that provide a living wage—require some form of career-connected postsecondary education and training. Our country must dramatically increase the number of Americans who possess a postsecondary credential. By 2027, 70 percent of jobs will require education or training beyond high school. The Department is committed to working with state and local leaders to ensure every student has an onramp to college and to good jobs by reimagining how our nation's high schools prepare all students to succeed and by providing students with accelerated and innovative opportunities to earn college credits and gain real-world professional experiences. Robust investments and a strategic action in the areas of an interagency initiative (with White House and Department of Labor), dual enrollment, work-based learning, and workforce credentials, are the four key levers to providing all students with pathways to high-quality postsecondary education and training.

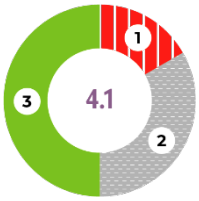
Strategic Goal 4

Objectives at a Glance

Four objectives guide the Department's work in goal 4. In fiscal year 2024, the Department assessed 19 performance indicators for this goal. Of these indicators, 13 met their targets; 3 did not meet their targets, and 3 are pending available data.



4.1 Support educational institutions and state systems in efforts to raise academic quality and college completion for all students, especially for underserved students, such as first-generation students, students from low-income backgrounds, students of color, and students with disabilities.



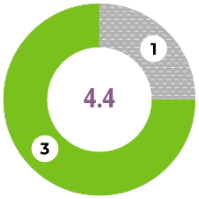
4.2 Improve the administration of student aid programs to help eligible students receive aid; support borrowers in successfully repaying their loans, claiming loan forgiveness benefits, and mitigating student loan default; and hold contractors accountable.



4.3 Increase equitable access to secondary and postsecondary programs that have clear on-ramps to both high-quality jobs and additional high-quality postsecondary educational opportunities.

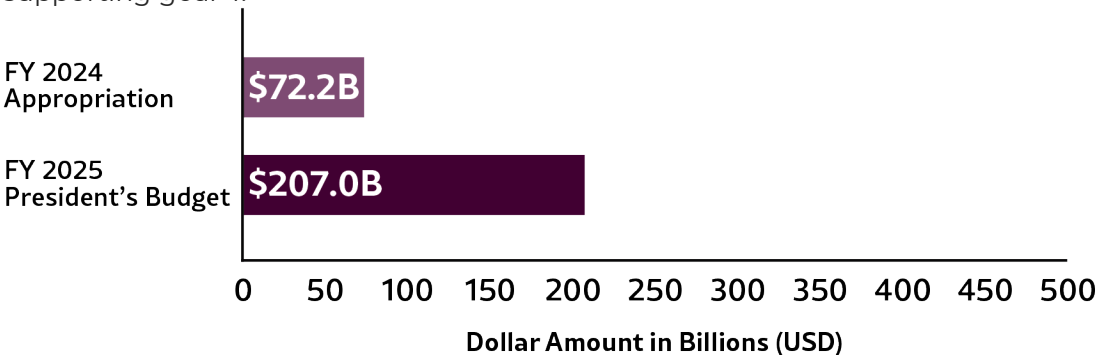


4.4 Improve the alignment across secondary, postsecondary, and career and technical education programs, including through transparent and effective transition processes, inclusive pathways, and clear credentialing requirements.



Goal 4 Budgetary Resources

The following figure and table show budgetary resources and major programs and activities supporting goal 4.



Major Programs and Activities Supporting Goal 4 (in thousands)

POC	Objective	Major Programs and Activities	FY 2024 Appropriation	FY 2025 President's Budget
FSA	4.1, 4.3	Federal Direct Student Loans Program Account (M)	$33,538,043	$42,266,917
FSA	4.1, 4.3	Federal Family Education Loans Program Account (M)	$0	$0
FSA	4.1, 4.3	Student Financial Assistance/Student Aid Administration (D, M)	$33,473,825	$39,273,508
FSA	4.1	Historically Black College and University Capital Financing Program Account—HEA III-D (D, M)	$20,678	$20,731
FSA	4.1	Higher Education Facilities Loans Liquidating Account—HEA Section 121 (M)	$0	$0
OCTAE	4.3, 4.4	Career, Technical, and Adult Education (D)	$1,452,269	$1,534,269
OESE	4.4	School Improvement Programs (M)	$0	$0
OPE	4.1	College Housing Loans (D, M)	$(298)	$(328)
OPE	4.1, 4.3	Higher Education (D, M)	$3,428,365	$3,610,730
OSERS	4.1	Gallaudet University (D)	$167,361	$165,361
OSERS	4.1	National Technical Institute for the Deaf (D)	$92,500	$92,500
N/A	4.2	Free Community College (D, M)	$0	$120,000,000

Notes: (1) Dollar amounts are estimates of program funding aligned to the strategic goal (Appendix F). As programs may support more than one strategic goal, amounts included here may be reflected in budget tables for other strategic goals. Please refer to the Department's Budget Tables for additional information on FY 2024 Congressional Action and the FY 2025 President's Budget Request. (2) Negative dollar amounts (indicated by values in parentheses) represent a downward re-estimate for the program. (3) Letters following major programs and activities denote discretionary (D) or mandatory (M).

Acronyms and Definitions: POC = Principal Operating Component; FY = Fiscal Year; FSA = Federal Student Aid; HEA = *Higher Education Act of 1965*; OCTAE = Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education; OESE = Office of Elementary and Secondary Education; OPE = Office of Postsecondary Education; OSERS = Office of Special Education and Rehabilitative Services; and N/A = Not Applicable.

Strategic Objective 4.1

Support educational institutions and state systems in efforts to raise academic quality and college completion for all students, especially for underserved students, such as first-generation students, students from low-income backgrounds, students of color, and students with disabilities.

Strategic Objective Leader: Assistant Secretary, Office of Postsecondary Education

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has six performance indicators. Of these indicators, three met their targets; one did not meet its target, and two are pending available data.

Key Successes and Opportunities

Increasing Equitable Funding for Minority-Serving Institutions, Historically Black Colleges and Universities, Tribally Controlled Colleges and Universities, and Community Colleges

The Office of Postsecondary Education (OPE) has conducted 171 outreach and 166 technical assistance engagements in fiscal year (FY) 2024 to expand linkages with a specific emphasis on increasing the participation of Historically Black Colleges and Universities (HBCUs), Tribally Controlled Colleges and Universities (TCCUs), minority-serving institutions (MSIs), and community colleges in the Department's grant programs. These engagements included webinars, site visits, meetings with institutions, speaking engagements, and other types of interactions. Topics focused on several issues, including increasing college completion and closing attainment gaps among underserved populations. To further outreach efforts to TCCUs, OPE leadership and staff have become involved with the White House Initiative (WHI) for TCCUs, working to develop relationships and inform more institutions of the availability of grant programs.

OPE hosted five technical assistance sessions to discuss eligibility for Titles III and V grant programs (under the *Higher Education Act of 1965*) and increase awareness of the process for being designated as an MSI. OPE (HEP-IS) management hosted a webinar for Asian American and Native American Pacific Islander serving institutions (AANAPISIs) and Alaska Native and Native Hawaiian serving institutions, in collaboration with the Department of Agriculture and the WHI on Asian Americans, Native Hawaiians, and Pacific Islanders to increase awareness of opportunities for grants for MSIs.

OPE's FY 2023 and FY 2024 Fulbright-Hays grant competitions (i.e., Group Projects Abroad, Seminars Abroad [SA], Doctoral Dissertation Research Abroad, and Faculty Research Abroad) included competitive preference priorities focused on MSIs as applicants or in partnership with other applicant institutions. These efforts yielded an increase in the number of SA applications received—162, which was 56 more applications than received in FY 2023, and included applications from 36 new applicants, from kindergarten through grade 12 (K–12) teachers, postsecondary faculty, and administrators across the United States. Of the 48 SA awardees for FY 2024, 18 are K–12 educators who teach at Title I schools; 7 teach at MSIs, 2 teach at community colleges, and 36 are new applicants.

The Department awarded more than $18 million for 46 grants in the AANAPISI Part A Grant Program. In August 2024, President Biden issued the first-ever Presidential Proclamation for

National AANAPISI Week. These grants are a key piece of the Biden–Harris Administration's commitment to elevating the significance of AANAPISIs and their role in higher education. This program provides grants and related assistance to AANAPISIs to enable such institutions to improve and expand their capacity to serve Asian Americans and Native American Pacific Islanders and low-income individuals.

The Department has continued Project Success, which supports collaborative efforts by major guarantee agencies to help HBCU, TCCUs, and other MSIs to improve student retention, completion, and post-graduation earnings so students can successfully repay their investments in higher education.

Improving Postsecondary Success

Since FY 2022, the Department has provided more than $90 million in grant awards to 17 grantees under the Postsecondary Student Success Grant (PSSG) Program. The PSSG Program aims to equitably improve postsecondary student outcomes, including retention, transfer, credit accumulation, and completion by leveraging data and implementing, scaling, and rigorously evaluating evidence-based approaches. OPE's priority initiative in support of this objective is to conduct outreach to grantees on topics that include best practices for persistence, such as tutoring, financial management, and other factors that would encourage student success.

The Promoting Postbaccalaureate Opportunities for Hispanic Americans Program includes a competitive preference priority focused on providing flexible, high-quality, and accessible learning opportunities. The Department made 16 awards totaling $11.1 million in September 2024.

In FY 2024, the Department awarded more than $41 million to nine states through the Gaining Early Awareness and Readiness for Undergraduate Programs (GEAR UP) State Grant Program. This discretionary grant program is designed to increase the number of students with low incomes who are prepared to enter and succeed in postsecondary education.

The Department provided more than $75 million in grants to 240 institutions of higher education (IHEs) to support or establish high-quality, campus-based childcare programs to meet the needs of student parents with low incomes enrolled on their campuses. For the first time, applicants for the Child Care Access Means Parents in School Grant Program were encouraged to propose ways to improve the quality of the services the program provides. Such methods include higher wages for childcare workers, which can significantly reduce turnover and are associated with better care and improved child outcomes.

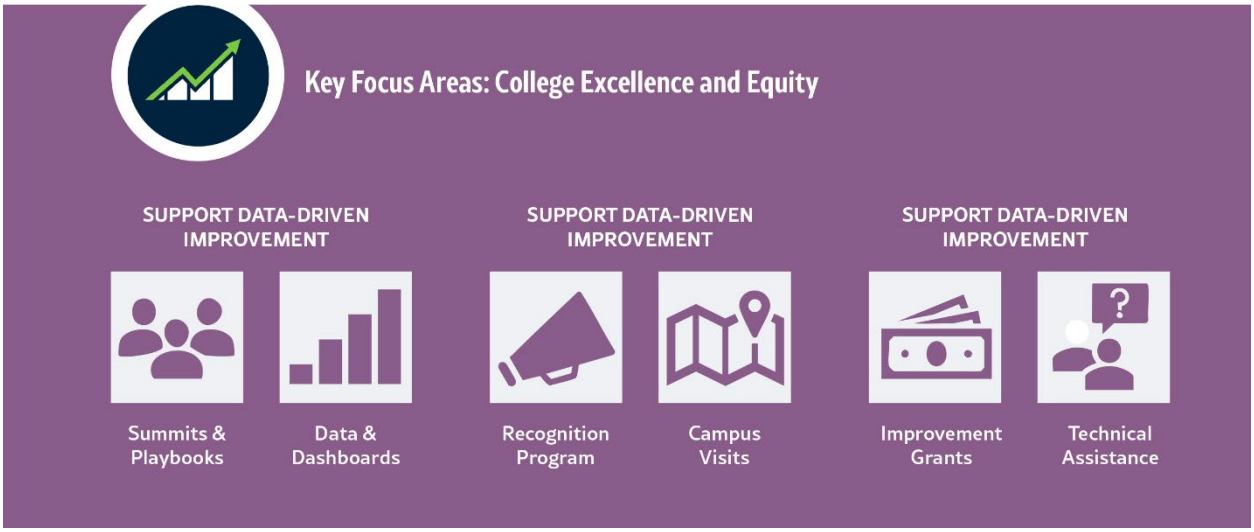
In FY 2023 and 2024, the Department provided approximately $89 million in grants to 43 IHEs to improve rates of postsecondary education enrollment, persistence, and completion among students in rural communities. The Rural Postsecondary and Economic Development Grant Program promotes the development of high-quality career pathways aligned to high-skill, high-wage, and in-demand industry sectors and occupations in the region.

The Department refreshed the College Scorecard website with data from the Internal Revenue Service on post-enrollment earnings. This data release included institution-level earnings for former students 6, 8, and 10 years after starting school and a field of study earnings for those 1 and 5 years after graduating. The 5-year calculation represents a brand-new data element. Additionally, the release included a restructured data file to relabel

previously published entry-cohort earnings calculations released in 2022 and 2023 with the publication of a data errata document describing data-quality issues with those calculations.

In summer 2024, the Office of Planning, Evaluation, and Policy Development launched a new College Scorecard resources webpage that includes educator and college access advisor toolkits. The toolkits are designed to enhance the use and understanding of College Scorecard data among educators, school counselors, and college access advisors. The development of these comprehensive toolkits—one tailored for classroom use and the other for professional development—were informed by user surveys, interviews, and stakeholder collaboration.

In FY 2024, the Office of Special Education and Rehabilitative Services (OSERS) implemented an Expect, Engage, Empower: Successful Transitions for All! initiative to highlight tools and resources necessary for successful transitions to secondary experiences. A series of blog posts on secondary transition from OSERS cover topics such as "Belonging: Building and Sustaining Environments that Support High Expectations, Engagement, and Empowerment for All!," focused on the importance of building a sense of belonging for children, youth, and young adults with disabilities in school, college, and workplace settings.



Providing Technical Assistance Services

OPE hosted several webinars, in collaboration with Federal Student Aid and the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, that provided financial aid information and technical assistance for the Better FAFSA to all Student Service grantees. Additionally, OPE hosted a webinar in collaboration with the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services (HHS) to provide information regarding HHS programs to TRIO project directors.

On October 30, 2023, the Rehabilitation Services Administration (RSA) published Promoting Meaningful and Sustained Engagement of Individuals with Disabilities in the State Vocational Rehabilitation [VR] Services Program. This policy guidance supports VR agencies in their efforts to make changes that will promote meaningful and sustained engagement with individuals with disabilities throughout the VR process. The continuum of VR services affords VR agencies opportunities, through multiple touchpoints, to provide quality services that maximize the potential of individuals with disabilities to achieve competitive integrated employment (CIE).

RSA also published Using Third-Party Cooperative Arrangements with Local Educational Agencies [LEAs] for Providing Pre-Employment Transition Services to Students with Disabilities under the VR Program. This policy guidance outlines how third-party cooperative agreements entered with LEAs provide VR agencies the opportunity to expand and improve the provision of pre-employment transition services for students with disabilities and enhance the potential for using all the state's VR Program funds by generating additional nonfederal share from the public cooperating agencies.

Military-connected families can experience delays and lack of continuity in service provision when relocating to another military installation. To better serve students with disabilities from military-connected families and mitigate delays and lack of continuity in service provision, RSA Commissioner Danté Allen transmitted a July 2024 Dear Colleague Letter. The letter stated that VR agencies can raise awareness of available resources by reaching out directly to military personnel, educators in Department of Defense schools and LEAs, and parents of children with disabilities in private schools. Further, they can provide critical and timely information about the wide variety of services available to these students. These services include career counseling, work-based learning experiences, work-readiness training, and instructions in self-advocacy, as well as other VR services such as rehabilitation technology, job search and placement services, and financial support for postsecondary education.

In November 2023, RSA published the Rapid Engagement: Improving Employment Outcomes, which describes an effective strategy to expedite individuals with disabilities through VR, enhancing the likelihood of successful employment outcomes. Highlighting the link between timely eligibility determinations and employment success, it proposes diverse approaches, including the Demand-Side Employment Approach, Integrated Resource Teams, Progressive Employment Model, and the Individual Placement and Support (IPS) Model. The document encourages tailored implementation by agencies and counselors and suggests resources for further learning, including on-demand training modules, manager minute insights, and state-specific success episodes. It also offers training series on IPS and reports on the replication of Progressive Employment Models in state VR agencies.

On February 23, 2024, the U.S. Departments of Education and Labor (the Departments) published a final rule in the Federal Register (89 FR 13814). The final rule defined the sixth performance indicator—effectiveness in serving employers—as Retention with the Same Employer in the second and fourth quarters following a participant's exit from a *Workforce Innovation and Opportunity Act* (WIOA) core program and requires it be reported by one WIOA core program on behalf of all six such programs within each state. The final rule took effect on March 25, 2024. To assist states, the Departments published a Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) document on March 22, 2024. The purpose of these jointly issued FAQs is to outline when states must begin collecting and reporting Retention with the Same Employer data and inform states of the information collection requests and joint policy guidance the Departments will revise in accordance with this new regulatory definition.

In response to inquiries regarding whether state VR agencies may support the choice of recipients of VR services to attend out-of-state postsecondary training, including programs that provide disability-specific supports, training, or accommodations, in August 2024, RSA issued a technical assistance circular to clarify state VR agencies' responsibilities and the role that state VR agencies may play in supporting informed choice for recipients of VR services, including postsecondary education, and providing out-of-state services that meet their individualized needs in accordance with their signed Individualized Plan for Employment.

On May 20, 2024, RSA published a Dear Colleague Letter in recognition of Mental Health Awareness Month and to highlight the importance of mental health and the power of the VR Program to help individuals with mental health conditions live fulfilling and meaningful lives. The letter encourages the VR agencies to support participants as they navigate mental health-related barriers and seek CIE and integration into the community. Nearly one-third of VR Program participants have psychological or psychiatric disabilities.

The Regional Educational Laboratories (RELs) provided technical assistance to postsecondary institutions with the goal of improving outcomes for students. REL West continued to work with six IHEs in California to advance their efforts to increase the number of individuals with "some college, no degree" or "near completers" who return to college and complete their credentials. REL Appalachia continued to work with the Virginia Community College System to improve retention, course completion, and degree and certificate completion for the nearly 200,000 students enrolled in 23 community colleges statewide.

Performance Indicators

4.1.1 Number of technical assistance activities (e.g., events, trainings, and webinars) or products focused on the use of evidence-based practices to meet the social, emotional, academic, and other learning and developmental needs of students in postsecondary and adult education.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	44	32	TBD	50

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year (FY) 2022. FY 2024 data are expected in February 2025.
Data Source: Department offices that deliver technical assistance.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

4.1.2 Percentage of grant applicants from community colleges, Historically Black Colleges and Universities, Tribally Controlled Colleges and Universities, and minority-serving institutions.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	43%	46%	45%	TBD	48%

Notes: Fiscal year (FY) 2022 data have been revised following further data validation. Data from previous years are not included as Office of Postsecondary Education grants are on a five-year cycle, and different grants are competed each year. This measure represents a cumulative rolling average of all grants competed during the period of performance for FY 2022–FY 2026. FY 2024 data are expected in February 2025.
Data Source: G5 data.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

4.1.3 Number of students with disabilities who receive counseling on enrollment in postsecondary education through the Vocational Rehabilitation Program.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	55,488	63,565	120,904	88,455	88,000

Data Source: Rehabilitation Services Administration (RSA) Case Service Report (RSA-911).
Period of Performance: Program year 2023.

4.1.4 Number of Vocational Rehabilitation Program participants who are enrolled in postsecondary education and training.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	178,494	184,704	186,452	170,884	190,000

Data Source: Rehabilitation Services Administration (RSA) Case Service Report (RSA-911).
Period of Performance: Program year 2023.

4.1.5 Number of engagements (i.e., meetings/events) with states, institutions, accrediting agencies, and associations with a focus on increasing college completion and closing attainment gaps among underserved populations.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	—	—	171	50

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2024.
Data Source: Office of Postsecondary Education outreach reports.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

4.1.6 Number of technical assistance and support activities provided to institutions.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	—	—	166	90

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2024.
Data Source: Office of Postsecondary Education technical assistance reports.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

Strategic Objective 4.2

Improve the administration of student aid programs to help eligible students receive aid; support borrowers in successfully repaying their loans, claiming loan forgiveness benefits, and mitigating student loan default; and hold contractors accountable.

Strategic Objective Leader: Chief Operating Officer, Federal Student Aid

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has eight performance indicators. One indicator was not able to report data due to administrative changes. Of the seven remaining indicators that were assessed, five met their targets, while two did not. The Department has designated strategic objective 4.2 as a "Focused Area for Improvement." This designation is derived from the Office of Management and Budget's guidance that provides criteria for designating at least one strategic objective for this category.

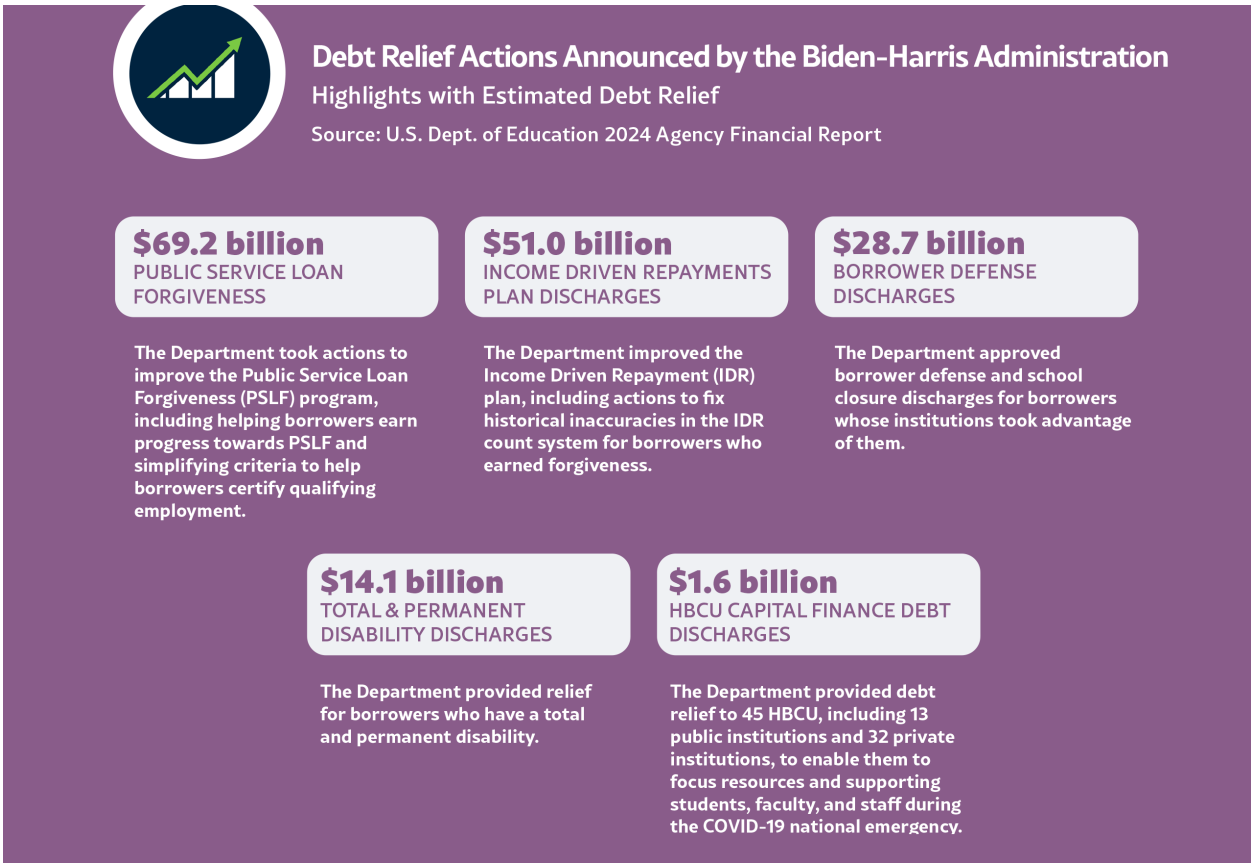
Key Successes and Opportunities

Providing Student Loan Debt Relief

The Biden–Harris Administration approved more than $169 billion in student loan relief for nearly 4.8 million borrowers as of August 2024. As part of this effort, over 1 million borrowers received $74 billion of relief, which is largely attributed to fixes implemented to the Public Service Loan Forgiveness (PSLF) Program. Further, over 1 million borrowers received $51 billion in relief via Income-Driven Repayment (IDR) plan payment adjustments. These efforts addressed longstanding concerns with the misuse of forbearance by loan servicers. In addition, more than 1.6 million borrowers are receiving $28.7 billion in relief due to court settlements related to schools who cheated, precipitously closed, or otherwise harmed students. More than 548,000 borrowers with a total and permanent disability also received $14.1 billion in relief.

Over the past year, the Department processed multiple rounds of discharges for eligible borrowers participating in the IDR and PSLF Programs, including borrowers who benefitted from IDR account adjustments. On July 18, 2024, a federal court issued a stay preventing the Department from continuing operations on the Saving on a Valuable Education Income-Driven Repayment Plan, which is the most affordable repayment plan for low and middle-income borrowers and provides an earlier pathway to forgiveness for low-balance borrowers.

The Department also announced and is currently processing discharges for more than 317,000 borrowers who attended the Art Institutes (valued at $6.1 billion). This group discharge is based on the Department's findings that the Art Institutes made widespread and pervasive substantial misrepresentations that borrowers relied on to their detriment. The Department also continues to process previously announced discharges for already approved applications to meet obligations set forth in the Sweet v. Cardona settlement. The Department substantially met all fiscal year (FY) 2024 adjudication settlement deadlines, successfully adjudicating and issuing over 21,000 decisions to class members. The Department also adjudicated thousands of individual applications and issued over 15,000 decisions to post-class applicants in FY 2024.



Improving the Customer Experience for Students and Borrowers

The Department introduced a new *Free Application for Federal Student Aid*® (FAFSA®) form for the 2024–2025 cycle. This new FAFSA, which implements updates authorized under the *Fostering Undergraduate Talent by Unlocking Resources for Education Act* and the *FAFSA Simplification Act*, reflects fundamental changes to both the form itself and the underlying formula that determines eligibility for federal student aid.

Pervasive technical issues delayed the project schedule and resulted in substantial defects during the implementation of the FAFSA Processing System (FPS) during the 2024–2025 cycle. These issues resulted in the miscalculation of student aid eligibility as well as significant submission errors as the FPS was deployed. These errors negatively impacted financial aid packaging for students, parents, and schools as they prepared for the forthcoming school year. These issues were reviewed by oversight and independent audit authorities, including Congress, the Government Accountability Office, and the Office of the Inspector General.

Department engagement via the Secretary's FAFSA School and Student Support Strategy as well as community partnerships led to student application success rates increasing significantly during the final six months of FY 2024. Form submissions, when compared to the previous FAFSA cycle, were down by 40 percent in March 2024 before being reduced to a 2.3 percent gap by September 2024. By the end of FY 2024, over 16.4 million applicants had successfully submitted a FAFSA form. Further, approximately 500,000 more FAFSA applicants were eligible for Pell Grants in September 2024 in comparison to September 2023, equating to a 6 percent increase. Further, the Department implemented communications improvements via the Marketing Communications Platform, which was leveraged to

distribute more than 619 million emails with key student aid information, updates, resources, deadlines, and more.

While there were significant development and delivery challenges associated with the 2024–2025 FAFSA, the Department worked diligently to obtain feedback from a wide range of stakeholders, including borrowers, schools, and community-based organizations, to identify and correct issues in preparation for the 2025–2026 FAFSA cycle. This included putting new project leadership and experts in place to help with the development of the 2025–2026 FAFSA form. The Department began an extensive effort to recruit and onboard more permanent information technology professionals with engineering, design, and project management expertise, as well as strengthen project management protocols, most notably to better hold contractors accountable for meeting key deadlines and achieving desired outcomes.

The Department designed a beta testing program, which launched on October 1, 2024, that is aligned with software industry best practices to maximize positive user experiences with the FAFSA form. This approach allows the Department to incrementally improve the form while building on the core improvements that have already been implemented and focusing on key functional areas, including the following:

- Providing early and predictable timelines and launching core functions at the same time.
- Ensuring the form functions as intended when broadly launched.
- Increasing transparency.
- Improving resources for students and families to assist them in navigating the form.
- Providing additional resources to counselors, institutions, states, and other critical partners.
- Ensuring the call center has sufficient capacity to handle outreach from and provide accurate information to students and families.
- Improving the user experience for students and families.
- Providing additional outreach and support for students and families who need the most help completing the form.
- Addressing the ongoing issues experienced by mixed-status families.
- Helping alleviate the additional burden on institutions.

Administering the Federal Student Loan Program

This year, the Department transitioned loan servicing to a new operational environment under the Unified Servicing and Data Solution (USDS) contract to more effectively provide loan servicing for 38 million federal student loan borrowers. USDS increases servicer accountability and ultimately improves the borrower experience. Under the new framework, service-level agreements are in effect to hold servicers accountable for portfolio performance and incentivize more support for borrowers at risk of delinquency and default.

In FY 2024, the Department also released information and updates to help institutions of higher education prepare for complying with the Financial Value Transparency and Gainful Employment regulations. These rules were published in October 2023 and went into effect in July 2024, providing the public with detailed information about college costs and financial outcomes that students and families can expect to achieve. The new regulations also include protections for students and taxpayers from career training programs that fail to provide sufficient financial value. The Department implemented new National Student Loan Data System reporting functionality and published numerous electronic announcements and

gainful employment guides for institutions in support of these requirements. Key information can be found on Federal Student Aid's (FSA's) Knowledge Center portal.

Strengthening Oversight of Institutions

The Department conducted significant oversight, monitoring, and enforcement activities to ensure institutions complied with Title IV requirements and other relevant laws, regulations, and policies. During FY 2024, the Department received 13,433 school-related complaints regarding more than 2,000 institutions of higher education. The Department conducted oversight reviews for more than 2,130 educational institutions, including reviews related to deficient audit resolutions, flagged financial statements, took certification actions, and more to ensure schools appropriately administered federal student aid programs. Additionally, the Department conducted secret shopper operations and opened new investigations into schools and their service providers when risk indicators suggested potential violations.

In FY 2024, the Department issued a total of 30 administrative actions aimed at mitigating business practices that put students at risk of being harmed by low-quality programs, including the following:

- **October 2023:** Initiated a $37 million fine proceeding against a school for, according to investigative findings, making substantial misrepresentations regarding program costs.
- **February 2024:** Reached a settlement requiring two executives of a school to resign after an investigation revealed unlawful conduct in violation of program standards.
- **March 2024:** Concluded an investigation of an institution that revealed extensive violations of the *Jeanne Clery Disclosure of Campus Security Policy and Campus Crime Statistics Act*, resulting in a $14 million fine.
- **September 2024:** Terminated the eligibility of an institution that failed to provide more than $700,000 in credit balance payments to student loan borrowers, resulting in a $4.2 million fine.

The Department increased transparency with stakeholders by publishing a new Enforcement webpage in August 2024, which includes substantive information about administrative enforcement actions and other actions to deter unlawful behavior. The Department issued three new public enforcement bulletins in FY 2024, including bulletins announcing public reporting of suspensions and debarments, reminding institutions of their obligation to establish and maintain appropriate compliance management systems, and informing institutions about risky conduct that could lead to substantial misrepresentation.

Work continues to diligently improve and meet targets for all performance indicators in this strategic objective, as FSA is undergoing an extensive modernization effort that will enable the agency to dynamically mature and successfully meet the needs of its stakeholders. Notably, the 2025–2026 FAFSA launch is currently on schedule, with full availability to all students and contributors expected on or before December 1, 2024.

Performance Indicators

4.2.1 Percentage of contractor interactions reviewed that received a passing score of 95%.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	—	98.33%	98.6%	≤95%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2023.
Data Source: Federal Student Aid's Vendor Management/Vendor Oversight and Program Accountability.
Period of Performance: July 2023 – September 2024.

4.2.2 Percentage of contractors that achieve at least 95% accuracy in performing tasks.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	—	99.17	97.65%	≤95%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2023.
Data Source: Federal Student Aid's Vendor Management/Vendor Oversight and Program Accountability.
Period of Performance: July 2023–September 2024.

4.2.3 Percentage of high school seniors submitting the *Free Application for Federal Student Aid*® (FAFSA®) form.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
65.9%	63.8%	60.87%	63.6%	65.16%	57.8%	61.5%

Data Source: Federal Student Aid's Common Origination and Distribution System.
Period of Performance: School year 2023–2024.

4.2.4 Persistence among first-time *Free Application for Federal Student Aid*® (FAFSA®) filing aid recipients.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
82.80%	81.00%	81.09%	80.02%	81.49%	77.61%	81%

Data Source: Federal Student Aid's Common Origination and Distribution System.
Period of Performance: School year 2023–2024.

4.2.5 Verification rate of *Free Application for Federal Student Aid*® (FAFSA®) filers.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
24.30%	22.86%	19.41%	10.48%	9.69%	—	≤7.50%

Notes: Data were not available for this indicator in fiscal year 2024.
Data Source: Central Processing System Database.
Period of Performance: School year 2023–2024.

4.2.6 Satisfaction survey scores associated with the *Free Application for Federal Student Aid*® (FAFSA®) application.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	77.8	80	80	78

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: FAFSA survey (housed on StudentAid.gov).
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

4.2.7 Number of sessions (as measured by completions) the Loan Simulator tool is used.						
FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	2,942,085	3,648,852	3,971,259	2.6 million

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology the target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Google Analytics.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

4.2.8 Percentage of individual Borrower Defense applications adjudicated timely.						
FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	—	100%	99%	90%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2023.
Data Source: Feedback Dispute Management System.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

Strategic Objective 4.3

Increase equitable access to secondary and postsecondary programs that have clear on-ramps to both high-quality jobs and additional high-quality postsecondary educational opportunities.

Strategic Objective Leader: Assistant Secretary, Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has two performance indicators; both met their annual targets.

Key Successes and Opportunities

Unlocking Career Success

The Department continued to reimagine how the nation's high schools prepare all students to thrive in their future careers and support public and private sector leaders, government agencies, and other others to help students earn postsecondary degrees and industry credentials that employers need and that the economy demands. The Unlocking Career Success (UCS) initiative blurs the lines between high school, college, and career, providing students with accelerated and innovative opportunities to earn college credits and gain real-world career experiences.

In January 2024, the Department announced 19 new grant awards totaling $25 million for the first-ever Perkins Innovation and Modernization, Career Connected High Schools (CCHS) grants. These grants support building the capacity of education and workforce systems to partner with business and industry to develop new high-quality, career-connected high school programs for more students. Grantees will leverage the following four evidence-based strategies, or keys, to help students in UCS:

- Providing postsecondary education and career guidance.
- Increasing access to dual or concurrent enrollment programs.
- Increasing work-based learning (WBL) opportunities.
- Providing industry-recognized credentials.

The grant is part of the Department's Raise the Bar (RTB): UCS initiative aimed at helping young Americans access good-paying jobs created by President Biden's Investing in America through seeding and scaling promising models of innovation. The CCHS Grant Program is the first in the Department's history intended to build capacity and coordination among secondary and postsecondary education, workforce development systems, and other community partners to expand access to CCHS programs for more students, with a focus on increasing access to high-quality pathways for underserved students.

During FY 2024, the Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education (OCTAE) published Playbooks for UCS, providing various stakeholder groups with strategic and tactical actions they can take to develop, promote, and make use of programs with clear on-ramps to high-quality jobs. These publications include playbooks for practitioners—such as , school counselors, career and technical education (CTE) directors, and community-based organizations—with actions to help students plan for the future, develop partnerships, and

align resources. It also includes playbooks for state leaders—such as state education agencies, higher education, and Governors—with actions to create unified visions, strengthen partnerships, and align data and accountability systems. It includes playbooks for local leaders—such as principals, superintendents, and Mayors—with actions to build staff capacity, create conducive environments, and align policy with practice. This initiative connects top talent with high-quality job opportunities. It includes a playbook for business and industry that focuses on addressing labor needs and enhancing WBL, as well as a playbook for students and families that offers guidance on goal setting and preparation for future success.

OCTAE hosted the Unlocking Employer Pathways Summit in the District of Columbia aimed at providing technical assistance to employers who wish to become more involved in supporting the implementation of career-connected pathways. The event attracted over 200 attendees, resulting in the formation of several new partnerships. The Department continues to facilitate listening sessions with various industries to assist employers in implementing high-quality, WBL and supportive pathways policies.

Additional information on products related to UCS, the Unlocking Pathways State Policy Heat Map, and various playbooks for specific demographic groups can be found in strategic objectives 1.4 and 4.4.

Supporting Career Pathways for Adults

The Department continues to provide national leadership and technical assistance activities focused on the use of promising and evidence-based practices to connect adult learners to basic needs support. Activities are enhancing the quality and outcomes of adult education and literacy activities and programs nationwide. These national leadership activities provide *Adult Education and Family Literacy Act* (AEFLA) grantees with professional development and technical assistance for the purposes of developing, improving, identifying, and disseminating the most successful methods and techniques for providing adult education and literacy activities based on scientifically valid and evidence-based research as well as assist grantees with developing, improving, and identifying successful methods and techniques for addressing the basic education and foundational needs of adults.

Through Literacy Information and Communication System (LINCS)—the Department's primary outreach and dissemination mechanism for adult educators—OCTAE supports professional development systems at state and local levels, adult education practitioners, program administrators, and state staff. Through LINCS, the Department offered high-quality, on-demand professional learning through research and evidence-based resources, self-paced online courses, and virtual communities of practice that support peer-to-peer learning. LINCS hosts expert-vetted research and evidence-based resources and serves as a platform for direct communication among peers and experts in the communities of practice. LINCS also hosts research and evidence-based resources produced by other national leadership activities to provide a well-branded and trusted one-stop content repository. The LINCS Learner Center, the component of LINCS designed for adult learner use, provided direct access to materials designed to help adults obtain job skills or become U.S. citizens, including programs for learning mathematics and science, learning how to read, and finding local adult literacy programs—many of which are available in English and Spanish.

Through the Digital Resilience in the American Workforce (DRAW) project, OCTAE supports states' current and long-term efforts to effectively implement digital literacy instruction in adult education and literacy programs by preparing adult education practitioners who support learners that struggle to fully engage in tasks that demand the use of digital

technologies. By supporting these practitioners through DRAW, the Department supported professional development that enables teachers to be strategic and learner-focused in their lesson planning and instruction; supported adult education programs in designing effective, flexible technology-enabled education and support services; as well as provided state AEFLA funders and their professional development providers with models, guidance, and resources for supporting programs that sustain and expand digital literacy efforts. DRAW provided AEFLA grantees with flexible, evidence-based, and piloted strategies and materials to support teachers in building the digital literacy and digital resilience of adult learners. In partnership with adult educators across the country, DRAW conducted a landscape scan that identified and curated existing resources for assessing and developing digital literacy skills and resilience, co-created resources to fill gaps identified in the landscape scan, developed a digital library to pull resources together in user-friendly, flexible formats with actionable strategies that support diverse populations of adult learners, including beginning level English learners, and trained adult education professionals in how to integrate high-quality evidence-based resources into their instruction. During FY 2024, 15 states and 130 participants have received technical assistance, training, and resources to assist them with introducing effective instructional strategies to support learners' digital resilience.

Through the Enhancing Access for Refugees and New Americans (EARN) project, OCTAE continues to build the capacity of states, local programs, and classroom instructors to provide comprehensive immigrant-integration services, centering around Integrated English Literacy and Civics Education (IELCE) and Integrated Education and Training programming. To provide just-in-time support to state and local AEFLA grantees through EARN, the Department provided technical assistance to state adult education agency staff and IELCE grantees to support the use of an immigrant-integration approach, which supports the linguistic, civic, and economic integration of immigrants and adult learners across the country. The Department conducted an immigrant-integration landscape scan, designed, and delivered comprehensive immigrant integration technical assistance resources and trainings, and conducted a national capstone meeting to discuss lessons learned and receive input on successful strategies for serving multilingual learners as well as address persistent challenges. The EARN project highlighted flexibilities by spotlighting states and programs that were successfully implementing a range of effective and innovative strategies for serving multilingual learners and immigrants while using an immigrant integration approach.

On September 10, 2024, the Department awarded $251.9 million to 27 grantees across the country who work to ensure individuals with disabilities have access to in-demand, good-paying jobs of the 21st century. These five-year grants, under the Disability Innovation Fund Program, will continue to promote competitive integrated employment (CIE) so that youth and adults with disabilities receive real wages for real jobs and to create pathways to some of today's most in-demand fields. Applications focused on one of the following topics:

- Broadening access to advanced technology careers and creating a 21st-century workforce of youth and/or adults with disabilities leading to CIE.
- Innovative applications of advanced technology to support youth and/or adults with disabilities leading to CIE.
- Justice-involved youth with disabilities, including early intervention and reintegration from the juvenile justice system to the community, leading to CIE.
- Early intervention and workforce reintegration strategies for youth and/or adults with acquired disabilities that lead to CIE.
- Early intervention and workforce reintegration strategies for disconnected youth and/or disconnected adults with disabilities that lead to CIE.

- Field initiated, under which applicants address innovative topic areas not otherwise included in this priority or combine two or more topic areas into one application.

Grant recipients will develop, implement, evaluate, refine, and disseminate new or substantially improved model strategies or programs to transition youth and adults with disabilities to CIE. Additionally, the grant recipients should design the model demonstration projects for easy adoption by others.

Additional examples of supporting career pathways for adults—including playbooks to Unlock Career Success for Adult Learners, OCTAE's Future Finder Challenge, ADVANCE IEC, and Ability to Benefit—can also be found in strategic objectives 1.4 and 4.4.

Innovating Tools for Careers

Through the Career Z Challenge, OCTAE sponsored an open innovation prize competition seeking creative solutions to expand student access to high-quality, WBL opportunities that will prepare them to be contributing members of today's workforce and propel them into successful careers of the future. Schools, districts, and consortiums were invited to share ideas for creating or enhancing WBL opportunities. Seventy-three semi-finalists received technical assistance to support the refinement and implementation of their proposed WBL ecosystem plan. They also participated in a community of practice and had access to learning workshops, peer collaboration opportunities, and other resources. In August 2024, 10 finalists were selected to move on to the next phase (ending in 2025), in which they will receive enhanced and tailored technical assistance to accelerate the expansion and sustainability of their WBL ecosystem. This intensified technical assistance will include one-on-one coaching, online collaboration space, resources, as well as in-person and virtual events. Each finalist who completes the phase 3 requirements will be eligible to receive a prize award of $150,000.

In addition, through OCTAE's CTE Momentum initiative, the Department annually invites educators and high school students to participate in a new challenge focused on a topic of national importance. This annual series empowers educators with resources and inspiration to help American schools become centers of innovation and possibility. In February 2024, the Department announced eight winning teams of the Your Place in Space Challenge, which invited teams to submit designs for a product or service that advances space missions and exploration. This challenge sought to create engaging learning opportunities for students to explore the challenges and opportunities in space missions, connect CTE programs with a wide variety of space careers, and inspire students to envision and pursue space careers. The next challenge in the CTE Momentum series—the Power Your Future Challenge—launched in August 2024, inviting teams to submit action plans that will advance the use of clean energy in their schools and communities. By participating, teachers and students will get hands-on experience envisioning and designing clean energy solutions that can make a real-world impact, with winners announced February 2025.

Separately, through the Employability Skills Framework 2.0, OCTAE began development of a central clearinghouse of free resources on instruction and assessment for employability skills. Using the interactive framework, policymakers, practitioners in education and workforce training, and others can identify employability skills and compare the skills identified by various instructional standards and assessments, understand key considerations for selecting an employability skills assessment, create a customized assessment comparison worksheet, and view practical examples of employability skills instruction and assessment. This project furthers the Administration's RTB Initiative, specifically to help design and implement WBL opportunities based on industry-sought credentials. Currently in its research phase, this

project will address employers who cannot find enough skilled workers to hire for in-demand jobs they must fill to grow their business, education and training programs that need better information on what skills those in-demand jobs require, and hard-working Americans, whether studying, looking for work, or wanting better career paths, who often are not sure what training to pursue and whether jobs will be waiting for them when they finish.

Performance Indicators

4.3.1 Number of technical assistance activities (e.g., events, trainings, convenings, webinars, communications, and products) focused on supporting increased stackability and transferability of postsecondary programs.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	5	9	9	3

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Perkins V National Activities contract deliverables and Perkins V statutory discretionary grants activities, WIOA Title II contract deliverables, and other staff technical assistance events.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024

4.3.2 Number of technical assistance activities (e.g., events, trainings, convenings, webinars, communications, and products) focused on the use of promising or evidence-based practices to connect students in postsecondary and adult education to basic needs support.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	96	154	91	70

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Literacy Information and Communication System Technical Assistance Center.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

Strategic Objective 4.4

Improve the alignment across secondary, postsecondary, and career and technical education programs, including through transparent and effective transition processes, inclusive pathways, and clear credentialing requirements.

Strategic Objective Leader: Assistant Secretary, Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has four performance indicators. Of these indicators, three met their targets, and one is pending available data.

Key Successes and Opportunities

Integrating Education and Training

The ADVANCE Integrated Education and Training (IET) project represents a commitment by the Department to help state and local adult education staff plan, design, implement, and evaluate effective IET programs and service approaches that are responsive to state and local labor market demands. To provide new training opportunities and resources to assist state adult education offices, professional development providers, and local program staff in enhancing and expanding IET programs for adult education participants, through ADVANCE IET, the Department built on the inaugural *Increasing IET Opportunities for Adults National Leadership Activity (2019–2022)*.

The Department conducted seven IET Design Camp cohorts that offered a mix of foundational and advanced IET design training; deployed a national IET coaching cadre to provide customized and targeted state technical assistance to support scaling and sustaining; curated and distributed IET program and instructional resources; developed a video series documenting implementation strategies, promising program design, and specialized models that serve diverse learners; and completed three new self-paced online learning courses for practitioners and administrators made publicly and freely available through the Literacy Information and Communication System.

The Integrated Education and Training in Corrections (IETC) project represents a commitment by the Department to provide resources and technical assistance to help state and local adult education and corrections staff plan, design, implement, and evaluate effective IET programs and service approaches in correctional facilities that are responsive to state and local labor market demands through a design camp model. To support *Adult Education and Family Literacy Act* (AEFLA) grantees and states working in correctional facilities, through IETC, the Department produced and provided resources and technical assistance for adult educators and corrections staff in developing and delivering IET programs in correctional facilities. The Department pilot-tested the development and delivery of IET programs in prisons and jails in Indiana, Maryland, Minnesota, Mississippi, Texas, and West Virginia as part of a prior Department-funded project. The IETC project conducted four virtual state leadership academies that prepared state and local leaders for the IETC design camps and assisted them with developing a strategy for supporting IET programs in their correctional facilities, conducted four in-person IETC design camp trainings to help state teams develop and implement IET programs in correctional settings, launched virtual affinity groups to explore specific IET implementation topics after design camps

concluded, and conducted a cross-cohort showcase activity for design camp participants to share their progress with IET program development as well as learn from their peers' experiences.

Access and Alignment

The Department has contributed to growing awareness among educators and the public of the value of dual enrollment opportunities and inequities in access to and participation in dual enrollment by students who are African American, Hispanic, Native American, from economically disadvantaged backgrounds, English learners, and students with disabilities. The Career-Connected High School grants awarded in January will support the implementation of strategies to address these inequities and may result in proof points from which others can learn. In November 2023, the Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education (OCTAE) also hosted a national webinar on dual enrollment and economic mobility that highlighted new resources from the Community College Research Center on dual enrollment equity pathways, a research-based framework for rethinking dual enrollment as a more equitable on-ramp to college programs of study that lead to family-supporting, career-path jobs for students who might not otherwise pursue education after college. In February 2023, OCTAE met with 46 state teams to discuss Unlocking Career Success (UCS), including discussing their dual enrollment policies.

The Department continues to engage higher education leaders and practitioners to promote transferability across postsecondary institutions. As part of its Raise the Bar (RTB): Attaining College Excellence and Equity initiative, the Department hosted a summit in November 2023 with 200 higher education leaders on making it easier for students to transfer from one college to another, in turn helping them save time and money. The Department also released groundbreaking new data showing which two- and four-year institutions are best promoting transfer students' success and highlighting the most productive transfer partnerships between community college and bachelors' degree institutions in the country. The Department also continued to widely disseminate among institutions of higher education a 2021 technical assistance guide to stackable credentials (Introduction to Stackable Credentials), including at convenings of the American Association of Community Colleges Workforce Development Institute and the American Association of Community College.

Through its UCS RTB Summit, OCTAE continued to promote career-connected learning that can drive student success at colleges and universities. As a part of this summit, some of the key themes included dual enrollment; early academic experiences (including building students' momentum toward earning credentials of value from the start through dual enrollment, contextualized acceleration through developmental education reform, and career-connected math pathways); career advising and navigation; and guidance to help students develop clear goals to make informed decisions from high school to postsecondary and career. Other subjects discussed at the summit include navigating transfer pathways; providing work-based learning; offering students meaningful career-connected learning experiences in their field (such as undergraduate research, internships, co-ops, pre-apprenticeship, and apprenticeships, including leveraging the Federal Work Study Program); providing workforce credentials; and ensuring students have access to structured academic pathways—including transfer pathways—that clearly connect learning outcomes to workforce skills so students earn in-demand credentials that give them a competitive edge in the labor market.

In fiscal year (FY) 2024, OCTAE also supported Ability to Benefit (ATB) efforts through multiple avenues. New guidance and regulations on ATB spurred attention from the field and

increased demand for technical assistance. OCTAE is addressing this demand through a series of stakeholder engagements, outreach, and guidance to the field in partnership with the Office of Postsecondary Education (OPE) and Federal Student Aid (FSA) and targeted technical assistance funded through OCTAE national activities funds. OCTAE is also working internally at the Department with other Principal Operating Components that are interested in or have jurisdiction over ATB recipients to coordinate guidance and technical assistance, which will continue into FY 2025. OCTAE held outreach efforts across the fiscal year, presenting on ATB at the American Association of Community Colleges annual convening in Louisville, KY, and the American Association of Community Colleges Workforce Development Institute in New Orleans, LA. OCTAE, OPE, and FSA published a Dear Colleague Letter on June 20, 2024, and drafted guidance on new ATB regulations that went into effect July 1, 2024. OCTAE also funded a technical assistance initiative through braided Perkins and AEFLA national activities funds to assist states and community colleges with ATB efforts, which will start in the first quarter of FY 2025.

Additional examples of Department efforts to support access alignment—including playbooks for UCS, Unlocking Pathways State Policy Heat Map, UCS summits, the Career-Connected High Schools Grant Program, Future Finder Challenge, Career Z Challenge, and Employability Skills Framework 2.0—can also be found in strategic objectives 1.4 and 4.3.

Performance Indicators

4.4.1 Percentage of Upward Bound and Talent Search high school degree completers who are reported in the Annual Performance Report to have completed a rigorous program of study.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	78%	76.5%	75%	TBD	77%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year (FY) 2021. FY 2024 data are expected in February 2025.
Data Source: Upward Bound and Upward Bound Math–Science Annual Performance Report (APR): (Field #37—Rigorous Study) and Talent Search APR (Sections 3 and 4).
Period of Performance: Program year 2022–2023.

4.4.2 Number of technical assistance activities (e.g., events, convenings, trainings, webinars, communications, and products) focused on implementing and improving integrated education and training programs, including in correctional and reentry education.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	53	87	76	60

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education (OCTAE) contract: Supporting Integrated Employment and Training for Adult Learners and OCTAE contract: Expanding Integrated Education and Training in Corrections Education.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

4.4.3 Number of technical assistance activities that encourage equity-focused strategies around dual enrollment and the Ability to Benefit provisions of the *Higher Education Act of 1965*.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	1	6	11	8

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education staff and contract-supported activities.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 2024.

4.4.4 Percentage of economically disadvantaged high school graduate career and technical education (CTE) concentrators that attain postsecondary credits in the relevant CTE program or program of study through a dual or concurrent enrollment or another credit transfer agreement in the 12 states that report for the *Carl D. Perkins Career and Technical Education Act*.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	39.80%	33.55%	34.45%	34.00%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Perkins V States' Consolidated Annual Reports.
Period of Performance: Program year 2023–2024.

STRATEGIC GOAL 5

Enhance the Department's internal capacity to optimize the delivery of its mission.

GOAL LEADER
Assistant Secretary, Office of Finance and Operations



WHY IT MATTERS

The effective management and innovative use of technology within the Department are vital for fulfilling its mission and supporting both employees and stakeholders. These essential resources enable our workforce to adeptly address the needs of students and families, efficiently manage data for improved outcomes, and prioritize strategic planning. Goal 5 underscores management's pivotal role in steering the Department toward its objectives. In fiscal year 2024, the Department achieved remarkable advancements, such as bolstering its Zero Trust Architecture with a robust Secure Access Service Edge solution, launching an Open Data Platform to better track data assets, and creating competency assessments for job series that enhance workforce planning initiatives. Notably, the Department not only met but exceeded its small business contracting goal of 17.46 percent, achieving an impressive $448 million, while also surpassing its targets for women-owned small businesses and historically underutilized business zones.

Strategic Goal 5

Objectives at a Glance

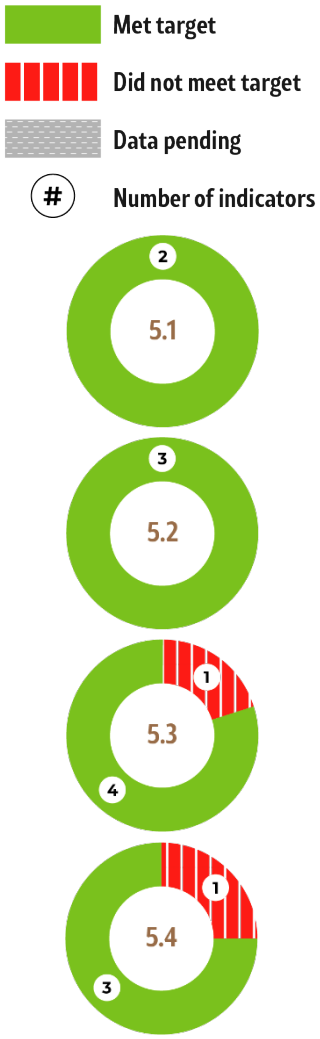
Four objectives guide the Department's work in goal 5. In fiscal year 2024, the Department assessed 14 performance indicators for this goal. Of these indicators, 12 met their targets; 2 did not meet targets, and 2 are pending available data.

5.1 Manage information technology as a strategic resource and driver to promote the advancement of the missions executed by the Department's 21st-century workforce.

5.2 Strengthen agency-wide data governance and build capacity to improve data access, data management, and enterprise data analytics in support of agency goals.

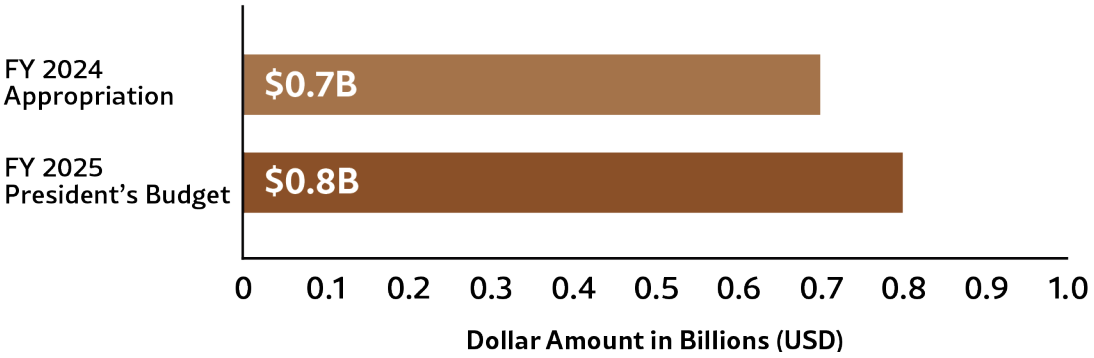
5.3 Recruit, retain, and develop the workforce needed to meet the Department's mission now and into the future.

5.4 Deliver mission outcomes and value for taxpayers through efficient acquisition management and proactive industry partnerships while promoting small businesses.



Goal 5 Budgetary Resources

The following figure and table show budgetary resources and major programs and activities supporting goal 5.



Major Programs and Activities Supporting Goal 5 (in thousands)

POC	Objective	Major Programs and Activities	FY 2024 Appropriation	FY 2025 President's Budget
All	5.3	Departmental Management/IES Program Administration (D)	$493,407	$557,696
OCR	5.3	Office for Civil Rights (D)	$140,000	$162,359
OIG	5.3	Office of Inspector General (D)	$67,500	$77,497

Notes: (1) Dollar amounts are estimates of program funding aligned to the strategic goal (Appendix F). As programs may support more than one strategic goal, amounts included here may be reflected in budget tables for other strategic goals. Please refer to the Department's Budget Tables for additional information on FY 2024 Congressional Action and the FY 2025 President's Budget Request. (2) Negative dollar amounts (indicated by values in parentheses) represent a downward re-estimate for the program. (3) Letters following major programs and activities denote discretionary (D) or mandatory (M).
Acronyms and Definitions: POC = Principal Operating Component; FY = Fiscal Year; IES = Institute of Education Sciences; OCR = Office for Civil Rights; and OIG = Office of Inspector General.
Mandatory Programs: No additional mandatory programs.

Strategic Objective 5.1

Manage information technology as a strategic resource and driver to promote the advancement of the missions executed by the Department's 21st-century workforce.

Strategic Objective Leader: Chief Information Officer, Office of the Chief Information Officer

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has two performance indicators; both met their annual target.

Key Successes and Opportunities

Strengthening Cybersecurity

The Office of Inspector General again recognized the Department's enterprise cybersecurity program's maturity level as "Effective," obtaining the Level 4 Cybersecurity Maturity Level. These scores are record achievements for the Department to date.

The Department again received multiple recognitions and awards from the Federal Information Systems Security Educators Association (FISSEA). FISSEA is an organization run by and for federal government information security professionals to assist federal agencies in strengthening their employee cybersecurity awareness and training programs. This year, the Department received awards for the Cybersecurity Symposium site, Cybersecurity Blog for Cybersecurity bits and bytes, and Training Awareness for best immersive web-based training.

The Department adopted a Secure Access Service Edge (SASE) solution in support of advancing its Zero-Trust Architecture (ZTA) capabilities in support of federal requirements as outlined in Office of Management and Budget (OMB) Memorandum M-22-09. In fiscal year 2024, the Department implemented a software-defined wide-area network to extend ZTA protections offered by SASE to branch office locations.

The Department's implementation of certificate-based authentication was recognized by the General Services Administration for several best practices which have been incorporated into the Federal Identity, Credential, and Access Management (ICAM) Architecture implementation guidance for all federal agencies.

The enterprise ICAM Program has added a new capability for Privileged Identity Management, which provides additional security controls for privileged user functions.

Advancing Information Technology Governance and Infrastructure

The Department doubled its network bandwidth for the headquarters building, quadrupled Wi-Fi connections, outfitted all flex spaces with over 700 sets of information technology (IT) peripherals, disseminated a how to guide (Get Started with IT) in every workspace, created a Return to Workplace (RTW) landing page with all the RTW resources on the Department's Intranet, delivered video teleconferencing training to more than 1,000 staff members, and conducted daily floor walks to ensure all the staff members' IT needs were met while working onsite.

The Department is on track to complete the first two phases of the ed.gov modernization effort. The new and enhanced look and feel of the Department's public website will provide enhanced customer experience, using a more robust and secure content management system and customer-orientated design.

The Department completed the configuration of Internet Protocol Version 6for the core services, including network services, identity, and access management solutions. The Department enhanced customer experience by prioritizing user-centric service delivery, resulting in a 67 percent improvement in average speed to answer time.

The Office of the Chief Information Officer (OCIO) coordinated efforts to transition the Department from a paper-based to a digitized organization in accordance with OMB Memorandums M-19-21 and M-23-07. These efforts fulfilled a two-fold goal of the timely transition of records to the National Archives to meet OMB mandates while also clearing critical infrastructure needed to successfully support the Department's post-COVID-19 return to the office initiative.

In 2024, OCIO spearheaded the Department's organizational goal of meeting the mandates of the President's Executive Order (EO) 14110 on the Safe, Secure, and Trustworthy Development and Use of Artificial Intelligence. As a result, the Department was able to assert 100 percent completion on all 20 of the EO's key goals and objectives.

Performance Indicators

5.1.1 Department's Office of the Chief Information Officer Information Technology cybersecurity composite score.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	86.5%	88%	88%	80%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and the target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Department of Homeland Security's (DHS's) CyberScope quarterly risk management assessment, the Department's Cybersecurity Framework Risk Scorecard, the previous fiscal year's Office of Inspector General *Federal Information Security Modernization Act of 2014* maturity score, and DHS Cyber Hygiene reports.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

5.1.2 Department's Office of the Chief Information Officer Information Technology (IT) scorecard score.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	93%	92%	97%	93%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: The initial baseline customer feedback scoring methodology is based on the following: IT Feedback Survey, Helpdesk Customer Satisfaction Survey, Helpdesk First Call Resolution Survey, and General Services Administration Mission support customer survey IT-related result outcome.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

Strategic Objective 5.2

Strengthen agency-wide data governance and build capacity to improve data access, data management, and enterprise data analytics in support of agency goals.

Strategic Objective Leader: Chief Data Officer, Office of Planning, Evaluation, and Policy Development

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has three performance indicators; all three met their targets.

Key Successes and Opportunities

Implementing Data Strategy 2.0

The Department's updated Data Strategy, published in August 2023, includes 16 new objectives and covers a three-year time horizon. Progress was achieved on multiple objectives, with 4 of 16, or 25 percent, objectives completed in fiscal year (FY) 2024. Throughout 2024, the Department focused on advancing agency-wide data maturity, developing a data validation methodology to assess the strategic alignment of existing data investments, implementing various data quality initiatives, and improving intra and inter-agency data sharing as part of Data Strategy Goal 1. Data Strategy Goal 2 activities focused on executing the data workforce plan, which aspires to address agency staffing and training needs while the Department continued to augment and expand its data skills programs for Department staff at different proficiency levels to help agency staff improve their data visualization and storytelling capacity.

Aligned with the agency's revision of its Information Quality Guidelines in fall 2023, starting in April 2024, data quality plans are expected for data collections that are disseminated publicly. To support principal offices in implementing the revised guidelines, the Department's Office of the Chief Data Officer (OCDO) developed technical assistance resources, including training materials and guidance for incorporating data quality plans into the formal information collection request (ICR) process. In addition, OCDO conducted technical assistance meetings with principal offices having an identified data collection for which this requirement applied in 2024. Six programs utilized the resources and assistance to successfully include data quality plans with the ICR packages.

The three-year implementation of the Data Strategy focuses initially on the foundational governance and capacity-building work of Goals 1 and 2, which support the practices and operations of Goals 3 and 4. The Data Governance Board (DGB) operates several working groups to achieve agency-wide progress, including the Open Data, Equitable Data, and Data Action Research groups. To advance the strategic use of data under Goal 3, the agency continued to strengthen the evidence-building pipeline by addressing the Learning Agenda's priority learning questions and continued to identify gaps in Department data while supporting the agency's grant management and student loan servicing systems, which will continue through FY 2026. Finally, under Goal 4, in September 2024, the agency published its inaugural Open Data Plan, and throughout 2024, it continued to expand the comprehensive data inventory, enhance transparency through access to agency administrative data, and strengthen the data release and disclosure review processes.

Cultivating the Department's Data Community and Strengthening Agency Capacity

In FY 2024, the Department's Data Professionals Community of Practice (DPCoP), a member-driven community open to all Department data professionals, planned and executed an internal agency-wide Data VizPalooza 2024, successfully completing the public commitment for Data Strategy Objective 2.3. The week of learning featured over 30 sessions for Department staff and garnered over 1,500 cumulative session attendances. Additionally, DPCoP supports the agency's data culture through several interest groups, including Data Visualization, SAS Users, and Open-Source Programming, which support the technical initiatives of data professionals. Throughout FY 2024, DPCoP convened a total of 12 meetings which spanned more than 30 data topics and featured presenters from 11 principal offices.

In early FY 2024, the agency graduated the second cohort of more than 30 employees across 10 principal offices who successfully completed the 2023–2024 Department Data Science Training Program (EDSTP). The program integrates Department staff-led classes, online instruction, mentorship, and hands-on projects to accomplish the overall goal of improving the data science skills of Department employees. In spring 2024, the Department kicked off the third cohort of EDSTP, inducting nearly 60 staff members across 13 principal offices into the 2024–2025 program year, which featured enhanced curriculum, new courses, and increased office hours support. Additionally, this year, the Department is providing 12 federal agencies interested in implementing a comparative program with a virtual seat at the training table to audit the Department's ongoing 2024–2025 program.

The agency continued its efforts to strengthen data governance and measure progress. In early FY 2024, OCDO led the administration of the principal office Data Maturity Assessment (DMA). The nine offices assessed during the 2024 cycle used the new online tool and DMA rubric to assess and submit progress on their data maturity. Five of the nine offices improved in overall data maturity, and DGB further identified priorities for data maturity improvements and developed associated resources to support such improvements throughout FY 2025.

Expanding Access to and Use the Department's Data

The Department's Open Data Platform (ODP) is a central repository for information about the Department's data assets. It featured 997 data assets at the end of FY 2024, exceeding the Department's FY 2024 performance target within this strategic objective. OCDO is also working with offices to complete descriptions of data assets that are currently only partially defined in the data inventory.

The Department's Open Data Plan serves as the Department's core strategy to meet the *Evidence Act's* requirement to make data open by default. The Open Data Plan, as described in Objective 4.1 of the Data Strategy, was published in September 2024. Additionally, in spring 2024, OCDO hosted the Department's Open Data Day Public Forum, an interactive public webinar to build awareness of and further improve the Department's open data practices, platforms, and resources.

In support of the agency's Raise the Bar: Lead the World goals to advance educational equity and excellence, in FY 2024, OCDO developed a series of key analytics and data visualization products. Using data that are publicly available, the agency is putting informative data visualizations to work, presenting data on eliminating educator shortages, investing in every students' well-being, spotlighting apprenticeship programs, and more in new and compelling ways for the public.

Increasing Transparency Through the Education Stabilization Fund Public Transparency Portal

The Department launched the Education Stabilization Fund (ESF) Transparency Portal in 2020 to provide transparency into how the $276 billion investment in education provided for state and institutional COVID-19 recovery and rebuilding efforts were awarded and spent. In 2024, the Department focused on increasing and improving precollection technical assistance efforts designed to aid ESF grantees and ensure accurate and timely reporting. This included annotated data collection forms, prefilled reporting templates, data dictionaries, updated business rule guides, and grantee annual performance report checklists. Additionally, OCDO offered more hands-on technical assistance and live training to engage grantees.

The Department completed the initial data collection of the 2023 annual performance reports for the Elementary and Secondary Education Relief (ESSER), Emergency Assistance to Non-Public Schools (EANS), and Governor's Emergency Education Relief (GEER) Fund grantees throughout summer 2024. All GEER and EANS Fund grantees submitted initial annual performance reports on time, as did nearly 90 percent of ESSER Fund grantees. The agency then conducted post-collection data quality reviews, generating detailed feedback reports to further guide grantees with updating or correcting data submissions remitted to the agency during the annual performance report correction windows scheduled throughout fourth and first quarters of FY 2024 and FY 2025, respectively.

In addition to the collection of the 2023 annual performance reports, the Department released two public-facing reports summarizing both the ESSER FY 2022 data and HEER calendar year 2022 data and posted the FY 2022 ESSER, GEER, EANS, ESF-State Educational Agency, ESF-GOV, and HEER Funds annual performance report datasets and new visualizations to the ESF Transparency Portal in spring 2024. The agency continues to invest in improving the quality of the data on the ESF Transparency Portal to provide a transparent and comprehensive view into how ESF grant funds are awarded and spent.

Performance Indicators

5.2.1 Percentage of Data Strategy objectives completed.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	74%	84%	25%	15%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and the target for this performance indicator were established in FY 2022. The FY 2024 data will be based on an updated Data Strategy with a new set of objectives, which was published in August 2023. The title was revised in FY 2023; refer to Appendix C.
Data Source: The Department's Data Strategy Implementation Tracker.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

5.2.2 Percentage of principal offices assessed as having higher data maturity scores year over year based on the Department's data maturity assessment (DMA) tool.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	79%	87.5%	56%	10%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in FY 2022.
Data Source: The Department's annual DMA.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

5.2.3 Percentage of principal offices assessed as having higher average staff data skills scores year over year based on the Department's Data and Evidence Use Survey.						
FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	14%	—	—	—

Notes: Performance indicator was discontinued in fiscal year 2023.

5.2.4 Number of Department data assets accessible in the enterprise data analytics platform.						
FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	—	—	—	—

Notes: Performance indicator was discontinued in fiscal year 2023.

5.2.5 Number of data assets in the comprehensive data inventory.						
FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	652	825	997	850

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and the target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: The Department's comprehensive data inventory (https://data.ed.gov/).
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

Strategic Objective 5.3

Recruit, retain, and develop the workforce needed to meet the Department's mission now and into the future.

Strategic Objective Leader: Chief Human Capital Officer, Office of Finance and Operations

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has five performance indicators. Of these indicators, four met their annual targets, and one did not meet its target.

Key Successes and Opportunities

Increasing Department Workforce Planning Maturity Level

The Department's Workforce Maturity Model is a valuable tool for assessing the quality and effectiveness of workforce planning processes and continuously evaluating staffing needs against organizational objectives.

In fiscal year (FY) 2024, the Department used this model to efficiently manage its resources by enhancing strategic alignment, using analytics and data to inform workforce decisions, managing staffing risks through succession planning, improving understanding of workforce needs to develop effective recruitment and retention strategies, identifying skills gaps, and leveraging technology and automation. This approach helped the Department identify the skills and capabilities needed to enhance workforce efficiency and effectiveness toward meeting organizational goals, guide continuous workforce development, and inform staffing needs for both the current and future state of the agency.

Improving Time to Hire

The Department continues to strive for the 80-day or fewer time to hire (TTH) established by the Office of Personnel Management (OPM) that has eluded most Government agencies. In FY 2024, the Department's TTH fell below the Government-wide average but was still above the OPM goal.

OPM also established subgoals for hiring elements on the End-to-End Hiring Roadmap within their 80-day TTH model. In FY 2024, the Department successfully met the goal for the maximum number of calendar days (31 days) for Human Resources Offices with a metric of 17 days. Other bottlenecks, such as calendar days for manager hold times and background checks, continue to beleaguer the Department's overall TTH.

Increasing Employee Engagement

The Department achieved impressive results in the FY 2024 Federal Employee Viewpoint Survey (FEVS) employee engagement score, recording a 75 percent engagement rate. This result exceeded the target of 70 percent, continuing a four-year trend of meeting or outperforming the set goals. The consistent improvement in employee engagement highlights the Department's commitment to fostering a positive workplace culture and addressing staff needs effectively. The sustained performance underscores the success of

initiatives aimed at enhancing communication, recognition, and opportunities for professional growth within the Department.

Offering Competency Assessments Across Occupational Series

The Department is developing and deploying competency assessments, by occupation series, to evaluate employees' knowledge, skills, and abilities for their work role. The assessments are used for various purposes, such as workforce planning, employee development, and sourcing training opportunities.

To increase the number of competency assessments completed in a fiscal year, the Office of Human Resources worked closely with executive sponsors for each occupational series to develop competency models so they could be uploaded into an automated tool and offered across the Department. This system tracks and manages federal employees' competency gaps by job series, principal office, and grade level.

Completing the competency assessments will provide the Department with valuable data for making decisions about training needs and recruitment. To support this initiative, the following resources are available:

- An online employee resource for the Competency Management Program.
- A FedTalent Information and Resource Page for Professional Development and Competencies.
- Documentation on the Department's competency models, including a link to completed competency models.

Improving Government-Wide Customer Satisfaction

The Department has demonstrated continuous improvement and ongoing communication with customers to streamline hiring processes and improved training, which led to an increase in the Department's overall Human Capital Function satisfaction, which met the FY 2024 target.

The Department continues to improve and exceed its goal for the FEVS employee engagement index score through a robust commitment to fostering a positive workplace culture. By actively soliciting employee feedback and implementing initiatives focused on professional development, work-life balance, and recognition programs, the Department has created an environment where staff feel valued and empowered. This ongoing dedication to employee engagement resulted in consistently high scores, reflecting the Department's successful efforts to enhance morale and productivity across the agency.

Performance Indicators

5.3.1 The Department's Workforce Planning Maturity Level.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	Level 1	Level 2	Level 2	Level 3	Level 3

Note: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and the target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2021.
Data Source: Principal Operating Component self-assessments against the Department's Workforce Planning Maturity Model.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

5.3.2 Time to hire.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	100 days	106 days	104 days	107	≤80 days

Note: This indicator does not include hiring data from Federal Student Aid, which operates separate human resource functions under flexibilities as a performance-based organization.
Data Source: Federal Personnel and Payroll System via Oracle Business Intelligence Enterprise Edition and recruitment tracking tools.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

5.3.3 Department Federal Employee Viewpoint Survey (FEVS) employee engagement index score.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
62%	70%	76%	76%	76%	75%	70%

Data Source: Office of Personnel Management FEVS.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

5.3.4 Number of competency assessments across the department's occupational series offered.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	—	2	4	4

Note: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and the target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2021.
Data Source: Competency Proficiency Tool.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

5.3.5 Government-wide score on the Customer Satisfaction Survey: Overall Human Capital Function.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	4.25	4.42	4.21	4.3	4.3

Note: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and the target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2021.
Data Source: Mission Support Customer Satisfaction Survey administered by the General Services Administration.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

Strategic Objective 5.4

Deliver mission outcomes and value for taxpayers through efficient acquisition management and proactive industry partnerships while promoting small businesses.

Strategic Objective Leader: Deputy Chief Acquisition Officer, Office of Finance and Operations

FY 2024 Performance Summary

This strategic objective has four performance indicators. Of these indicators, three met their annual targets, and one did not meet its target.

Key Successes and Opportunities

Expanding Small Business Contracting

The Department received an "A" rating on the U.S. Small Business Administration's Federal Scorecard released in July 2023. The annual scorecard is an assessment tool to measure how well federal agencies fulfill small business prime contracting and subcontracting goals. The Department implemented Creating and Leveraging Acquisition Small Business Strategies (CLASS) to elevate the Department's small business achievement by data-driven, fact-based decisions. CLASS was built on the Department's procurement forecasted items that were in the current fiscal year. In fiscal year (FY) 2024, the Department exceeded its small business goal, achieving 17.46 percent, totaling $448 million to small businesses. The Department exceeded the socioeconomic women-owned small business and historically underutilized business zone goal.

Transforming Acquisitions Management

The Department has transformed acquisition management by promoting smart, efficient, and cost-effective acquisition decision-making, through which the same kinds of goods and services are purchased through best value solutions. The Department developed a contract for a common acquisition management system, created mandatory use policy, and conducted acquisition training on system. The holistic approach to acquisition lifecycle management from early stages of the acquisition planning to closeout will create a uniformed approach to acquisition management business operations. Through establishing an acquisition innovation framework and policy, the Department provides guidance on a uniformed approach to streamlining acquisitions and reducing administrative burden. The Department partnered with the Procurement Innovation Lab (PIL) at the Department of Homeland Security to understand acquisition best practices and promote greater efficiencies in procurement. The Department coordinated three Civilian Services Acquisition Workshop events in support of the Better Contracting Initiative and to promote stronger acquisition requirements. The Department implemented a contract review process to provide stronger controls and oversight over procurements to mitigate performance and compliance risk.

Strengthening the Acquisition Workforce

In FY 2024, the Strategic Acquisition Management Initiatives (SAMI) division conducted two training sessions on the revised Department Acquisition Regulation. These sessions were attended by 210 acquisition professionals. Additionally, SAMI held three Category Management training sessions for 440 acquisition workforce professionals, which was a

dramatic 519 percent increase over last year, and had 328 acquisition professionals attend this year's SAMI Acquisition Workforce conference. SAMI managed and promoted the Virtual Acquisition Office resource, which allowed acquisition professionals to earn a total of 174.5 continuous learning points in FY 2024, as well as coordinated a Department-sponsored PIL Bootcamp for Acquisition Workforce. SAMI crafted and issued Senior Procurement Executive Acquisition Innovation Guidance in support of the President's Management Agenda Goal 1.1 and OMB memorandum Acquisition Innovation Labs and Pilot for Digital Acquisition Lab.

The Office of Small and Disadvantaged Business Utilization also conducted five vendor conferences and trainings and held eight in-reach training sessions.

Performance Indicators

5.4.1 Percentage of prime small business contract obligations.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	17.62%	17.73%	17.46%	16.00%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Small Business Administration Small Business Scorecard.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

5.4.2 Percentage of contract obligations categorized as "Spend Under Management."

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	75.0%	74.3%	51.2%	73.0%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Office of Management and Budget/General Services Administration Category Management Data-to-Decisions dashboard.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

5.4.3 Number of days of procurement administrative lead time of contract awards.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	104 days	119 days	65 days	≤140 days

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Office of Management and Budget/General Services Administration Benchmarking dashboard.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

5.4.4 Employee engagement index for the Department's acquisition workforce.

FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	
Actual					Actual	Target
—	—	—	63%	61%	67%	65%

Notes: Data from previous years are not included as the methodology and target for this performance indicator were established in fiscal year 2022.
Data Source: Office of Personnel Management Federal Employee Viewpoint Survey and Office of Management and Budget/General Services Administration Benchmarking dashboard.
Period of Performance: October 1, 2023–September 30, 2024.

APPENDICES

Appendix A. COVID-19 Pandemic Relief Funding Performance Indicators

Appendix A summarizes performance indicators for COVID-19 emergency relief funding. The Office of Management and Budget's memorandum M-20-21 requires the Department to include the *American Rescue Plan Act of 2021* (ARP), Elementary and Secondary School Emergency Relief (ESSER) Fund, and Higher Education Emergency Relief Fund in the established mission performance plans and reports for performance reporting on COVID-19 emergency relief funding.

Performance Indicators	FY 2022 Actual	FY 2023 Actual	FY 2024 Actual	FY 2024 Target
1. Amount spent within each Elementary and Secondary School Emergency Relief program on meeting students' academic, social, emotional, and other needs. **Note:** Data will be available in fiscal year (FY) 2025.	$6,135,079,987.56[3]	$13,455,675,650.78[4]	TBD	TBD
2. Percentage of institutions of higher education that are on enhanced monitoring under high-risk status and monitored for appropriate use of COVID-19 pandemic relief funding.	21.8%	.04%	N/A	≤10%
3. Number of technical assistance activities provided to institutions of higher education focused on ensuring proper use and reporting of Higher Education Emergency Relief Fund funding.	15	200	24	9
4. Percentage of institutions of higher education that report on their annual report that Higher Education Emergency Relief Fund funding enabled them to keep students enrolled who were at risk of dropping out due to pandemic-related factors. **Note:** FY 2024 data will be available in FY 2025.	89.8%—FY 2021 91%—FY 2022	91.54%	N/A[5]	>75%

[3] The FY 2022 actual is the total amount spent in each ESSER program: ESSER I $2,881,927,315.72, ESSER II $2,834,799,390.28, and ARP ESSER $418,353,281.56.
[4] This measure sums the total dollars spent in FY 2023 (the most recent year data are available), as reported through annual performance reporting, on salaries and benefits for meeting students' academic, social, emotional, and other needs (excluding mental health supports.
[5] FY 2023 was the final year for this collection. No data were collected in FY 2024 due to the small number of HEERF grants remaining.

Appendix B. Data Validity and Verification

Appendix B provides data validation and verification information for all performance indicators across the Department's five strategic goals and Appendix A.

Strategic Goal 1: Promote equity in student access to educational resources, opportunities, and inclusive environments.

1.1.1 Percentage of individual discretionary grant programs that include the Secretary's priority of promoting equity in student access to educational resources and opportunities (including absolute, invitational, or competitive preference priorities).	
Data Source:	Grants Policy Office Data Dashboard.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Grants Policy Office in the Office of Planning, Evaluation, and Policy Development tracks use of the Secretary's Priorities in discretionary grant programs across the Department and reports the data at the office and Department levels. The data are updated regularly throughout the fiscal year.

1.1.2 Percentage of states publishing report cards (as of January 15 annually) that include per-pupil expenditures of federal, state, and local funds, including actual personnel expenditures and actual non personnel expenditures of federal, state, and local funds disaggregated by source of funds for each local educational agency and school for either of the prior two years.	
Data Source:	School Support and Accountability—Title I program office.
Data Validation and Verification:	Staff review state websites on January 15 using a checklist to identify specific items that states must include on their report cards. The information is catalogued in an Excel file, and the team discusses issues to ensure consistency in how the information is tracked.

1.2.1 Number of local educational agencies who are subrecipients of American Rescue Plan Homeless Grants showing an increase in the number of students identified as homeless.	
Data Source:	ED*Facts* Consolidated State Performance Report.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Office of Elementary and Secondary Education conducts a thorough data quality review of the exiting data submitted by states to ensure compliance with the requirements of identifying and reporting students experiencing homelessness. Reviews focus on three areas: timeliness, completeness, and accuracy. Outstanding questions regarding accuracy may result in data suppression. If questions remain upon completion of the Department's data quality review process regarding whether the data submitted by a state are accurate, the Department may decide not to publish or use the data.

1.3.1 Number of policy guidance and fact sheets publications on the Office for Civil Rights' website that focus on how schools and districts serving students in prekindergarten through grade 12 and institutions of higher education may comply with Federal civil rights laws by avoiding and addressing discrimination based on race, color, national origin, disability, sex, and age.	
Data Source:	Generated data reports from an internal data-collection system.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Office for Civil Rights' guidance documents are posted on the Department website and circulated to stakeholders via Adobe Campaign.

1.3.2 Number of published civil rights data and user-friendly summaries of key data about the experiences of students, including their access to resources and educational opportunities through the Civil Rights Data Collection.	
Data Source:	Generated data reports from an internal data-collection system.

Data Validation and Verification:	The Office for Civil Rights' Civil Rights Data Collection publications are posted on the Department website and the Civil Rights Data website.

1.3.3 Number of proactive investigations that address possible violations of Federal civil rights laws.	
Data Source:	Generated data reports from an internal data-collection system.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Office for Civil Rights maintains an internal system that collects all data and documentation that is relevant to the evaluation, investigation, and resolution of complaints and the investigation and resolution of proactive activities.

1.3.4 Number of proactive outreach and technical assistance activities that provide stakeholders (e.g., students, parents and guardians, recipient educational institutions, and advocacy groups) with information concerning their rights and responsibilities under Federal civil rights laws.	
Data Source:	Generated data reports from an internal data-collection system.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Office for Civil Rights maintains an internal system that collects information concerning proactive outreach, technical assistance, and training activities.

1.3.5 Percentage of complaints that are resolved within 180 days.	
Data Source:	Generated data reports from an internal data-collection system.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Office for Civil Rights maintains an internal system that collects all data and documentation that is relevant to the evaluation, investigation, and resolution of complaints and the investigation and resolution of proactive activities.

1.3.6 Number of annual trainings on two substantive areas related to systemic investigations.	
Data Source:	Generated data reports from an internal data-collection system.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Office for Civil Rights maintains an internal system that collects information concerning proactive outreach, technical assistance, and training activities.

1.3.7 Percentage of students with disabilities who have an Individualized Educational Program who graduate from high school with a regular high school diploma.	
Data Source:	The Department's annual Children with Disabilities (*Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* [IDEA]) Exiting Special Education Data file, which includes state-reported data pulled from ED*Facts* File Specification 009/Data Group 85.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Office of Special Education Programs (OSEP) and ED*Facts* conduct a thorough data quality review of the exiting data submitted by states to ensure compliance with IDEA Section 618. Reviews focus on three areas: timeliness, completeness, and accuracy States submit these data via the EDPass system, which automatically runs a set of business rules to review the quality of the data submission. If the data submission is flagged based on the business rules, the state is required to submit an explanation via a data note. If OSEP has additional questions regarding the quality of a state's data submission, OSEP holds a conference call with the state to gain a better understanding of identified anomalies and provide technical assistance to empower the state to submit higher quality exiting data. Outstanding questions regarding accuracy may result in data suppression. If questions remain upon completion of the Department's data quality review process regarding whether the data submitted by a state are accurate, the Department may decide not to publish or use the data.

1.4.1 Percentage of adult education participants that achieve measurable skill gains (reporting for Native American and Alaska Native, Hispanic or Latino, Asian, Black or African American, Native Hawaiian or other Pacific Islander, White, and more than one race).	
Data Source:	National Reporting System for adult education annual program performance report from grantee submissions (Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education).
Data Validation and Verification:	State data quality attestation submitted with the annual performance report, state and federal data system validations, and data verifications conducted by state and federal staff.

1.4.2 Percentage of disaggregated student categories for which secondary career and technical education concentrators meet 90% of the average state determined performance level for secondary students being placed in postsecondary education; advanced training; military service; national, community service, or Peace Corps; or employment.	
Data Source:	States' Consolidated Annual Reports (CARs) submitted each January 31.
Data Validation and Verification:	State data quality attestation as part of their CAR, system-generated business rules, and staff data review process.

1.4.3 Number of eligible minority-serving institutions that can apply for competitive grant programs that contribute to student success, including access, support services, retention, and outreach.	
Data Source:	The Department's Federal Eligibility Matrix results in a list of eligible minority-serving institutions (MSIs) based on the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS) and Postsecondary Education Participants System (PEPS) data as well as institutional applications and waivers. The Office of Postsecondary Education will set targets to increase the number of eligible MSIs over the number of institutions from the prior year by providing technical assistance to community stakeholders.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Federal Eligibility Matrix is an annual standardized list of institutions that have been deemed eligible for Titles III, V, and VII grant programs based on IPEDS, PEPS, and institutional data.

Strategic Goal 2: Support a diverse and talented educator workforce and professional growth to strengthen student learning.

2.1.1 Percentage of participants in teacher preparation projects funded under the Indian Education Professional Development Grants Program who become teachers in local educational agencies that serve a high proportion of Indian students.	
Data Source:	Office of Indian Education (OIE): Professional Development—*Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) Measure, Professional Development Program Data Collection System (PDPDCS).
Data Validation and Verification:	OIE uses PDPDCS to validate and monitor this measurement. A sequence of milestone checks by three parties must be completed to validate this specific GPRA measure: • The institution of higher education that grants the four-year or graduate degree in the teaching subject must verify in the PDPDCS that the individual has completed teacher training and exit the participant from the training program in completion status. • Once in this completion status, the participant must log into PDPDCS and enter information about the qualifying local educational agency (LEA)[6] that has employed him/her/them as a teacher, including complete contact information for hiring personnel (i.e., district or school hiring official), and request service payback credit for time served (every six months, until payback complete). • The above participant's request for service payback credit for teaching in a qualifying LEA triggers the PDPDCS to issue a request to the hiring personnel to verify (sign a federal assurance) that the individual has been hired as a teacher and has completed the time in service being requested. The PDPDCS then calculates the raw number (and percentage) of participants whose milestones are complete, to come up with the figure for this specific GPRA measure.

2.1.2 Percentage of individual discretionary grant programs that include a priority (i.e., absolute, competitive, or invitational priority) that advances educator diversity.	
Data Source:	Grants Policy Office Data Dashboard.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Grants Policy Office in the Office of Planning, Evaluation, and Policy Development tracks use of the Secretary's Priorities in discretionary grant programs across the

[6] A qualifying LEA is an LEA that serves a high proportion of Indian students (an LEA with a proportion of Indian students above the statewide LEA average).

	Department and reports the data at both the office and Department level. The data are updated regularly throughout the fiscal year.

2.2.1 Percentage of candidates in teacher preparation programs who become teachers of record.	
Data Source:	Effective Educator Development Programs: Teacher Quality Partnership (TQP)—*Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) and Grantee Summaries.
Data Validation and Verification:	GPRA data are collected via the Annual Performance Report form. The initial form collects data for the first six months of the reporting period. At the end of the annual reporting period, grantees submit Data Verification Sheets to update the data submitted in the initial form. The TQP program staff collect both one-year and three-year teacher retention data; however, the first year's data are not received until year 3 or 4 of the five-year grant cycle. The fiscal year 2018 cohort will be reporting year 1 retention data in fall 2022.

2.2.2 Number of qualified teachers and school leaders retained in high-needs schools, including those who were recruited through teacher residency programs.	
Data Source:	Effective Educator Development (EED) Programs: Teacher and School Leader (TSL) Incentive Program—*Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) Measure and Grantee Summaries.
Data Validation and Verification:	In April 2022, EED provided baseline information indicating that in fiscal year (FY) 2021, TSL grantees retained 21,552 (approximately 88 percent) teachers and school leaders employed in participating high-need schools. TSL performance data validation and verification data were received in January 2023 and reconciled against figures provided in the annual report submission in January and February 2023.

2.3.1 Percentage of educators participating in leadership preparation programs.	
Data Source:	Effective Educator Development Programs: Supporting Effective Educator Development (SEED)—*Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) Measure.
Data Validation and Verification:	GPRA data are collected via the Annual Performance Report form. The initial form collects data for the first six months of the reporting period. At the end of the annual reporting period, grantees submit Data Verification Sheets to update the data submitted in the initial form. SEED GPRA measure 1 tracks participant data. In the 2020 (12) cohort, there were 2 SEED leadership programs. Data for these grants will not be available until fall 2022.

2.3.2 Percentage of local educational agencies indicating that one of their top two uses of Title II, Part A professional development funds is for professional development that is sustained, job-embedded, and/or collaborative.	
Data Source:	School Support and Accountability—Title II program *Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) measure.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Department awarded a contract to create a sample of Title II, Part A subgrant recipients to produce estimates that are representative of traditional school districts at the national and state levels and estimates that are representative of charter school districts at the national level. Additionally, a state-level survey is administered to state educational agencies in all 50 states, the District of Columbia, and Puerto Rico.

Strategic Goal 3: Meet students' social, emotional, and academic needs.

3.1.1 Number of high-impact activities or services implemented to ensure that parents are trained and can effectively engage in activities that will improve students' social, emotional, and mental health as well as academic development to include an understanding of how they can support learning in the classroom with activities at home or outside the school as well as how they can participate in state and local decision-making processes.	
Data Source:	School Choice and Improvement Programs—Statewide Family Engagement Center *Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) Measure.

Data Validation and Verification:	Data are collected through the online Annual Performance Report form. Data are reviewed by the technical assistance contractor and the program officer and published in the report produced by the technical assistance contractor.

3.1.2 Percentage of national chronic absenteeism.	
Data Source:	Chronic Absenteeism (EDFacts File 195).
Data Validation and Verification:	The Department collects chronic absenteeism data via ED*Facts* file specification 195. These data are collected annually at the school level and undergo the Office of Elementary and Secondary Education's data verification process, which includes a feedback and correction window with state educational agencies. The edit checks applied to the chronic absenteeism data are documented through the ED*Facts*' Business Rules Single Inventory.

3.1.3 Percentage of discretionary grant programs that include a priority (i.e., absolute, invitational, or competitive preference priority) that addresses student social, emotional, and mental health as well as academic needs.	
Data Source:	Grants Policy Office Dashboard.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Grants Policy Office in the Office of Planning, Evaluation, and Policy Development tracks use of the Secretary's Priorities in discretionary grant programs across the Department and reports the data at both the office and Department levels. The data are updated regularly throughout the fiscal year.

3.1.4 Percentage of schools that report annually an improved school climate based on the results of the Department's School Climate Surveys or via a similar tool.	
Data Source:	School Climate Transformation Grant: Local Educational Agency (LEA) *Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) Measure.
Data Validation and Verification:	School Climate Transformation Grant—LEA GPRA data are collected via the Annual Performance Report (APR) form. Program staff review all APRs. Data are then reviewed and aggregated by a technical assistance contractor and published in the following reports: the Department's *Fiscal Year (FY) 2023 Congressional Budget Justification for School Safety National Activities*; the Department's *FY 2020 Performance Summary Report* in support of the National Drug Control Strategy; and in the status update to the *2020 Government Accountability Office Report*.

3.1.5 Number of states with 80% or more prekindergarten children with disabilities that show greater-than-expected growth in social–emotional skills by the time they exit *Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* (IDEA) Part B, Section 619 services.	
Data Source:	IDEA Part B state annual performance reports (APR).
Data Validation and Verification:	The Office of Special Education Programs' (OSEP's) state leads review of each state's APR for data quality. The Monitoring and State Improvement Planning Division and OSEP's Early Childhood Technical Assistance Center, which has expertise in early childhood outcome measurement systems, review the full set of data for anomalies and other data quality concerns. The center publishes a brief on its data analysis methodology at https://ectacenter.org/. The number of states collecting high-quality data has increased over time as states continue to build their capacity to collect valid and reliable data. These efforts are supported by the center, which helps states build and improve their outcome measurement systems, collect and analyze data, and use data to make program improvements. States certify that the data they turn in to OSEP are accurate. The OSEP Director signs the determination letter for each state.

3.1.6 Number of states with 65% or more infants and toddlers with disabilities that show greater-than-expected growth in social–emotional skills by the time they exit *Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* (IDEA) Part C services.	
Data Source:	IDEA Part C state annual performance reports (APRs).
Data Validation and Verification:	The Office of Special Education Programs' (OSEP's) state leads review of each state's APR for data quality. The Monitoring and State Improvement Planning Division and OSEP's Early Childhood Technical Assistance Center, which has expertise in early childhood outcome measurement systems, review the full set of data for anomalies and other data quality concerns. The center publishes a brief on its data analysis methodology at http://ectacenter.org. The number of states collecting high-quality data has increased over time as states continue to build their capacity to collect valid and reliable data. These efforts are supported by the technical assistance center, which helps states build and improve their outcome measurement systems, collect and analyze data, and use data to make program improvements. States certify that the data they turn in to OSEP are accurate. The OSEP Director signs the determination letter for each state.

3.1.7 Number of successful grant applications that address the Secretary's supplemental priorities related to social, emotional, and academic needs.	
Data Source:	This will reflect the number of grants that fit this competitive preference priority of meeting students' social, emotional, and academic needs from 2022–2026.
Data Validation and Verification:	This will be a moving aggregate of grants year-over-year.

3.1.8 Number of schools that report fidelity data on their Positive Behavioral Interventions and Supports (PBIS) implementation efforts via PBIS apps.	
Data Source:	PBIS Assessment web application (www.pbisapps.org/products/pbis-assessment). Measures: Tiered Fidelity Inventory, Schoolwide Benchmarks of Quality, Schoolwide Evaluation Tool, Self-Assessment Survey, Team Implementation Checklist. Measurement Cycle: August 15 for the previous full school year.
Data Validation and Verification:	PBIS apps provide validated measurement tools, listed under Data Source, for schools to self-assess implementation fidelity. The PBIS technical assistance center provides training on using the measurement tools and access to a web-based analysis system to obtain implementation scores improve implementation fidelity in their PBIS efforts.

3.2.1 Percentage of grantees providing culturally responsive activities.	
Data Source:	Office of Indian Education (OIE) Title VI, Part A Formula *Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) measure, Annual Performance Reporting via Electronic Application System for Indian Education (EASIE).
Data Validation and Verification:	A culturally responsive activity is when a Native child is provided an opportunity to learn about a Native American language, cultural practice, tribal ecological knowledge, tribal history, or relationship to ancestral homelands. Each aspect of the culturally responsive activity reinforces the ability for a Native child to understand their place in time and how to strengthen their mental health and maturity as it relates to their cultural pride and their enrolled or affiliated identity to a federally or state recognized Tribal Nation. One example of an affiliated identity means when a Native individual can trace their descendance via Certificate Degree of Indian Blood. OIE receives both quantitative and qualitative activity data from grantees through an Annual Performance Report. OIE staff reviews and accepts the data as received. Reviewing protocols include checking for the presence and completeness of the self-reported data for any future analysis. OIE staff discuss anomalous or missing data with grantees to verify complete submissions. As an overall validity and reliability examination, the OIE compares self-reported data against annual substantial progress reporting to identify any data variances. EASIE Annual Performance Report guidance is available at: https://easie.communities.ed.gov/#communities/pdc/documents/20661.

3.2.2 Percentage of Student Support Service students served who persist into their next year of enrollment or attain a degree.	
Data Source:	Student Support Services' (SSS's) Annual Performance Report (APR).

Data Validation and Verification:	This report counts students who proceed to the next year of college. Calculation excludes new summer participants who are first served before they matriculate in the fall semester because most (perhaps all) these students are not persisting to their next year of enrollment, but rather are in their first academic year at the institution. Data are drawn from two tables within the SSS APR database: (1) the student record table for students served by two-year institutions (SSS2YearStudent) and (2) the student record table for students served by four-year institutions (SSS4YearStudent). Frequency/Available: Annually (quarter 3 report for prior year).

3.2.3 Percentage of prekindergarten children with disabilities attending general early childhood programs and receiving the majority of *Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* (IDEA) services in that setting.	
Data Source:	IDEA Part B Child Count and Educational Environments data file that includes state-reported data pulled from ED*Facts* File Specification 089/Data Group 613.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Office of Special Education Programs (OSEP) and ED*Facts* conduct a thorough data quality review of the Part B Child Count and Educational Environments data submitted by states to ensure compliance with IDEA Section 618. Reviews focus on three areas: timeliness, completeness, and accuracy. States submit these data via the EDPass system which automatically runs a set of business rules to review the quality of the data submission. If the data submission is flagged based on the business rules, the state is required to submit an explanation via a data note. If OSEP has additional questions regarding the quality of a state's data submission, OSEP holds a conference call with the state to gain a better understanding of identified anomalies and provide technical assistance to empower the state to submit higher-quality Part B Child Count and Educational Environments data. Outstanding questions regarding accuracy may result in data suppression. If questions remain upon completion of the Department's data quality review process regarding whether the data submitted by a state are accurate, the Department may decide not to publish or use the data.

3.2.4 Percentage of parents receiving Special Education Parent Information Centers services who report having enhanced capacity to effectively work with schools and service providers in meeting the needs of their children.	
Data Source:	Data and performance reports from Department-funded technical assistance centers.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Office of Special Education Programs (OSEP) staff conduct data reviews of grantee data from the Parent Training and Information Program. OSEP staff are responsible for locating, assessing, and recording annual performance data. Review protocols include checking and documenting the presence and completeness of data for analysis. OSEP staff discuss anomalous data with grantees, who verify or correct submissions. Valid anomalies are documented. Data are reviewed by OSEP prior to being submitted.

3.2.5 Percentage of students ages 14 through 21 with disabilities served under *Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* (IDEA) Part B who exit school by dropping out.	
Data Source:	The Department's annual Children with Disabilities (IDEA) Exiting Special Education Data File that includes state-reported data pulled from ED*Facts* File Specification 009/Data Group 85.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Office of Special Education Programs (OSEP) and ED*Facts* conduct a thorough data quality review of the exiting data submitted by states to ensure compliance with the IDEA Section 618. Reviews focus on three areas: timeliness, completeness, and accuracy. States submit these data via the EDPass system which automatically runs a set of business rules to review the quality of the data submission. If the data submission is flagged based on the business rules, the state is required to submit an explanation via a data note. If OSEP has additional questions regarding the quality of a state's data submission, OSEP holds a conference call with the state to gain a better understanding of identified anomalies and provide technical assistance to empower the state to submit higher quality exiting data. Outstanding questions regarding accuracy may result in data suppression. If questions remain upon completion of the Department's data quality review process regarding whether the data submitted by a state are accurate, the Department may decide not to publish or use the data.

3.2.6 Percentage of students with disabilities who spend 80% or more of the day inside a regular class.	
Data Source:	ED*Facts*—*Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* Part B Child Count and Educational Environment Data File that includes state-reported data pulled from ED*Facts* File Specification 002/ Data Group 74.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Office of Special Education Programs (OSEP) and ED*Facts* conduct a thorough data quality review of the child count and educational environments data submitted by states to ensure compliance with the IDEA Section 618. Reviews focus on three areas: timeliness, completeness, and accuracy. States submit these data via the EDPass system which automatically runs a set of business rules to review the quality of the data submission. If the data submission is flagged based on the business rules, the state is required to submit an explanation via a data note. If OSEP has additional questions regarding the quality of a state's data submission, OSEP holds a conference call with the state to gain a better understanding of identified anomalies and provide technical assistance to empower the state to submit higher-quality child count and educational environments data. Outstanding questions regarding accuracy may result in data suppression. If questions remain upon completion of the Department's data quality review process regarding whether the data submitted by a state are accurate, the Department may decide not to publish or use the data.

3.3.1 Percentage of students who attain proficiency in a Native language as determined by each grantee through pre- and post-assessments of Native language proficiency.	
Data Source:	Native American and Alaska Native Children in School Program—*Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) Measure.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Office of English Language Acquisition (OELA) program leads review of each grant's annual performance report for data quality. Each Program Officer reviews the full set of data for anomalies and other data quality concerns and works with the grantee to make corrections. The OELA contractor aggregates the GPRA data, qualitative data, and measures the data against initial targets. The contractor also reviews data for anomalies and any other data quality concerns before producing an annual report. The report supports OELA's technical assistance to grantees and is used to make program improvements. Program Officers certify that the data grantees turn in to OELA leadership are accurate.

3.3.2 Number of technical assistance and outreach activities that support (or increase awareness of supports for) the English learners' education community and/or its stakeholders.	
Data Source:	Tracking via contractor-produced and internally produced, quarterly technical assistance and outreach reports.
Data Validation and Verification:	Tracking via quarterly technical assistance and outreach reports.

3.3.3 Number of National Professional Development (NPD) grant participants who are enrolled and are making progress toward becoming state-certified, licensed, or endorsed in English learner instruction.	
Data Source:	NPD grant—*Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) Measure.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Office of English Language Acquisition (OELA) program leads review each grant's annual performance report for data quality. Each Program Officer reviews the full set of data for anomalies and other data quality concerns and works with the grantee to make corrections. The OELA contractor aggregates the GPRA data, qualitative data, and measures the data against initial targets. The contractor also reviews data for anomalies and any other data quality concerns before producing an annual report. The report supports OELA's technical assistance to grantees and is used to make program improvements. Program Officers certify that the data grantees turn in to OELA leadership are accurate.

3.3.4 Number of National Professional Development (NPD) grant participants who have become state-certified, licensed, or endorsed in English as a Second Language or bilingual instruction.	
Data Source:	NPD grant—*Government Performance and Results Act of 1993* (GPRA) Measure.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Office of English Language Acquisition (OELA) program leads review of each grant's annual performance report for data quality. Each Program Officer reviews the full set of

	data for anomalies and other data quality concerns and works with the grantee to make corrections. The OELA contractor aggregates the GPRA data, qualitative data, and measures the data against initial targets. The contractor also reviews data for anomalies and any other data quality concerns before producing an annual report. The report supports OELA's technical assistance to grantees and is used to make program improvements. Program Officers certify that the data grantees turn in to OELA leadership are accurate.

Strategic Goal 4: Increase postsecondary value by focusing on equity-conscious strategies to address affordability, completion, post-enrollment success, and support for inclusive institutions.

4.1.1 Number of technical assistance activities (e.g., events, trainings, and webinars) or products focused on the use of evidence-based practices to meet the social, emotional, academic, and other learning and developmental needs of students in postsecondary and adult education.	
Data Source:	Department offices that deliver technical assistance.
Data Validation and Verification:	Criteria for and examples of technical assistance events/activities and products are provided to program office representatives. The criteria are flexible to accommodate different technical assistance offerings provided across the Department. The Office of Planning, Evaluation, and Policy Development's Grants Policy Office reviews program offices' submission to address any anomalous data. The Department conducts level-setting meetings with staff charged with reporting from each program office to support the collection of standard and meaningful data. Contacts in each program office are responsible for certifying accuracy of the data.

4.1.2 Percentage of grant applicants from community colleges, Historically Black Colleges and Universities (HBCUs), Tribally Controlled Colleges and Universities (TCCUs), and minority-serving institutions (MSIs).	
Data Source:	G5 data.
Data Validation and Verification:	This performance indicator is measured by a moving aggregated percentage of total applications to all Office of Postsecondary Education grants that are classified as a community college (including two-year institutions, excluding MSIs and HBCUs), HBCUs, and MSIs (including TCCUs and excluding HBCUs). As some institutions fit into multiple categories, data are de-duplicated to ensure that institutions are only counted once in one category per grant competition. Different grants are competed year-to-year; therefore, this performance indicator measures the percentage of applicants for the grants that are competed cumulatively from fiscal year (FY) 2022–FY 2026.

4.1.3 Number of students with disabilities who receive counseling on enrollment in postsecondary education through the Vocational Rehabilitation (VR) Program.	
Data Source:	Rehabilitation Services Administration's (RSA) Case Service Report (RSA-911).
Data Validation and Verification:	Data are verified through federal review of state data submissions via annual reviews, on-site monitoring reviews, offsite review activities, and technical assistance. Each quarter, RSA develops quarterly data dashboards for each of the 78 state VR agencies and shares these files with its grantees. These tools assist both RSA and state VR agencies in identifying anomalies, errors, and areas for improvement in data collection and reporting. Further, they support RSA's efforts to foster continuous improvement in the quality of RSA-911 data.

4.1.4 Number of Vocational Rehabilitation (VR) Program participants who are enrolled in postsecondary education and training.	
Data Source:	Rehabilitation Services Administration's (RSA) Case Service Report (RSA-911).
Data Validation and Verification:	Data are verified through federal review of state data submissions via annual reviews, on-site monitoring reviews, off-site review activities, and technical assistance. Each quarter, RSA develops quarterly data dashboards for each of the 78 state VR agencies and shares these files with its grantees. These tools assist both RSA and state VR agencies in identifying anomalies, errors, and areas for improvement in data collection and reporting. Further, they support RSA's efforts to foster continuous improvement in the quality of RSA-911 data.

4.1.5 Number of engagements (i.e., meetings/events) with states, institutions, accrediting agencies, and associations with a focus on increasing college completion and closing attainment gaps among underserved populations.	
Data Source:	Office of Postsecondary Education (OPE) outreach reports.
Data Validation and Verification:	This performance indicator is measured by the number of Interactions and outreach with grantees, institutions of higher education, public groups, agencies, and associations, both formal and informal, to disseminate information on OPE programs and grants. This does not include technical assistance engagements. OPE uses a shared internal reporting spreadsheet to collect data.

4.1.6 Number of technical assistance and support activities provided to institutions.	
Data Source:	Office of Postsecondary Education technical assistance reports.
Data Validation and Verification:	This performance indicator is measured by the number of technical assistance engagements, at any stage of the grant process (pre and post), where the objective is to inform applicants to be more successful in a competition and to sustain objectives of their grants. An internal reporting spreadsheet is used for data collection on a quarterly basis.

4.2.1 Percentage of contractor interactions reviewed that received a passing score of 95%.	
Data Source:	Federal Student Aid's Vendor Management/Vendor Oversight and Program Accountability.
Data Validation and Verification:	This performance indicator is measured by the percentage of contractor interactions reviewed that received a passing score.

4.2.2 Percentage of contractors that achieve at least 95% accuracy in performing tasks.	
Data Source:	Federal Student Aid's Vendor Management/Vendor Oversight and Program Accountability.
Data Validation and Verification:	This performance indicator is measured by the accuracy of contractor tasks that were subject to quality assurance; measures the percentage of tasks that were performed correctly the first time.

4.2.3 Percentage of high school seniors submitting the *Free Application for Federal Student Aid*® (FAFSA®) form.	
Data Source:	Federal Student Aid's (FSA's) Central Processing System.
Data Validation and Verification:	FSA operational systems have procedures in place to address potential data quality issues. The process for querying system data is consistent and disciplined. A separate data analyst from a different office within FSA validates the accuracy of the query and the resulting data and validates any anomalous data. Queries and calculations are simultaneously conducted on data from previous years by FSA's Business Intelligence Team to ensure technical definitions remain consistent. The Customer Analytics Group is responsible for the primary calculation of the metric as well as the technical validation of the metric, which is done by reviewing for accuracy the query used to pull the data and all calculations made with the data. Finally, the Financial Reporting and Analysis Branch is responsible for ensuring that documentation is complete and archived. These calculations also restrict the application period to the first 9 months of the application cycle (through the close of the fiscal year) rather than the entire 18 months. Because most applicants, including high school seniors, file their FAFSA form prior to the start of the upcoming academic year (usually before fiscal year end), this decision better aligns the performance indicator with the fiscal year where most of the performance occurred.

4.2.4 Persistence among first-time *Free Application for Federal Student Aid*® (FAFSA®) filing aid recipients.	
Data Source:	Federal Student Aid's Common Origination and Distribution System.
Data Validation and Verification:	Data results are ascertained through standardized system queries. These queries are used to rerun and match calculations for earlier cycles as part of the verification and validity assessment.

4.2.5 Verification rate of *Free Application for Federal Student Aid*® (FAFSA®) filers.	
Data Source:	Central Processing System Database.
Data Validation and Verification:	The percentage of FAFSA applicants selected by Federal Student Aid (FSA) for verification or income and/or identity information to make sure all information filed is correct and as a method of preventing fraud and abuse. General Dynamics Information Technology provides the data, and FSA's Customer Analytics Group will verify. Data only include transactions on file as of September 30th of each fiscal year. Applications and correction transactions received after this point are excluded.

4.2.6 Satisfaction survey scores associated with the *Free Application for Federal Student Aid*® (FAFSA®) application.	
Data Source:	FAFSA (housed on StudentAid.gov) survey.
Data Validation and Verification:	Measured by satisfaction survey scores associated with the FAFSA application. The American Customer Satisfaction Index (ACSI) survey has been conducted annually for Federal Student Aid's major programs. The index provides a national, cross-industry, cross-sector economic indicator, using widely accepted methodologies to obtain standardized customer satisfaction information. Survey scores are indexed on a 100-point scale. The ACSI scores for application are weighted by the utilization of each process/service and the intensity of the service provided.

4.2.7 Number of sessions (as measured by completions) the Loan Simulator tool is used.	
Data Source:	Google Analytics.
Data Validation and Verification:	Loan Simulator tool completions will be measured using sessions that reach the confirmation page. The metric value is based on the number of visits or sessions (as opposed to unique visitors or page views).

4.2.8 Percentage of Individual Borrower Defense applications adjudicated timely.	
Data Source:	Feedback Dispute Management System.
Data Validation and Verification:	Borrower Defense is a type of federal student loan forgiveness where borrowers may be eligible for forgiveness of their federal student loans if the relevant school attended misled the borrower or engaged in other misconduct in violation of certain laws. This performance indicator measures the percentage of individual Borrower Defense applications

	adjudicated within timeframes stipulated by applicable regulation or court order, or two years when no timeframe exists. The total number of Borrower Defense applications required to be adjudicated that year pursuant to stipulated timeframes would serve as the denominator, and the total number of Borrower Defense applications adjudicated within that year would serve as the numerator. Adjudicated applications are those that have a final decision rendered, whether approved or denied. Weekly production data are derived from the Borrower Defense case management platform, which tracks progress and status of Borrower Defense applications through intake, adjudication, borrower notification, and loan servicer documentation on effectuated loan relief, where applicable.

4.3.1 Number of technical assistance activities (e.g., events, trainings, convenings, webinars, communications, and products) focused on supporting increased stackability and transferability of postsecondary programs.	
Data Source:	Department staff who deliver technical assistance.
Data Validation and Verification:	Self-reporting. Criteria for and examples of technical assistance events/activities and products are flexible to accommodate different opportunities and requests from stakeholders (to present at conferences, webinars, etc.).

4.3.2 Number of technical assistance activities (e.g., events, trainings, convenings, webinars, communications, and products) focused on the use of promising or evidence-based practices to connect students in postsecondary and adult education to basic needs support.	
Data Source:	Literacy Information and Communication System Technical Assistance Center.
Data Validation and Verification:	This performance indicator is measured through ongoing review of contractor deliverables. Relevant contractor deliverables include instructional resources, trainings and seminars, coaching, webinars, instructional videos, interactive infographics, community of practice events, online professional development modules, conference presentations and workshops, and social media postings, among others.

4.4.1 Percentage of Upward Bound and Talent Search high school degree completers who are reported in the Annual Performance Report to have completed a rigorous program of study.	
Data Source:	Upward Bound and Upward Bound Math–Science Annual Performance Report: (Field #37—Rigorous Study) and Talent Search (TS) Annual Performance Report (Sections 3 and 4).
Data Validation and Verification:	Numerator: (Upward Bound and Upward Bound Math–Science HS diploma recipients who completed a rigorous program of study + TS HS diploma recipients who completed a rigorous program of study). Denominator: (Upward Bound and Upward Bound Math–Science HS diploma recipients + TS HS diploma recipients). This is a lagging performance indicator. Prior year actual numbers will be reported in the following year based on report time frames for grantees. Therefore, report data reflect prior fiscal year actual information.

4.4.2 Number of technical assistance activities (e.g., events, convenings, trainings, webinars, communications, and products) focused on implementing and improving integrated education and training (IET) programs, including in correctional and reentry education.	
Data Source:	Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education (OCTAE) contract: Supporting Integrated Employment and Training for Adult Learners and OCTAE contract: Expanding Integrated Education and Training in Corrections Education.
Data Validation and Verification:	This performance indicator is measured through ongoing review of contractor deliverables. Relevant contractor deliverables include instructional resources, trainings and seminars, coaching, webinars, instructional videos, interactive infographics, community of practice events, online professional-development modules, conference presentations and workshops, and social media posting, among others.

4.4.3 Number of technical assistance activities that encourage equity-focused strategies around dual enrollment and the Ability to Benefit provisions of the *Higher Education Act of 1965*.	
Data Source:	Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education (OCTAE) staff and contract-supported activities.

Data Validation and Verification:	This performance indicator is measured through ongoing review of OCTAE staff and contractor deliverables. Relevant deliverables include agendas, talking points, slide decks, and, when available, transcripts for trainings and seminars, webinars, online professional-development modules, and conference presentations and workshops.

4.4.4 Percentage of economically disadvantaged high school graduate career and technical education (CTE) concentrators that attain postsecondary credits in the relevant CTE program or program of study through a dual or concurrent enrollment or another credit transfer agreement in the 12 states that report for the *Carl D. Perkins Career and Technical Education Act*.	
Data Source:	Perkins V States' Consolidated Annual Reports (CARS).
Data Validation and Verification:	State data quality attestation as part of their CAR, system-generated business rules, and staff data review process.

Strategic Goal 5: Enhance the Department's internal capacity to optimize the delivery of its mission.

5.1.1 Department's Office of the Chief Information Officer Information Technology cybersecurity composite score.	
Data Source:	Department of Homeland Security's (DHS's) CyberScope quarterly risk management assessment (RMA), the Department's Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) Risk Scorecard, the previous fiscal year's Office of Inspector General (OIG) *Federal Information Security Modernization Act of 2014* (FISMA) maturity score, and DHS Cyber Hygiene reports.
Data Validation and Verification:	Information derived from the data sources follows a formalized review process to ensure accuracy and timeliness of the information for the purposes of measuring the Department's progress across these areas. Specifically: • **DHS's quarterly RMA:** The Department receives and reviews the draft RMA report. Department approvals are then submitted through CyberScope. The RMA factor is calculated by averaging the security domain completion percentage results within each CSF function to determine the overall percentage of completion at the CSF function level. Peer reviews are conducted to ensure mathematical accuracy prior to finalizing this factor. • **The Department's CSF Risk Scorecard:** Department risk scores are compiled via Microsoft Power BI and verified based on the CSF Risk Scorecard standard operating procedure. Scores are continuously reviewed for accuracy prior to releases. • **The previous fiscal year's OIG FISMA maturity score:** The current FISMA capability maturity levels (1–5) correlate to a percentage of completion toward the desired goal of achieving level 5-optimized or 100% of the achievable outcomes. Peer reviews are conducted to ensure mathematical accuracy prior to finalizing this factor. • **DHS Cyber Hygiene reports:** The Department receives and reviews the DHS reports. After Department confirmation, percentages are averaged to determine the overall scoring percentage for the Cyber Hygiene factor. Peer reviews are also conducted to ensure mathematical accuracy prior to finalizing the reports.

5.1.2 Department's Office of the Chief Information Officer Information Technology (IT) scorecard score.	
Data Source:	The initial baseline customer feedback scoring methodology is based on the following: IT Feedback Survey, Helpdesk Customer Satisfaction Survey, Helpdesk First Call Resolution Survey, General Services Administration Mission support customer survey IT related result outcome.
Data Validation and Verification:	Customer Relationship Management team members review and analyze the feedback and metrics received from surveys, catalog issues and comments listed in the surveys, place follow-up calls with the survey submitters that give low scores, and bring the suggestions and feedback to chain of command and service providers for improvement opportunities.

5.2.1 Percentage of Data Strategy objectives completed.	
Data Source:	The Department's Data Strategy Implementation Tracker.

Data Validation and Verification:	The Department's inaugural Data Strategy, published in December 2020, provided a data-centered approach to supporting the agency's mission through four goals and 19 objectives. The 19 objectives were on various documented completion timelines, and throughout fiscal year (FY) 2023, the Department reported on the number of completed objectives as gauged against their requisite published timelines. In FY 2023, the Department published a new Data Strategy with 16 new objectives, and the FY 2024 performance indicator measures progress on implementing and completing those newly created objectives over the three-year implementation timeline.

5.2.2 Percentage of principal offices assessed as having higher data maturity scores year over year based on the Department's data maturity assessment (DMA) tool.	
Data Source:	The Department's annual DMA.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Department's annual DMA is administered by the Data Governance Board (DGB) support contractor. Any data identified by the DGB program management office as anomalous are discussed by the DGB support contractor and program management office. Anomalous data are researched using the original meeting notes from the monthly meeting in question and followed up with calls from the DGB program management office and to any office points of contact whose data are in question. The DGB program management office is responsible for certifying the data are accurate.

5.2.5 Number of data assets in the comprehensive data inventory.	
Data Source:	The Department's comprehensive data inventory (https://data.ed.gov/).
Data Validation and Verification:	The Chief Data Officer is responsible for establishing and maintaining the Department's comprehensive data inventory. The Department's Office of the Chief Data Officer (OCDO) established an Open Data Platform that meets the needs of the statutorily required comprehensive data inventory and is capable of tracking new and existing data assets. OCDO is responsible for calculating these numbers and establishing an independent validation process.

5.3.1 The Department's Workforce Planning Maturity Level.	
Data Source:	Principal Operating Component self-assessments against the Department's Workforce Planning Maturity Model.
Data Validation and Verification:	Components use tools and resources provided by the Office of Human Resources (OHR) to support workforce planning activities. OHR conducts regular reviews of self-assessments to verify the data and provide a final assessment.

5.3.2 Time to hire.	
Data Source:	Federal Personnel and Payroll System (FPPS) via Oracle Business Intelligence Enterprise Edition and recruitment tracking tools.
Data Validation and Verification:	Time to hire is calculated from the date the need, validated by the hiring manager, is received in the Office of Human Resources (OHR) to the date of the new employee's entrance on duty, excluding Senior Executive Service and political appointees. Data validation and verification are conducted monthly by OHR by comparing FPPS data to the recruitment tracking tools. For transparency, monthly recruitment reports and quarterly Service Level Agreement reports are provided to Principal Operating Component key contacts as an additional layer of validation. Hiring data from Federal Student Aid is not included in the fiscal year 2022 calculation.

5.3.3 Department Federal Employee Viewpoint Survey (FEVS) employee engagement index score.	
Data Source:	Office of Personnel Management (OPM) FEVS.
Data Validation and Verification:	Data verification and validation processes are integrated into the OPM FEVS results validation process. Any questionable or anomalous FEVS results identified are brought to the attention of OPM. The Department then works with the OPM point of contact to obtain clarity or resolve the results. There are no known data limitations. OPM is responsible for certifying the data are accurate.

5.3.4 Number of competency assessments across the department's occupational series offered.	
Data Source:	Competency Proficiency Tool.
Data Validation and Verification:	Periodic updates on the status of completed competency assessments will be captured in the Human Capital Operating Plan quarterly review. Upon development of validated competency models, Office of Human Resources will track the count of competency assessments offered, by respective occupational series.

5.3.5 Government-wide score on the Customer Satisfaction Survey: Overall Human Capital Function.	
Data Source:	Mission Support Customer Satisfaction Survey administered by the General Services Administration (GSA).
Data Validation and Verification:	Data validation and verification are conducted by GSA on behalf of the Office of Management and Budget. The Office of Human Resources works with GSA to identify Department employees and provide contact information for survey administration.

5.4.1 Percentage of prime small business contract obligations.	
Data Source:	Small Business Administration Small Business Scorecard.
Data Validation and Verification:	Scorecard data are validated by the Office of Small and Disadvantaged Business Utilization using the Federal Procurement Data System.

5.4.2 Percentage of contract obligations categorized as "Spend Under Management."	
Data Source:	Office of Management and Budget/General Services Administration Category Management Data-to-Decisions dashboard.
Data Validation and Verification:	Dashboard data are validated by the Office of Acquisition, Grants, and Risk Management division using Federal Procurement Data System—Next Generation and workload reports.

5.4.3 Number of days of procurement administrative lead time of contract awards.	
Data Source:	Office of Management and Budge/General Services Administration benchmarking dashboard.
Data Validation and Verification:	Dashboard data are validated by the Office of Acquisition, Grants, and Risk Management division using Federal Procurement Data System—Next Generation and workload reports.

5.4.4 Employee Engagement Index for the Department's acquisition workforce.	
Data Source:	Office of Personnel Management (OPM) Federal Employee Viewpoint Survey (FEVS) and Office of Management and Budget/General Services Administration benchmarking dashboard.
Data Validation and Verification:	Data verification and validation processes are integrated into the OPM FEVS results validation process. Any questionable or anomalous FEVS results identified are brought to the attention of OPM. The Department then works with the OPM point of contact to obtain clarity or resolve the results. There are no known data limitations. OPM is responsible for certifying the data are accurate.

COVID-19 INDICATOR 1: Amount spent within each Elementary and Secondary School Emergency Relief program on meeting students' academic, social, emotional, and other needs.	
Data Source:	Elementary and Secondary School Emergency Relief Annual Performance Report.
Data Validation and Verification:	The Office of the Chief Data Officer implements data-quality checks; via monitoring, staff will check for external validity of the data.

COVID-19 INDICATOR 2: Percentage of institutions of higher education that are on enhanced monitoring under high-risk status and monitored for appropriate use of COVID-19 pandemic relief funding.	
Data Source:	The Office of Postsecondary Education will identify high-risk grantees for enhanced monitoring based on being in the Heightened Cash Monitoring 2 category; missing, incorrect, or consistently late quarterly or annual reporting; closing institutions; or other reasons for route payment (i.e., continuous improper payments, excessive draw of funds, large available balances, multiple audit findings, and unresponsiveness).

Data Validation and Verification:	Validation will be done by monitoring central grant management systems, annual performance reports and coordination with other Principal Operating Components (i.e., Federal Student Aid, Office of the Chief Finance Officer, and Office of the Chief Data Officer).

COVID-19 INDICATOR 3: Number of technical assistance activities provided to institutions of higher education focused on ensuring proper use and reporting of Higher Education Emergency Relief Fund funding.	
Data Source:	Number of technical assistance engagements at any stage of the grant process (pre- and post-award).
Data Validation and Verification:	Counts technical assistance engagements where the objective is to inform institutions on the proper use and reporting of Higher Education Emergency Relief Fund funding.

COVID-19 INDICATOR 4: Percentage of institutions of higher education that report on their annual report that Higher Education Emergency Relief Fund funding enabled them to keep students enrolled who were at risk of dropping out due to pandemic-related factors.	
Data Source:	Annual Higher Education Emergency Relief Fund (HEERF) Performance Report. Report period closes in May for prior year information.
Data Validation and Verification:	Number of institutions that confirm in the annual report that they have utilized HEERF funds for this purpose (Question 4D). Counting the percentage of opened grants.

Appendix C. Performance Indicator Changes

Appendix C includes performance indicators that were added, removed, or changed since the publication of the *FY 2023 Annual Performance Report*.

Strategic Goal 1: Promote equity in student access to educational resources, opportunities, and inclusive environments.

None.

Strategic Goal 2: Support a diverse and talented educator workforce and professional growth to strengthen student learning.

None.

Strategic Goal 3: Meet students' social, emotional, and academic needs.

None.

Strategic Goal 4: Increase postsecondary value by focusing on equity-conscious strategies to address access to high-quality institutions, affordability, completion, post-enrollment success, and support for inclusive institutions.

None.

Strategic Goal 5: Build on the Department's internal capacity to improve the delivery of its mission.

None.

Appendix D. Summary of Performance Evaluations Completed During FY 2024

Appendix D summarizes findings from all evaluations conducted for the Institute of Education Sciences' National Center for Education Evaluation and Regional Assistance that have had publications released by the Department during fiscal year 2024. Ongoing evaluations have been included in the Department's Annual Evaluation and Evidence-Building Plan, as required under the *Foundations for Evidence-Based Policymaking Act of 2018*.

Focus Area 1—COVID-19:	Address the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on students, educators, and faculty.
Focus Area 2—Equity:	Promote equity in student access to educational resources, opportunities, and inclusive environments.
Focus Area 3—Educators:	Support a diverse educator workforce and professional growth to strengthen student learning.
Focus Area 4—Meeting Student Needs:	Meet students' social, emotional, and academic needs.
Focus Area 5—Postsecondary Value:	Increase postsecondary value by focusing on equity-conscious strategies to address affordability, completion, post-enrollment success, and support for inclusive institutions.
Focus Area 6—Federal Financial Aid:	Manage federal student aid programs.

Appropriate Identification of Children with Disabilities for IDEA Services: A Report from Recent National Estimates

Focus Areas: 2–Equity and 4–Meeting Student Needs

Appropriately identifying children with disabilities—in ways that are timely, comprehensive, and accurate—is critical for ensuring learners receive the supports they need to meet early milestones and succeed in school. In turn, the *Individuals with Disabilities Education Act* (IDEA) charges states and school districts with the following tasks, among others:

- Finding all children, birth through age 21, suspected of having a disability.
- Evaluating identified learners to determine if they are eligible for IDEA services.
- Measuring and addressing significant disproportionality based on race or ethnicity in who is identified as children with disabilities eligible for IDEA services.

Since IDEA's reauthorization in 2004, the Department has greater access to data, and there are more sophisticated approaches to screen for and identify certain disabilities, an increasingly diverse child population, and new regulations on how to measure significant disproportionality in identification. This report examines how state and district practices during the 2019–2020 school year aligned with IDEA's goals of appropriate identification.

Did the Striving Readers Comprehensive Literacy Grant Program Reach Its Goals? An Implementation Report

Focus Areas: 2–Equity and 4–Meeting Student Needs

Boosting literacy among school-age children remains a national priority. Nearly one-third of students in the United States have not developed the foundational reading skills needed to succeed academically, with students living in poverty, students with disabilities, and English learners especially at risk. Starting in 2010, Congress invested more than $1 billion for state literacy improvement efforts through the Striving Readers Comprehensive Literacy (SRCL) program. SRCL was intended to focus funding on disadvantaged schools, encourage schools to use evidence-based practices, and support schools and teachers in providing comprehensive literacy instruction. This report assesses how well SRCL implementation was aligned with these goals, using information collected from states, districts, and schools in all 11 states awarded three-year grants in 2017.

Evaluation of Departmentalized Instruction in Elementary Schools: Exploring Implementation Experiences

Focus Area: 4–Meeting Student Needs

Assigning upper elementary grade teachers to teach their strongest subjects to multiple classes (departmentalizing) rather than teaching all subjects to a single class (self-contained instruction) could mean more specialized instructional expertise in the classroom or focus for teacher planning time and professional development. This study examined the experiences of 90 schools that either voluntarily switched to departmentalized instruction for up to two years or continued with self-contained teaching in fourth and fifth grade classes beginning in fall 2019. The findings show that schools that switched were able to implement the key steps needed to departmentalize instruction but struggled with aspects of the approach. Teachers' reported experiences were consistent with some of both the benefits and challenges that prior research had hypothesized. Although the pandemic significantly disrupted instruction and the study activities, school and teacher experiences during this challenging time may inform schools and districts considering adopting departmentalized instruction.

Federal Efforts Towards Investing in Innovation through the i3 Fund: A Summary of Grantmaking and Evidence-Building

Focus Areas: 2–Equity, 3—Educators, and 4–Meeting Student Needs

Finding and expanding the use of innovative educational strategies that work is important to help improve student learning and close equity gaps nationwide. The Investing in Innovation Fund (i3) was a key Department program explicitly focused on these goals. Between 2010 and 2016, i3 invested $1.4 billion in 172 five-year grants to universities, school districts, and private nonprofit organizations. i3 intentionally awarded different types of grants to either develop and test new, innovative but as-yet unproven strategies or to learn more about the circumstances under which previously tested strategies are effective. Grantees were required to fund independent evaluations that would meet high standards for quality. The

Department reviewed 148 i3 evaluations, completed at or after the conclusion of the grants, to understand the key components of the grantees' educational strategies, assess the quality of the grantees' evaluations, and summarize what the evaluations found.

How a Federal Grant Program Is Training and Supporting Educators of English Learners

Focus Areas: 2–Equity, 3—Educators, and 4–Meeting Student Needs

Across the nation, states and school districts face a persistent shortage of educators with expertise in promoting both the English proficiency and academic achievement of English learner (EL) students. To help improve educators' qualifications and classroom instruction for ELs, the National Professional Development (NPD) Program has awarded grants for EL-focused educator professional development projects since 2002. This Department-funded program allows grantees to serve the varied types of educators who work with ELs, including those preparing to join the educator workforce, and encourages grantees to focus on professional development topics and approaches supported by rigorous research evidence. In addition, the NPD Program encourages grantees to engage in evaluation activities, including performance measurement and rigorous evaluations of project effectiveness, that may inform project improvement and contribute to evidence building. This study examines the extent to which NPD grantees implemented their projects in ways aligned with these program objectives, drawing primarily on a 2021 survey of all 2016 and 2017 NPD grantees.

Appendix E. FY 2024 Management Challenges Facing the U.S. Department of Education

The Department has made progress toward addressing the seven areas of risk identified in the fiscal year 2024 Management Challenges Facing the U.S. Department of Education report issued in December 2023 by the Department's Office of Inspector General. These challenges continue to pose significant obstacles as the Department strives to promote student achievement, preparation for global competitiveness, educational excellence, and equal access. The areas of risk identified include the following:

1. Implementing pandemic relief laws for elementary and secondary education.
2. Implementing pandemic relief laws for higher education.
3. Oversight and monitoring of student financial assistance programs.
4. Oversight and monitoring of grantees.
5. Data quality and reporting.
6. Improper payments.
7. Information technology security.

<table>
<tr><td colspan="2">Management Challenge 1—Implementing Pandemic Relief Laws for Elementary and Secondary Education
The Department was provided with more than $200 billion under three major pandemic relief laws to assist states, public and nonpublic schools, and school districts in meeting their needs and the needs of students impacted by the pandemic.
The implementation of pandemic relief laws for elementary and secondary education poses challenges for the Department, as it must effectively oversee and monitor new grant programs and ensure that quality data are reported. In addition to its pandemic relief–related oversight responsibilities, the Department must also oversee more than 100 other grant programs.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Progress in Meeting the Challenge:</td><td>Technical Assistance
Formal guidance is a priority, as it promotes consistent application of the American Rescue Plan (ARP) Act and other recovery act requirements across variously situated grantees and subgrantees and provides a clear basis for monitoring by the Department as well as other entities with oversight responsibilities (e.g., state and local inspectors general, state fiscal officers, and private auditors).
The Department meets regularly with cross-departmental workgroups, including Elementary and Secondary School Emergency Relief (ESSER), Governor's Emergency Education Relief (GEER), Emergency Assistance to Non-Public Schools (EANS)/Equitable Services, Maintenance of Effort (MOE)/ Maintenance of Equity (MOEquity), and Construction, to answer unique grantee questions (i.e., those asking about a situation or circumstance that is not easily answerable by available resources, such as frequently asked questions [FAQs]).
The Department wants to be responsive to states' needs by collecting feedback from state leadership and using it to determine and prioritize technical assistance needed for states to effectively implement programs based on requirements.
Fiscal year (FY) 2024 guidance, communication, and other technical assistance activities include:
Published guidance documents, in particular, grantees asked for guidance in using federal funds for construction. As a result, the Department published guidance on the Davis-Bacon and Related Acts provisions (relates to labor issues) and Federal Interest FAQs (relates to using federal funds for infrastructure) and issued a Dear Colleague Letter explaining how state educational agencies may apply for a Tydings waiver to consolidate administrative funds, in addition to other communications designed to promote the efficient/appropriate uses of funds.</td></tr>
</table>

	• Webinars/office hours on Davis-Bacon Compliance Oversight (211 participants); ARP ESSER and EANS liquidation extension (105 participants); subrecipient monitoring (72 participants); ARP admin funds waiver (203 participants); strategic planning for continued recovery (PGSS); and year 4 of reporting for the ESSER, GEER and EANS programs • Published weekly SGR Newsflash (publicly available to promote greater awareness of key grant administration policies and procedures; 50 publications). • The Department has worked with all 52 grantees to ensure compliance with MOE and MOEquity requirements. As a result, the Department has $779.6 million in additional funding going to high-need and high-poverty local educational agencies. Two states still need to reach compliance. **Monitoring** • The Department's regular monitoring of states helps ensure lawful, appropriate use of COVID-19 relief funds, including strong accountability for compliance with all applicable requirements. Beyond these technical requirements, monitoring helps address disparities in fund implementation supporting states in continuously improving the implementation of COVID-19 relief programs. • Timely issuance of monitoring determinations. • Implementation of corrective actions by noncompliant grantees within stated timelines. • Closeout of *Coronavirus Aid, Relief, and Economic Security* (CARES) *Act* and *Coronavirus Response and Consolidated Appropriations* (CRRSA) *Act* funded grants in compliance. • Audited the oversight of late liquidation extensions by the Office of Elementary and Secondary Education (OESE) and implemented corrective actions to address identified findings of lack of fidelity to OESE's processes for approving and managing the implementation of late liquidation extensions. Actions taken include professional development focused on late liquidation extension requirements and the management of data. • Audited all CRRSA ESSER, EANS, and GEER grant drawdowns at the end of the statutory liquidation period and reviewed findings with grantees to identify cash management issues. Resolving findings and recovering funds from Maine, Maryland, New Mexico, and Rhode Island. • Increased oversight of grantee annual performance reporting, with assistance from the Office of the Chief Data Officer (OCDO), to ensure timely reporting of accurate data of annual performance reporting data. Colorado, Michigan, and North Carolina are resolving findings for reporting that occurred in FY 2023. (FY 2024 findings of noncompliance with reporting requirements will be made in quarters 1 and 2 of FY 2025.) • Piloted late liquidation extension monitoring protocols in Indiana, Massachusetts, Oklahoma, Pennsylvania, and Texas. • Corrective actions are underway by Kansas, Maine, North Carolina, New Mexico, Oklahoma, and South Dakota in response to findings of noncompliance with ESSER program requirements identified during monitoring, including findings resulting from targeted monitoring of all ESSER grantees' subrecipient monitoring practices. Findings in Nevada and Utah are resolved and closed. • Corrective action is underway by Maryland and Oklahoma in response to findings of noncompliance with EANS program requirements identified during monitoring. • For MOE, no monitoring findings were issued for FY 2020–FY 2022 because all states have demonstrated compliance with the requirement. The Department is still in the process of collecting FY 2023 MOE data and processing waiver requests but does not anticipate issuing any monitoring findings. • All planned monitoring engagements completed with corrective actions required of grantees ongoing based on stated timelines. • Closeout of all CARES Act and CRRSA Act ESSER, GEER and EANS grants in compliance, following the end of the liquidation period and the associated last reporting period.
Planned Actions:	• The Department will continue its efforts and will track outcomes.

Management Challenge 2—Implementing Pandemic Relief Laws for Higher Education

With respect to higher education, the pandemic relief laws established and provided more than $76 billion for a new emergency relief program, the Higher Education Emergency Relief (HEER) program, and included multiple provisions intended to provide postsecondary students and borrowers with emergency relief.

The Department needs to continue its efforts given the amount of funding provided for the HEER program, significance of the student financial assistance program requirements, and the overall value of the federal student loan portfolio.

Progress in Meeting the Challenge:	**Technical Assistance** • The Department has issued and continues to issue formal, written guidance (Dear Colleague Letters, fact sheets, and frequently asked questions) and highlights these communications in the SGR Newsflash that is sent to all grantees each week as well as on our website. • The Department reminds grantees to email their state mailbox at statename.OESE@ed.gov with unique grantee inquiries and responds within 24 hours to meet grantee needs. • The Department identifies grantee technical assistance needs through data/feedback collected from grantees (FY 2023 Grantee Satisfaction Survey data and monthly meetings) and provides informational webinars and "Office Hours" to support grantees. • Formal guidance is a priority as it promotes consistent application of the ARP Act and other recovery act requirements across variously situated grantees and subgrantees and provides a clear basis for monitoring by the Department as well as other entities with oversight responsibilities (e.g., state, and local inspectors general, state fiscal officers, private auditors). • The Department meets regularly with cross-departmental workgroups: ESSER, GEER, EANS/Equitable Services, MOE/MOEquity, and Construction to answer unique grantee questions (i.e., those asking about a situation or circumstance that is not easily answerable by available resources, such as FAQs). • The Department wants to be responsive to states' needs by collecting feedback from state leadership and uses it to determine and prioritize technical assistance needed for states to effectively implement programs based on requirements. • Additional progress includes the following: • Implemented On-Ramp, Fresh Start, and Targeted Early Delinquency Intervention (TEDI). • Provided frequent, targeted communications to borrowers. • Payment pause ended in August 2023. • Interest accrual resumed September 1, 2023, and payments resumed in October 2023. • After providing a one-year transitional period, Federal Student Aid (FSA) is now preparing to resume normal operations. • 9.1 million borrowers benefitted from On-Ramp as of the end of July 2024. • Over 630,000 borrowers have participated in Fresh Start to date. • 120 million TEDI emails were sent and delivered to struggling borrowers.
Planned Actions:	• Transition out of payment pause and into repayment (there are currently more than 32 million borrowers in repayment, deferment, or forbearance status). • Continue ongoing programs designed to ease transition to repayment • Resume, beginning on October 1, 2024, normal operations to include all negative consequences of nonpayment. • Implement the Department's plan to improve oversight of the HEER program.

Management Challenge 3—Oversight and Monitoring of Student Financial Assistance Programs The Department must effectively oversee student financial assistance programs to prevent fraud, waste, and abuse, including coordinating and monitoring entities involved in federal student aid delivery within statutory and regulatory frameworks.	
Progress in Meeting the Challenge:	• The Department's hiring goal was achieved—105 staff members have been hired, the front office is set up, and senior leaders are in place. • Policies and procedures have been established across the team, and the related Government Accountability Office recommendation was marked as complete in April 2024. • Version 2.0 of the risk model was finalized and implemented in 2024. • The risk tracker is fully populated and being used as a pilot. • The investigations team has implemented two new investigative tools: a secret shopper program and a tip line to gather evidence efficiently. • A finalized process for conducting investigations has been published. • Enforcement has initiated a bulletin program and issued nine bulletins to raise awareness about compliance issues among schools and other stakeholders. • FSA has developed an enforcement webpage listing all administrative actions taken by the Department and linking to information about each school's participation agreement, including any attached conditions. • For the first time, FSA has published information about individuals who have been suspended or disbarred from contracting with the federal government due to misconduct related to the Title IV program. That information is updated quarterly.

	• In FY 2024, the Borrower Defense Group's work led to the approval of over $6.1 billion in relief to approximately 317,000 borrowers due to widespread misrepresentations made by the institution regarding placement rates, average salaries for graduates, and partnerships with employers. • The Borrower Defense Group has adjudicated thousands of individual applications under the *Sweet* settlement framework, granting relief when regulatory standards are satisfied and denying relief when they are not. • In FY 2024, RRMG reviewed and resolved 3,877 compliance complaint cases from students/borrowers against their schools, relating to more than 1,500 schools. • Among the many administrative actions taken by FSA were several particularly significant actions stemming from the investigations team, including denial of recertification for a large school and use of its fine authority for substantial misrepresentations, including the following: • Denied a large school's application for recertification based on egregious abuses of the Title IV program and students; during the 2021–2022 student aid award year, this school enrolled nearly 9,000 students and received over $85 million in Title IV funds. • Devised a novel wind-down period to protect enrolled students who wanted to get their degree. • Held individual executives from that school accountable by requiring their resignation in order for a sister school to continue in the Title IV program. • Initiated a $37.7 million fine against a school that mispresented the cost of its doctoral program to thousands of students and imposed related conditions on the school's continued participation in the Title IV program. This school is the largest recipient of federal student aid revenue in the Title IV Program, and the Department has over 800 complaints from students about this issue. • Issued the largest Clery fine in Department history, a $14 million fine in a settlement with a school for, among other things, failing to publish crime statistics and treatment of sexual assault survivors. • The investigations team has 19 staff members; the team is monitoring the appropriate number of open investigations to reflect this staff size, a number that the team anticipates will grow with training and experience.
Planned Actions:	• FSA will continue to monitor servicers' performance and hold servicers accountable to meeting the Unified Servicing and Data Solution service level agreements and objectives. • Implementation of specialty servicing will be ongoing.

Management Challenge 4—Oversight and Monitoring of Grantees The Department administers education programs authorized by Congress and the President. Effective monitoring and oversight are essential to ensure grantee compliance and program success. Balancing assistance and oversight is crucial for improving educational program performance.	
Progress in Meeting the Challenge:	• To enhance efficiency and strengthen oversight, OESE has expanded its consolidated monitoring initiatives for specific formula grants and increased the number of states under review from 4 to 5. This proactive approach ensures a more comprehensive evaluation and support for effective grant management. States monitored in FY 2024 included OK, MD, TX, VT, and CO. • Additionally, OESE's ESF grants (ESSER/EANS/GEER) continue to be included in the process. • Five consolidated reviews were planned for FY 2024 with the intention to continue that pace in FY 2025. Additionally, OESE has begun transitioning from virtual to on-site/hybrid reviews. • Staff continuously work to resolve findings.
Planned Actions:	• OESE will continue its five consolidated reviews pace in FY 2025. • OESE will continue transitioning from virtual to on-site/hybrid reviews. • Downward trends of excessive drawdowns. • No new programs moving to Phase 2 in FY 2025.

Management Challenge 5—Data Quality and Reporting The Department has made significant progress over the past several years to improve the quality of education data from the conception of a data investment through the resolution of data quality issues with grantees.

Progress in Meeting the Challenge:	• Data Quality Playbook Training was offered quarterly, with nearly 100 staff trained in fiscal year (FY) 2024. On-demand Data Quality training was published in FedTalent in September 2024. • Per the revised *2023 Information Quality Act Guidelines*, agency information collections submitted after April 2024 are expected to include a Data Quality Plan. In FY 2024, OCDO has provided technical assistance to Principal Operating Component staff representing six programs, and they have submitted complete information collection request packages with new Data Quality Plans. • A Data Quality Policy is under review with the Data Governance Board and Data Coordinator Council. Publication is expected in early FY 2025. • In FY 2024, there was an increase in frequency and scope of precollection technical assistance and hands-on live grantee assistance. Additionally, in FY 2024, there was 100 percent on-time reporting by GEER and EANS grantees and nearly 90 percent on-time reporting by ESSER grantees.
Planned Actions:	• The Department's ongoing actions will include the implementation of IQA guidelines and the implementation of the Data Quality Policy throughout the agency. • The Department needs to fully implement its enterprise-wide initiatives and demonstrate the results of these efforts to improve the quality of collected data.

Management Challenge 6—Improper Payments The Department must identify the cause of improper payments, implement effective mitigation strategies, and regularly assess their effectiveness. Programs could move into Phase 2 due to excessive drawdowns leading to improper payments. The recommendation is for the Department to increase communication and partnership with program offices regarding grantee cash management requirements.	
Progress in Meeting the Challenge:	The Department's progress included, but was not limited to: • Educating the Department grant management community and cascading messaging from the top. Examples include the following: • PIIA audit results presentation on May 29 at cross-cutting leadership meeting. • PIMA training twice a year. • Promote ACS Directive on Payment Integrity. • Cross Training Grant program managers, (i.e., Grant Rangers training). • Title I program submitted program integrity proposal with Congressional Justification on September 9, 2024 (a mandated corrective action). FSA's progress included, but was not limited to, the following: • FSA is collaborating with the Office of Management and Budget (OMB) through the OMB A-123C Re-Write Working Group to advocate for inclusion of language in the next update to A-123 Circular Appendix C to specifically allow agencies to use compliance audits as a reliable data source to support the statistically valid estimation of agency programs for PIIA reporting purposes. • FSA will continue to collaborate with OMB, Office of Inspector General (OIG), Departmental components, and the independent audit community to identify ways to improve the usefulness of information obtained in *Single Audit Act* compliance audits.
Planned Actions:	• FSA will collaborate with OMB to advocate for language in the next update to OMB Circular A-123 Appendix C to specifically allow agencies to use compliance audits as a reliable data source to support statistically valid estimates, including the point estimates and confidence intervals around the estimate, for PIIA reporting purposes. • FSA will continue efforts to obtain OMB's approval under PIIA § 3352(c)(1)(A) that FSA's sampling and estimation plan is acceptable considering program resources and characteristics. • FSA will continue to collaborate with OMB, OIG, Departmental components, and the independent audit community to identify ways to improve the usefulness of information obtained in Single Audit Act compliance audits. • OESE will continue comprehensive monitoring in several states and will rely on A-133 external audits.

Management Challenge 7—Information Technology (IT) Security The Department must ensure IT controls are effective in decreasing the risk of unauthorized use, disclosure, disruption, modification, or destruction of information and information systems that could impact the integrity and reliability of information processed in the associated applications.	
Progress in Meeting the Challenge:	• In FY 2024, the Department made significant progress in migrating to a Zero Trust Architecture (ZTA) in accordance with Office of Management and Budget (OMB) Memo (M-24-14) through implementing CASB; software-defined wide-area network; Secure Access Service Edge; XSOAR; Identity, Credential, and Access Management; EDR; new policies; and an Integrated Master Schedule (IMS) for maturing implementation according to the ZTA Strategic Plan. • The Department is coordinating with budget services for a dedicated line of funding for the enterprise cyber and IT programs by FY 2025.
Planned Actions:	Maturing ZTA implementation will ensure the Department remains on the forefront of emerging information security strategies and solutions to ensure that controls are continually integrated into our security program. Having a dedicated and protected line of funding for the enterprise Cyber and IT programs will address the following gaps: • Lack of dedicated and adequate funding for IT/Cybersecurity specific to Executive Order 14028. • FTE cuts and inability to approve requests for additional cyber-related positions. • Lack of adequate recruitment, retention, and incentive pay flexibilities program to compete with the Federal enterprise and private sector for cyber workforce.

Appendix F. Programs by Goal

Appendix F includes other discretionary programs and activities and mandatory programs by strategic goal.

Strategic Goal 1: Promote equity in student access to educational resources, opportunities, and inclusive environments.

Goal 1 Other Discretionary Programs and Activities

POC	Education/ Funding Area	Objective	Program
IES	IES	1.1	National Assessment
IES	IES	1.1	National Assessment Governing Board
IES	IES	1.1, 1.2, 1.3, 1.4	Regional Educational Laboratories
IES	IES	1.1, 1.2, 1.3, 1.4	Research, Development, and Dissemination
IES	IES	1.3	Special Education Studies and Evaluations
IES	IES	1.3	Research in Special Education
IES	IES	1.1	Statewide Longitudinal Data Systems
IES	IES	All	Statistics
OCR	OCR	1.3	Office for Civil Rights
OCTAE	CTAE	1.4	Adult Basic and Literacy Education State Grants
OCTAE	CTAE	1.4	Adult Education National Leadership Activities
OCTAE	CTAE	1.4	Career and Technical Education State Grants
OCTAE	CTAE	1.4	Career and Technical National Programs
OESE	ED	1.1	Title I Grants to Local Educational Agencies
OESE	ED	1.1	Comprehensive Literacy Development Grants
OESE	ED	1.1	State Agency Programs: Migrant
OESE	ED	1.1	State Agency Programs: Neglected and Delinquent
OESE	ED	1.4	Special Programs for Migrant Students
OESE	ED	1.1	Innovative Approaches to literacy
OESE	ELA	1.2	English Language Acquisition
OESE	I&I	1.1, 1.2	Fostering Diverse Schools
OESE	I&I	1.2	Charter Schools Grants
OESE	I&I	1.2	Education Innovation and Research
OESE	I&I	1.1, 1.2, 1.3,	Magnet Schools Assistance
OESE	I&I	1.1	Ready to Learn Programming
OESE	I&I	1.1	Arts in Education
OESE	I&I	1.1	Javits Gifted and Talented Education
OESE	I&I	1.1	Statewide Family Engagement Centers
OESE	I&I	1.1	Supporting In-Demand Credentials for Teachers
OESE	IA	1.1, 1.2, 1.3, 1.4	Impact Aid, Payments for Federally Connected Children: Basic Support Payments

POC	Education/ Funding Area	Objective	Program
OESE	IA	1.1, 1.2, 1.3, 1.4	Impact Aid, Payments for Federally Connected Children: Payments for Children with Disabilities
OESE	IA	1.1, 1.2, 1.3, 1.4	Impact Aid, Facilities Maintenance
OESE	IA	1.1, 1.2, 1.3, 1.4	Impact Aid, Construction
OESE	IA	1.1, 1.2, 1.3, 1.4	Impact Aid, Payments for Federal Property
OESE	IE	1.1, 2.2	Indian Education: Special Programs for Indian Children
OESE	IE	1.1	Indian Education: Grants to Local Educational Agencies
OESE	IE	1.1	Indian Education: National Activities
OESE	SIP	1.2	State Assessments
OESE	SIP	1.3	Training and Advisory Services
OESE	SIP	1.1	Rural Education
OESE	SIP	1.1, 1.2, 1.3, 1.4	Supplemental Education Grants
OESE	SIP	1.2	Comprehensive Centers
OESE	SIP	1.2	21st Century Community Learning Centers
OESE	SIP	1.1	Education for Homeless Children and Youth Education
OESE	SIP	1.1	Native Hawaiian Education
OESE	SIP	1.1	Alaska Native Education
OESE	SIP	1.2	Student Support and Academic Enrichment Grants
OESE	SSCE	1.1	Full-Service Community Schools
OESE	SSCE	1.1	Promise Neighborhoods
OSERS	APHB	1.2	American Printing House for the Blind
OPE	HE	1.4	Tribally-Controlled Postsecondary Career and Technical Institutions
OSERS	REHAB	1.3, 1.4	Client Assistance State Grants
OSERS	REHAB	1.4	Demonstration and Training Programs
OSERS	REHAB	1.3	Protection and Advocacy of Individual Rights
OSERS	REHAB	1.4	Supported Employment State Grants
OSERS	REHAB	1.4	Helen Keller National Center for Deaf-Blind Youths and Adults
OSERS	SE	1.2, 1.3	Special Education Grants to States
OSERS	SE	1.1, 1.3	Preschool Grants
OSERS	SE	1.1, 1.3	Grants for Infants and Families
OSERS	SE	1.1, 1.3	Technical Assistance and Dissemination
OSERS	SE	1.2	Parent Information Centers
OSERS	SE	1.1	Education Technology, Media, and Materials

Acronyms and Definitions:
POC = Principal Operating Component; IES = Institute of Education Sciences; OCR = Office for Civil Rights; OCTAE = Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education; CTAE = Career, Technical, and Adult Education; OESE = Office of Elementary and Secondary Education; ED = Education for the Disadvantaged; ELA = English Language Acquisition; I&I = Innovation and Improvement; IA = Impact Aid; IE = Indian Education; SIP = School Improvement Programs; SSCE = Safe Schools and Citizenship Education; OSERS = Office of Special Education and Rehabilitative Services; APHB = American Printing House for the Blind; OPE = Office of Postsecondary Education; HE = Higher Education; REHAB = Rehabilitation Services and Disability Research; and SE = Special Education.

Goal 1 Mandatory Programs

POC	Education/ Funding Area	Objective	Program
OCTAE	CTAE	1.4	Expanded Career Pathways for Middle and High School Students
OCTAE	CTAE	1.4	Adult Education State Grants
OSERS	REHAB	1.4	Vocational Rehabilitation, State Grants
OSERS	REHAB	1.4	Vocational Rehabilitation, Grants to Indians

Acronyms and Definitions:
POC = Principal Operating Component; OCTAE = Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education; CTAE = Career, Technical, and Adult Education; OSERS = Office of Special Education and Rehabilitative Services; and REHAB = Rehabilitation Services and Disability Research.

Strategic Goal 2: Support a diverse and talented educator workforce and professional growth to strengthen student learning.

Goal 2 Other Discretionary Programs and Activities

POC	Education/ Funding Area	Objective	Program
IES	IES	2.1, 2.2, 2.3	Regional Educational Laboratories
IES	IES	2.3	Research in Special Education
IES	IES	2.3	Special Education Studies and Evaluations
OESE	ED	All	Title I Grants to Local Educational Agencies
OESE	ED	All	Comprehensive Literacy Development Grants
OESE	ED	All	Innovative Approaches to Literacy
OESE	I&I	2.1, 2.2	Teacher and School Leader Incentive Grants
OESE	I&I	2.1, 2.2	School Leader Recruitment and Support
OESE	I&I	2.1, 2.2, 2.3	Supporting Effective Educator Development
OESE	IE	2.2	Indian Education: Special Programs for Indian Children
OESE	SIP	2.1, 2.2, 2.3	Supporting Effective Instruction State Grants
OELA	ELA	2.2	English Language Acquisition national activities and evaluation
OESE	SIP	2.1, 2.2, 2.3	Supplemental Education Grants
OPE	HE	2.1, 2.2	Teacher Quality Partnership
OPE	HE	2.1	Augustus Hawkins Center of Excellence
OSERS	REHAB	2.2, 2.3	Vocational Rehabilitation Training
OSERS	SE	2.2, 2.3	Personnel Preparation
OSERS	SE	2.2	Special Education Grants to States
OSERS	SE	2.2, 2.3	State Personnel Development

Acronyms and Definitions:
POC = Principal Operating Component; IES = Institute of Education Sciences; OESE = Office of Elementary and Secondary Education; ED = Education for the Disadvantaged; I&I = Innovation and Improvement; IE = Indian Education; SIP = School Improvement Programs; OPE = Office of Postsecondary Education; HE = Higher Education; OSERS = Office of Special Education and Rehabilitative Services; REHAB = Rehabilitation Services and Disability Research; and SE = Special Education.

Goal 2 Mandatory Programs

POC	Education/ Funding Area	Objective	Program
FSA	HEAL	2.1	Health Education Assistance Loans Liquidating Account
FSA	TEACH	2.1, 2.3	TEACH Grants: New loan subsidy
FSA	TEACH	2.1, 2.3	TEACH Grants: Upward Reestimate of Existing Loans
FSA	TEACH	2.1, 2.3	TEACH Grants: Downward Reestimate of Existing Loans (Non-add)
FSA	TEACH	2.1, 2.3	TEACH Grants: Net Reestimate of Existing Loans (Non-add)

Acronyms and Definitions:
POC = Principal Operating Component; FSA= Federal Student Aid; HEAL= Health Education Assistance Loan; and TEACH= Teacher Education Assistance for College and Higher Education.

Strategic Goal 3: Meet students' social, emotional, and academic needs.

Goal 3 Other Discretionary Programs and Activities

POC	Education/ Funding Area	Objective	Program
IES	IES	3.1, 3.2, 3.3	Research, Development, and Dissemination
IES	IES	3.1, 3.2, 3.3	Statistics
IES	IES	3.1, 3.2, 3.3	National Assessment
IES	IES	3.1, 3.2, 3.3	National Assessment Governing Board
IES	IES	3.2	Research in Special Education
IES	IES	3.1, 3.2, 3.3	Statewide Longitudinal Data Systems
IES	IES	3.2	Special Education Studies and Evaluations
IES	IES	3.1, 3.2, 3.3	Regional Educational Laboratories
OESE	ED	3.2	Comprehensive Literacy Development Grants
OESE	ED	3.2	State Agency Programs: Migrant
OESE	ED	3.2	State Agency Programs: Neglected and Delinquent
OESE	I&I	3.2	American History and Civics Education
OESE	I&I	3.2	Magnet Schools Assistance
OESE	ED	3.2	Innovative Approaches to Literacy
OESE	I&I	3.2	Ready to Learn Programming
OESE	I&I	3.2	Arts in Education
OESE	I&I	3.2	Javits Gifted and Talented Education
OESE	I&I	3.2	Statewide Family Engagement Centers
OESE	IE	3.2, 3.3	Indian Education: Special Programs for Indian Children
OESE	IE	3.2, 3.3	Indian Education: Grants to Local Educational Agencies
OESE	IE	3.2, 3.3	Indian Education: National Activities
OESE	SIP	3.2	Education for Homeless Children and Youth Education
OESE	SIP	3.2, 3.3	Native Hawaiian Education
OESE	SIP	3.2, 3.3	Alaska Native Education
OESE	SIP	3.1, 3.2, 3.3	Supplemental Education Grants
OESE	SIP	3.1, 3.2	21st Century Community Learning Centers
OESE	SIP	3.1, 3.2	Student Support and Academic Enrichment Grants

POC	Education/ Funding Area	Objective	Program
OESE	SSCE	3.1, 3.2	Full-Service Community Schools
OESE	SSCE	3.2	Promise Neighborhoods
OESE	SSCE	3.1	School Safety National Activities
OESE/OELA	ELA	3.2, 3.3	English Language Acquisition
OSERS	APHB	3.2	American Printing House for the Blind
OSERS	REHAB	3.2	Helen Keller National Center for Deaf-Blind Youths and Adults
OSERS	SE	3.2	Special Olympics Education Programs
OSERS	SE	3.2	Special Education Grants to States
OSERS	SE	3.2	Preschool Grants
OSERS	SE	3.2	Grants for Infants and Families
OSERS	SE	3.2	Technical Assistance and Dissemination
OSERS	SE	3.2	Education Technology, Media, and Materials

Acronyms and Definitions:
POC = Principal Operating Component; IES = Institute of Education Sciences; OESE = Office of Elementary and Secondary Education; ED = Education for the Disadvantaged; I&I = Innovation and Improvement; IA = Impact Aid; IE = Indian Education; SIP = School Improvement Programs; SSCE = Safe Schools and Citizenship Education; OELA = Office of English Language Acquisition; ELA = English Language Acquisition; OSERS = Office of Special Education and Rehabilitative Services; APHB = American Printing House for the Blind; REHAB = Rehabilitation Services and Disability Research; and SE = Special Education.

Goal 3 Mandatory Programs:
No additional mandatory programs.

Strategic Goal 4: Increase postsecondary value by focusing on equity-conscious strategies to address access to high-quality institutions, affordability, completion, post-enrollment success, and support for inclusive institutions.

Goal 4 Other Discretionary Programs and Activities

POC	Education/ Funding Area	Objective	Program
FSA	SFA	4.1, 4.3	Federal Pell Grants: Discretionary
FSA	SFA	4.1, 4.3	Federal Supplemental Educational Opportunity Grants
FSA	SFA	4.1, 4.3	Federal Work-Study
FSA	DM/SAA	4.2	Student Aid Administration: Salaries and Expenses
FSA	DM/SAA	4.2	Student Aid Administration: Servicing Activities
FSA	HEA	N/A	Historically Black College and University Capital Financing Program Account: Federal Administration
FSA	HEA	N/A	Historically Black College and University Capital Financing Program Account: Loan Subsidies
FSA	HEA	N/A	Historically Black College and University Capital Financing Program Account: Modification of Existing Loan Subsidies *
OCTAE	CTAE	4.3, 4.4	Career and Technical Education State Grants
OCTAE	CTAE	4.3, 4.4	Career and Technical National Programs
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Fund for the Improvement of Postsecondary Education
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Aid for Institutional Development: Strengthening Tribally-Controlled Colleges and Universities

POC	Education/ Funding Area	Objective	Program
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Aid for Institutional Development: Strengthening Alaska Native and Native Hawaiian-Serving Institutions
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Aid for Institutional Development: Strengthening Historically Black Colleges and Universities
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Aid for Institutional Development: Strengthening Historically Black Graduate Institutions
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Aid for Institutional Development: Strengthening Historically Black Colleges and Universities Master's Program
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Aid for Institutional Development: Strengthening Predominantly Black Institutions
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Aid for Institutional Development: Strengthening Asian American- and Native American/Pacific Islander-Serving Institutions
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Aid for Institutional Development: Strengthening Native American-Serving Nontribal Institutions
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Minority Science and Engineering Improvement
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Aid for Hispanic-Serving Institutions: Developing Hispanic-Serving Institutions
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Aid for Hispanic-Serving Institutions: Promoting Post-Baccalaureate Opportunities for Hispanic Americans
OPE	HE	4.3	International Education and Foreign Language Studies: Domestic Programs
OPE	HE	4.3	International Education and Foreign Language Studies: Overseas Programs
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Model Transition Programs for Students with Intellectual Disabilities into Higher Education
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Tribally-Controlled Postsecondary Career and Technical Institutions
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Federal TRIO Programs
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Gaining Early Awareness and Readiness for Undergraduate Programs (GEAR UP)
OPE	HE	4.3	Graduate Assistance in Areas of National Need
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Child Care Access Means Parents in School
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Howard University: General Support
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Howard University Hospital
OPE	HE	N/A	College Housing and Academic Facilities Loans Program Account: Federal Administration
OSERS	GU	4.1	Gallaudet University
OSERS	NTID	4.1	National Technical Institute for the Deaf
	FCC	4.2	Accelerated Success Free Community College (Proposed Legislation)

Acronyms and Definitions:
POC = Principal Operating Component; FSA = Federal Student Aid; SFA = Student Financial Assistance; DM = Departmental Management; SAA = Student Aid Administration; HEA = *Higher Education Act of 1965*; N/A = Not Applicable; OCTAE = Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education; CTAE = Career, Technical, and Adult Education; HE = Higher Education; OPE = Office of Postsecondary Education; OSERS = Office of Special Education and Rehabilitative Services; GU = Gallaudet University; NTID = National Technical Institute for the Deaf; and FCC = Free Community College.

Goal 4 Mandatory Programs

POC	Education/ Funding Area	Objective	Program
FSA	FDSL	4.1, 4.3	Federal Direct Student Loans Program Account: New Loan Subsidies
FSA	FDSL	4.1, 4.3	Federal Direct Student Loans Program Account: New Net Loan Subsidy (Non-add)*
FSA	FDSL	4.1, 4.3	Federal Direct Student Loans Program Account: Upward Reestimate of Existing Loans*
FSA	FDSL	4.1, 4.3	Federal Direct Student Loans Program Account: Downward Reestimate of Existing Loans (Non-add)*
FSA	FDSL	4.1, 4.3	Federal Direct Student Loans Program Account: Net Reestimate of Existing Loans (Non-add)*
FSA	FDSL	4.1, 4.3	Federal Direct Student Loans Program Account: Upward Modification of Existing Loans*
FSA	FFEL	4.1, 4.3	Federal Family Education Loans Program Account: Upward Reestimate of Existing Loans*
FSA	FFEL	4.1, 4.3	Federal Family Education Loans Program Account: Downward Reestimate of Existing Loans (Non-add)*
FSA	FFEL	4.1, 4.3	Federal Family Education Loans Program Account: Net Reestimate of Existing Loans (Non-add)*
FSA	FFEL	4.1, 4.3	Federal Family Education Loans Program Account: Upward Modification of Existing Loans*
FSA	FFEL	4.1, 4.3	Federal Family Education Loans Program Account: Downward Modification of Existing Loans (Non-add)*
FSA	FFEL	4.1, 4.3	Federal Family Education Loans Program Account: Net Modification of Existing Loans (Non-add)*
FSA	FFEL	4.1, 4.3	Federal Family Education Loans Liquidating Account: Pre-1992 Student Loans*
FSA	HE	N/A	Higher Education Facilities Loans Liquidating Account*
FSA	HEA	N/A	Historically Black College and University Capital Financing Program Account: Reestimate of Existing Loan Subsidies*
FSA	SFA	4.1, 4.3	Federal Pell Grants: Mandatory
FSA	SFA	4.1, 4.3	Federal Pell Grants: Mandatory Funding for Discretionary Program Costs
FSA	SFA	4.1, 4.3	Iraq and Afghanistan Service Grants
FSA	SFA	4.1, 4.3	Perkins Loan Repayments *
FSA	SFA	N/A	FDSL Downward Reestimate of Loan Subsidies*
FSA	SFA	N/A	FFEL Downward Reestimate of Loan Subsidies*
FSA	SFA	N/A	FDSL Downward Modification/Negative Loan Subsidies*
FSA	SFA	N/A	HBCU Capital Financing Downward Reestimate of Loan Subsidies*
FSA	SFA	N/A	FFEL Downward Modification/Negative Loan Subsidies*
FSA	SFA	N/A	HEAL Downward Reestimate of Loan Subsidies*
OCTAE	CTAE	4.4	Expanded Career Pathways for Middle and High School Students
OESE	SIP	4.4	School-Based Health Professionals of the Future
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Aid for Institutional Development: Mandatory Strengthening Tribally-Controlled Colleges and Universities
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Aid for Institutional Development: Mandatory Strengthening Alaska Native and Native Hawaiian-Serving Institutions
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Aid for Institutional Development: Mandatory Strengthening Historically Black Colleges and Universities

POC	Education/ Funding Area	Objective	Program
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Aid for Institutional Development: Mandatory Strengthening Predominantly Black Institutions
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Aid for Institutional Development: Mandatory Strengthening Asian American- and Native American Pacific Islander-Serving Institutions
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Aid for Institutional Development: Mandatory Strengthening Native American-Serving Nontribal Institutions
OPE	HE	4.1, 4.3	Aid for Hispanic-Serving Institutions: Mandatory Developing HSI STEM and Articulation Programs
OPE	HE	4.1	*Higher Education Act of 1965*, Title III/V Programs for Historically Black Colleges and Universities, Tribally-Controlled Colleges and Universities, Hispanic-Serving Institutions, and Minority-Serving Institutions
OPE	HE	4.1	Completion Grants
OPE	HE	N/A	College Housing and Academic Facilities Loans Program Account: Reestimate of Existing Loan Subsidies*
OPE	HE	N/A	College Housing and Academic Facilities Loans Liquidating Account*
OPE	HE	N/A	College Housing Loans Liquidating Account *
N/A	FCC	4.2	Free Community College (Proposed Legislation)
N/A	FCC	4.2	Advancing Affordability for Students (Proposed Legislation)

Acronyms and Definitions:
POC = Principal Operating Component; FSA = Federal Student Aid; FDSL = Federal Direct Student Loan; FFEL = Federal Family Education Loan; HE = Higher Education; N/A = Not Applicable; HEA = *Higher Education Act of 1965*; SFA = Student Financial Assistance; HBCU = Historically Black College or University; HEAL = Health Education Assistance Loan; OCTAE = Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education; CTAE = Career, Technical, and Adult Education; OESE = Office of Elementary and Secondary Education; SIP = Strengthening Institutions Program; OPE = Office of Postsecondary Education; HSI = Hispanic-Serving Institution; STEM = Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics; and FCC = Free Community College.
*These programs do not directly affect goal 4; they are mainly for accounting and not related to new student loans.

Strategic Goal 5: Build on the Department's internal capacity to improve the delivery of its mission.

Goal 5 Other Discretionary Programs and Activities

POC	Education/ Funding Area	Objective	Program
All	DM/PA	5.3	Program Administration: Salaries and Expenses
All	DM/PA	5.3	Program Administration: Building Modernization
OCR	OCR	5.3	Office for Civil Rights
OIG	OIG	5.3	Office of Inspector General
IES	IES	5.3	IES Program Administration

Acronyms and Definitions:
POC = Principal Operating Component; DM = Departmental Management; PA = Program Administration; OCR = Office for Civil Rights; and OIG = Office of Inspector General.

Goal 5 Mandatory Programs

No additional mandatory programs.

Appendix G. Glossary of Acronyms and Abbreviations

Acronym	Definition
AANAPISI	Asian American and Native American Pacific Islander Serving Institution
ACSI	American Customer Satisfaction Index
AEFLA	*Adult Education and Family Literacy Act*
AI/AN	American Indian and Alaska Native
APG	Agency Priority Goal
APHB	American Printing House for the Blind
APP	Annual Performance Plan
APR	Annual Performance Report
ARP	*American Rescue Plan Act of 2021*
AT	Assistive Technology
ATB	Ability to Benefit
CAR	Consolidated Annual Report
CARES	Coronavirus Aid, Relief, and Economic Security
CCHS	Career Connected High Schools
CCLC	Century Community Learning Centers
CFBNP	Center for Faith-Based and Neighborhood Partnerships
CHIPS	Creating Helpful Incentives to Produce Semiconductors
CIE	Competitive Integrated Employment
CLASS	Creating and Leveraging Acquisition Small Business Strategies
CLSD	Comprehensive Literacy State Development
CRDC	Civil Rights Data Collection
CRRSA	Coronavirus Response and Relief Supplemental Appropriations
CSF	Cybersecurity Framework
CTAE	Career, Technical, and Adult Education
CTE	Career and Technical Education
DEIA	Diversity, Equity, Inclusion, and Accessibility
DGB	Data Governance Board
DHS	Department of Homeland Security
DM	Departmental Management
DMA	Data Maturity Assessment
DPCoP	Data Professionals Community of Practice
DRAW	Digital Resilience in the American Workforce
EANS	Emergency Assistance to Non-Public Schools
EARN	Enhancing Access for Refugees and New Americans
EASIE	Electronic Application System for Indian Education
ED	Education for the Disadvantaged
EDSTP	Department Data Science Training Program
EED	Effective Educator Development
EL	English Learner
ELA	English Language Acquisition

Acronym	Definition
EO	Executive Order
ESF	Education Stabilization Fund
ESSER	Elementary and Secondary School Emergency Relief
FAFSA®	*Free Application for Federal Student Aid®*
FAQ	Frequently Asked Question
FBA	Functional Behavior Assessment
FCC	Free Community College
FDSL	Federal Direct Student Loan
FEVS	Federal Employee Viewpoint Survey
FFATA	*Federal Funding Accountability and Transparency Act of 2006*
FFEL	Federal Family Education Loan
FISMA	*Federal Information Security Modernization Act of 2014*
FISSEA	Federal Information Systems Security Educators Association
FPPS	Federal Personnel and Payroll System
FPS	*Free Application for Federal Student Aid®* Processing System
FSA	Federal Student Aid
FY	Fiscal Year
GAO	Government Accountability Office
GEAR UP	Gaining Early Awareness and Readiness for Undergraduate Programs
GEER	Governor's Emergency Education Relief
GPRA	*Government Performance and Results Act of 1993*
GPRAMA	*Government Performance and Results Act Modernization Act of 2010*
GSA	General Services Administration
GU	Gallaudet University
GYO	Grow Your Own
HBCU	Historically Black College or University
HE	Higher Education
HEA	*Higher Education Act of 1965*
HEAL	Health Education Assistance Loan
HEERF	Higher Education Emergency Relief Fund
HHS	U.S. Department of Health and Human Services
HSI	Hispanic-Serving Institution
i3	Investing in Innovation Fund
I&I	Innovation and Improvement
IA	Impact Aid
ICAM	Identity, Credential, and Access Management
ICR	Information Collection Request
IDEA	*Individuals with Disabilities Education Act*
IDR	Income-Driven Repayment
IE	Indian Education
IELCE	Integrated English Literacy and Civics Education
IES	Institute of Education Sciences
IET	Integrated Education and Training
IETC	Integrated Education and Training in Corrections
IHE	Institution of Higher Education
IPEDS	Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System

Acronym	Definition
IPS	Individual Placement and Support
IT	Information Technology
IWG	Interagency Working Group
K–12	Kindergarten Through Grade 12
LEA	Local Educational Agency
LINCS	Literacy Information and Communication System
METRICS	Mental Health Personnel Technical Assistance Center for Schools
MHSP	Mental Health Service Professional
MOE	Maintenance of Effort
MOEquity	Maintenance of Equity
MSAP	Magnet Schools Assistance Program
MSG	Measurable Skill Gain
MSI	Minority-Serving Institution
N/A	Not Applicable
NALRC	Native American Language Resource Centers
NAM	Native American and Alaska Native Children in School
NCPMI	National Center for Pyramid Model Innovations
NPD	National Professional Development
NPSS	National Partnership for Student Success
NRS	National Reporting System
NTID	National Technical Institute for the Deaf
OCDO	Office of the Chief Data Officer
OCIO	Office of the Chief Information Officer
OCR	Office for Civil Rights
OCTAE	Office of Career, Technical, and Adult Education
ODP	Open Data Platform
OELA	Office of English Language Acquisition
OESE	Office of Elementary and Secondary Education
OHR	Office of Human Resources
OIE	Office of Indian Education
OIG	Office of Inspector General
OMB	Office of Management and Budget
OPE	Office of Postsecondary Education
OPM	Office of Personnel Management
OSDBU	Office of Small and Disadvantaged Business Utilization
OSEP	Office of Special Education Programs
OSERS	Office of Special Education and Rehabilitative Services
PA	Program Administration
PBIS	Positive Behavioral Interventions and Supports
PDPDCS	Professional Development Program Data Collection System
PIL	Procurement Innovation Lab
POC	Principal Operating Component
PPOHA	Promoting Postbaccalaureate Opportunities for Hispanic Americans
PSLF	Public Service Loan Forgiveness
PSSG	Postsecondary Student Success Grant
PTI	Parent Training and Information

Acronym	Definition
REHAB	Rehabilitation Services and Disability Research
REL	Regional Educational Laboratory
RMA	Risk Management Assessment
RSA	Rehabilitation Services Administration
RTB	Raise the Bar
RTW	Return to Workplace
SA	Seminars Abroad
SAA	Student Aid Administration
SAMI	Strategic Acquisition Management Initiatives
SASE	Secure Access Service Edge
SBMH	School-Based Mental Health
SE	Special Education
SEA	State Educational Agency
SEAC	Student Engagement and Attendance Center
SEED	Supporting Effective Educator Development
SFA	Student Financial Assistance
SIP	Strengthening Institutions Program
SPCR	Strategic Planning for Continued Recovery
SRCL	Striving Readers Comprehensive Literacy
SSCE	Safe Schools and Citizenship Education
SSS	Student Support Services
STEM	Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics
TA&D	Technical Assistance and Dissemination
TBD	To Be Determined
TCCU	Tribally Controlled College or University
TEACH	Teacher Education Assistance for College and Higher Education
TEDI	Targeted Early Delinquency Intervention
TTH	Time to Hire
TQP	Teacher Quality Partnership
TS	Talent Search
TSL	Teacher and School Leader
UCS	Unlocking Career Success
USDS	Unified Servicing and Data Solution
VR	Vocational Rehabilitation
WHI	White House Initiative
WIOA	*Workforce Innovation and Opportunity Act*
ZTA	Zero-Trust Architecture

U.S. Department of Education
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U.S. Secretary of Education

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